

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 01

Genesis

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 1*

God

Table of Contents

Genesis 1
Genesis 2
Genesis 3
Genesis 4
Genesis 5
Genesis 6
Genesis 7
Genesis 8
Genesis 9
Genesis 10
Genesis 11
Genesis 12
Genesis 13
Genesis 14
Genesis 15
Genesis 16
Genesis 17
Genesis 18
Genesis 19
Genesis 20
Genesis 21
Genesis 22
Genesis 23
Genesis 24
Genesis 25
Genesis 26
Genesis 27
Genesis 28
Genesis 29
Genesis 30
Genesis 31
Genesis 32
Genesis 33
Genesis 34

Genesis 35
Genesis 36
Genesis 37
Genesis 38
Genesis 39
Genesis 40
Genesis 41
Genesis 42
Genesis 43
Genesis 44
Genesis 45
Genesis 46
Genesis 47
Genesis 48
Genesis 49
Genesis 50

Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Genesis

Genesis 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 First this: God created the Heavens and Earth--all you see, all you don't see.
- 1 In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth.
- 2 Earth was a soup of nothingness, a bottomless emptiness, an inky blackness. God's Spirit brooded like a bird above the watery abyss.
- 2 Now the earth was formless and empty, darkness was over the surface of the deep, and the Spirit of God was hovering over the waters.
- 3 God spoke: "Light!" And light appeared.
- 3 And God said, "Let there be light," and there was light.
- 4 God saw that light was good and separated light from dark.
- 4 God saw that the light was good, and he separated the light from the darkness.
- 5 God named the light Day, he named the dark Night. It was evening, it was morning-- Day One.
- 5 God called the light "day," and the darkness he called "night." And there was evening, and there was morning--the first day.
- 6 God spoke: "Sky! In the middle of the waters; separate water from water!"
- 6 And God said, "Let there be an expanse between the waters to separate water from water."
- 7 God made sky. He separated the water under sky from the water above sky. And there it was:
- 7 So God made the expanse and separated the water under the expanse from the water above it. And it was so.
- 8 he named sky the Heavens; It was evening, it was morning-- Day Two.
- 8 God called the expanse "sky." And there was evening, and there was morning--the second day.

9 God spoke: "Separate! Water-beneath-Heaven, gather into one place; Land, appear!" And there it was.

9 And God said, "Let the water under the sky be gathered to one place, and let dry ground appear." And it was so.

10 God named the land Earth. He named the pooled water Ocean. God saw that it was good.

10 God called the dry ground "land," and the gathered waters he called "seas." And God saw that it was good.

11 God spoke: "Earth, green up! Grow all varieties of seed-bearing plants, Every sort of fruit-bearing tree." And there it was.

11 Then God said, "Let the land produce vegetation: seed-bearing plants and trees on the land that bear fruit with seed in it, according to their various kinds." And it was so.

12 Earth produced green seed-bearing plants, all varieties, And fruit-bearing trees of all sorts. God saw that it was good.

12 The land produced vegetation: plants bearing seed according to their kinds and trees bearing fruit with seed in it according to their kinds. And God saw that it was good.

13 It was evening, it was morning-- Day Three.

13 And there was evening, and there was morning--the third day.

14 God spoke: "Lights! Come out! Shine in Heaven's sky! Separate Day from Night. Mark seasons and days and years,

14 And God said, "Let there be lights in the expanse of the sky to separate the day from the night, and let them serve as signs to mark seasons and days and years,

15 Lights in Heaven's sky to give light to Earth." And there it was.

15 and let them be lights in the expanse of the sky to give light on the earth." And it was so.

16 God made two big lights, the larger to take charge of Day, The smaller to be in charge of Night; and he made the stars.

16 God made two great lights--the greater light to govern the day and the lesser light to govern the night. He also made the stars.

17 God placed them in the heavenly sky to light up Earth

17 God set them in the expanse of the sky to give light on the earth,

18 And oversee Day and Night, to separate light and dark. God saw that it was good.

18 to govern the day and the night, and to separate light from darkness.
And God saw that it was good.

19 It was evening, it was morning-- Day Four.

19 And there was evening, and there was morning--the fourth day.

20 God spoke: "Swarm, Ocean, with fish and all sea life! Birds, fly through the sky over Earth!"

20 And God said, "Let the water teem with living creatures, and let birds fly above the earth across the expanse of the sky."

21 God created the huge whales, all the swarm of life in the waters, And every kind and species of flying birds. God saw that it was good.

21 So God created the great creatures of the sea and every living and moving thing with which the water teems, according to their kinds, and every winged bird according to its kind. And God saw that it was good.

22 God blessed them: "Prosper! Reproduce! Fill Ocean! Birds, reproduce on Earth!"

22 God blessed them and said, "Be fruitful and increase in number and fill the water in the seas, and let the birds increase on the earth."

23 It was evening, it was morning-- Day Five.

23 And there was evening, and there was morning--the fifth day.

24 God spoke: "Earth, generate life! Every sort and kind: cattle and reptiles and wild animals--all kinds." And there it was:

24 And God said, "Let the land produce living creatures according to their kinds: livestock, creatures that move along the ground, and wild animals, each according to its kind." And it was so.

25 wild animals of every kind, Cattle of all kinds, every sort of reptile and bug. God saw that it was good.

25 God made the wild animals according to their kinds, the livestock according to their kinds, and all the creatures that move along the ground according to their kinds. And God saw that it was good.

26 God spoke: "Let us make human beings in our image, make them reflecting our nature So they can be responsible for the fish in the sea, the birds in the air, the cattle, And, yes, Earth itself, and every animal that moves on the face of Earth."

26 Then God said, "Let us make man in our image, in our likeness, and let them rule over the fish of the sea and the birds of the air, over the

- livestock, over all the earth, and over all the creatures that move along the ground."
- 27 God created human beings; he created them godlike, Reflecting God's nature. He created them male and female.
- 27 So God created man in his own image, in the image of God he created him; male and female he created them.
- 28 God blessed them: "Prosper! Reproduce! Fill Earth! Take charge! Be responsible for fish in the sea and birds in the air, for every living thing that moves on the face of Earth."
- 28 God blessed them and said to them, "Be fruitful and increase in number; fill the earth and subdue it. Rule over the fish of the sea and the birds of the air and over every living creature that moves on the ground."
- 29 Then God said, "I've given you every sort of seed-bearing plant on Earth And every kind of fruit-bearing tree, given them to you for food.
- 29 Then God said, "I give you every seed-bearing plant on the face of the whole earth and every tree that has fruit with seed in it. They will be yours for food.
- 30 To all animals and all birds, everything that moves and breathes, I give whatever grows out of the ground for food." And there it was.
- 30 And to all the beasts of the earth and all the birds of the air and all the creatures that move on the ground--everything that has the breath of life in it--I give every green plant for food." And it was so.
- 31 God looked over everything he had made; it was so good, so very good! It was evening, it was morning-- Day Six.
- 31 God saw all that he had made, and it was very good. And there was evening, and there was morning--the sixth day.

Genesis 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Heaven and Earth were finished, down to the last detail.
- 1 Thus the heavens and the earth were completed in all their vast array.
- 2 By the seventh day God had finished his work. On the seventh day he rested from all his work.

- 2 By the seventh day God had finished the work he had been doing; so on the seventh day he rested from all his work.
- 3 God blessed the seventh day. He made it a Holy Day Because on that day he rested from his work, all the creating God had done.
- 3 And God blessed the seventh day and made it holy, because on it he rested from all the work of creating that he had done.
- 4 This is the story of how it all started, of Heaven and Earth when they were created.
- 4 This is the account of the heavens and the earth when they were created. When the LORD God made the earth and the heavens--
- 5 At the time GOD made Earth and Heaven, before any grasses or shrubs had sprouted from the ground--GOD hadn't yet sent rain on Earth, nor was there anyone around to work the ground
- 5 and no shrub of the field had yet appeared on the earth and no plant of the field had yet sprung up, for the LORD God had not sent rain on the earth and there was no man to work the ground,
- 6 (the whole Earth was watered by underground springs)--
- 6 but streams came up from the earth and watered the whole surface of the ground--
- 7 GOD formed Man out of dirt from the ground and blew into his nostrils the breath of life. The Man came alive--a living soul!
- 7 the LORD God formed the man from the dust of the ground and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life, and the man became a living being.
- 8 Then GOD planted a garden in Eden, in the east. He put the Man he had just made in it.
- 8 Now the LORD God had planted a garden in the east, in Eden; and there he put the man he had formed.
- 9 GOD made all kinds of trees grow from the ground, trees beautiful to look at and good to eat. The Tree-of-Life was in the middle of the garden, also the Tree-of-Knowledge-of-Good-and-Evil.
- 9 And the LORD God made all kinds of trees grow out of the ground--trees that were pleasing to the eye and good for food. In the middle of the garden were the tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.
- 10 A river flows out of Eden to water the garden and from there divides into four rivers.

- 10 A river watering the garden flowed from Eden; from there it was separated into four headwaters.
- 11 The first is named Pishon; it flows through Havilah where there is gold.
- 11 The name of the first is the Pishon; it winds through the entire land of Havilah, where there is gold.
- 12 The gold of this land is good. The land is also known for a sweet-scented resin and the onyx stone.
- 12 (The gold of that land is good; aromatic resin and onyx are also there.)
- 13 The second river is named Gihon; it flows through the land of Cush.
- 13 The name of the second river is the Gihon; it winds through the entire land of Cush.
- 14 The third river is named Hiddekel and flows east of Assyria. The fourth river is the Euphrates.
- 14 The name of the third river is the Tigris; it runs along the east side of Asshur. And the fourth river is the Euphrates.
- 15 GOD took the Man and set him down in the Garden of Eden to work the ground and keep it in order.
- 15 The LORD God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden to work it and take care of it.
- 16 GOD commanded the Man, "You can eat from any tree in the garden,
- 16 And the LORD God commanded the man, "You are free to eat from any tree in the garden;
- 17 except from the Tree-of-Knowledge-of-Good-and-Evil. Don't eat from it. The moment you eat from that tree, you're dead."
- 17 but you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, for when you eat of it you will surely die."
- 18 GOD said, "It's not good for the Man to be alone; I'll make him a helper, a companion."
- 18 The LORD God said, "It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make a helper suitable for him."
- 19 So GOD formed from the dirt of the ground all the animals of the field and all the birds of the air. He brought them to the Man to see what he would name them. Whatever the Man called each living creature, that was its name.
- 19 Now the LORD God had formed out of the ground all the beasts of the field and all the birds of the air. He brought them to the man to see what

- he would name them; and whatever the man called each living creature, that was its name.
- 20 The Man named the cattle, named the birds of the air, named the wild animals; but he didn't find a suitable companion.
- 20 So the man gave names to all the livestock, the birds of the air and all the beasts of the field. But for Adam no suitable helper was found.
- 21 GOD put the Man into a deep sleep. As he slept he removed one of his ribs and replaced it with flesh.
- 21 So the LORD God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep; and while he was sleeping, he took one of the man's ribs and closed up the place with flesh.
- 22 GOD then used the rib that he had taken from the Man to make Woman and presented her to the Man.
- 22 Then the LORD God made a woman from the rib he had taken out of the man, and he brought her to the man.
- 23 The Man said, "Finally! Bone of my bone, flesh of my flesh! Name her Woman for she was made from Man."
- 23 The man said, "This is now bone of my bones and flesh of my flesh; she shall be called 'woman,' for she was taken out of man."
- 24 Therefore a man leaves his father and mother and embraces his wife. They become one flesh.
- 24 For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and they will become one flesh.
- 25 The two of them, the Man and his Wife, were naked, but they felt no shame.
- 25 The man and his wife were both naked, and they felt no shame.

Genesis 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 The serpent was clever, more clever than any wild animal GOD had made. He spoke to the Woman: "Do I understand that God told you not to eat from any tree in the garden?"
- 1 Now the serpent was more crafty than any of the wild animals the LORD God had made. He said to the woman, "Did God really say, 'You must

- not eat from any tree in the garden'?"
- 2 The Woman said to the serpent, "Not at all. We can eat from the trees in the garden.
 - 2 The woman said to the serpent, "We may eat fruit from the trees in the garden,
 - 3 It's only about the tree in the middle of the garden that God said, 'Don't eat from it; don't even touch it or you'll die.'"
 - 3 but God did say, 'You must not eat fruit from the tree that is in the middle of the garden, and you must not touch it, or you will die.' "
 - 4 The serpent told the Woman, "You won't die.
 - 4 You will not surely die, the serpent said to the woman.
 - 5 God knows that the moment you eat from that tree, you'll see what's really going on. You'll be just like God, knowing everything, ranging all the way from good to evil."
 - 5 For God knows that when you eat of it your eyes will be opened, and you will be like God, knowing good and evil.
 - 6 When the Woman saw that the tree looked like good eating and realized what she would get out of it--she'd know everything!--she took and ate the fruit and then gave some to her husband, and he ate.
 - 6 When the woman saw that the fruit of the tree was good for food and pleasing to the eye, and also desirable for gaining wisdom, she took some and ate it. She also gave some to her husband, who was with her, and he ate it.
 - 7 Immediately the two of them did "see what's really going on"--saw themselves naked! They sewed fig leaves together as makeshift clothes for themselves.
 - 7 Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they realized they were naked; so they sewed fig leaves together and made coverings for themselves.
 - 8 When they heard the sound of GOD strolling in the garden in the evening breeze, the Man and his Wife hid in the trees of the garden, hid from GOD.
 - 8 Then the man and his wife heard the sound of the LORD God as he was walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and they hid from the LORD God among the trees of the garden.
 - 9 GOD called to the Man: "Where are you?"

9 But the LORD God called to the man, "Where are you?"

10 He said, "I heard you in the garden and I was afraid because I was naked. And I hid."

10 He answered, "I heard you in the garden, and I was afraid because I was naked; so I hid."

11 GOD said, "Who told you you were naked? Did you eat from that tree I told you not to eat from?"

11 And he said, "Who told you that you were naked? Have you eaten from the tree that I commanded you not to eat from?"

12 The Man said, "The Woman you gave me as a companion, she gave me fruit from the tree, and, yes, I ate it."

12 The man said, "The woman you put here with me--she gave me some fruit from the tree, and I ate it."

13 GOD said to the Woman, "What is this that you've done?" "The serpent seduced me," she said, "and I ate."

13 Then the LORD God said to the woman, "What is this you have done?" The woman said, "The serpent deceived me, and I ate."

14 GOD told the serpent: "Because you've done this, you're cursed, cursed beyond all cattle and wild animals, Cursed to slink on your belly and eat dirt all your life.

14 So the LORD God said to the serpent, "Because you have done this, "Cursed are you above all the livestock and all the wild animals! You will crawl on your belly and you will eat dust all the days of your life.

15 I'm declaring war between you and the Woman, between your offspring and hers. He'll wound your head, you'll wound his heel."

15 And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel."

16 He told the Woman: "I'll multiply your pains in childbirth; you'll give birth to your babies in pain. You'll want to please your husband, but he'll lord it over you."

16 To the woman he said, "I will greatly increase your pains in childbearing; with pain you will give birth to children. Your desire will be for your husband, and he will rule over you."

17 He told the Man: "Because you listened to your wife and ate from the tree That I commanded you not to eat from, 'Don't eat from this tree,' The very ground is cursed because of you; getting food from the ground

Will be as painful as having babies is for your wife; you'll be working in pain all your life long.

17 To Adam he said, "Because you listened to your wife and ate from the tree about which I commanded you, 'You must not eat of it,' "Cursed is the ground because of you; through painful toil you will eat of it all the days of your life.

18 The ground will sprout thorns and weeds, you'll get your food the hard way, Planting and tilling and harvesting,

18 It will produce thorns and thistles for you, and you will eat the plants of the field.

19 sweating in the fields from dawn to dusk, Until you return to that ground yourself, dead and buried; you started out as dirt, you'll end up dirt."

19 By the sweat of your brow you will eat your food until you return to the ground, since from it you were taken; for dust you are and to dust you will return."

20 The Man, known as Adam, named his wife Eve because she was the mother of all the living.

20 Adam named his wife Eve, because she would become the mother of all the living.

21 GOD made leather clothing for Adam and his wife and dressed them.

21 The LORD God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife and clothed them.

22 GOD said, "The Man has become like one of us, capable of knowing everything, ranging from good to evil. What if he now should reach out and take fruit from the Tree-of-Life and eat, and live forever? Never--this cannot happen!"

22 And the LORD God said, "The man has now become like one of us, knowing good and evil. He must not be allowed to reach out his hand and take also from the tree of life and eat, and live forever."

23 So GOD expelled them from the Garden of Eden and sent them to work the ground, the same dirt out of which they'd been made.

23 So the LORD God banished him from the Garden of Eden to work the ground from which he had been taken.

24 He threw them out of the garden and stationed angel-cherubim and a revolving sword of fire east of it, guarding the path to the Tree-of-Life.

24 After he drove the man out, he placed on the east side of the Garden of Eden cherubim and a flaming sword flashing back and forth to guard the way to the tree of life.

Genesis 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Adam slept with Eve his wife. She conceived and had Cain. She said, "I've gotten a man, with GOD's help!"
- 1 Adam lay with his wife Eve, and she became pregnant and gave birth to Cain. She said, "With the help of the LORD I have brought forth a man."
- 2 Then she had another baby, Abel. Abel was a herdsman and Cain a farmer.
- 2 Later she gave birth to his brother Abel. Now Abel kept flocks, and Cain worked the soil.
- 3 Time passed. Cain brought an offering to GOD from the produce of his farm.
- 3 In the course of time Cain brought some of the fruits of the soil as an offering to the LORD.
- 4 Abel also brought an offering, but from the firstborn animals of his herd, choice cuts of meat. GOD liked Abel and his offering,
- 4 But Abel brought fat portions from some of the firstborn of his flock. The LORD looked with favor on Abel and his offering,
- 5 but Cain and his offering didn't get his approval. Cain lost his temper and went into a sulk.
- 5 but on Cain and his offering he did not look with favor. So Cain was very angry, and his face was downcast.
- 6 GOD spoke to Cain: "Why this tantrum? Why the sulking?"
- 6 Then the LORD said to Cain, "Why are you angry? Why is your face downcast?"
- 7 If you do well, won't you be accepted? And if you don't do well, sin is lying in wait for you, ready to pounce; it's out to get you, you've got to master it."
- 7 If you do what is right, will you not be accepted? But if you do not do what is right, sin is crouching at your door; it desires to have you, but

you must master it."

- 8 Cain had words with his brother. They were out in the field; Cain came at Abel his brother and killed him.
- 8 Now Cain said to his brother Abel, "Let's go out to the field." And while they were in the field, Cain attacked his brother Abel and killed him.
- 9 GOD said to Cain, "Where is Abel your brother?" He said, "How should I know? Am I his babysitter?"
- 9 Then the LORD said to Cain, "Where is your brother Abel?" "I don't know," he replied. "Am I my brother's keeper?"
- 10 GOD said, "What have you done! The voice of your brother's blood is calling to me from the ground.
- 10 The LORD said, "What have you done? Listen! Your brother's blood cries out to me from the ground.
- 11 From now on you'll get nothing but curses from this ground; you'll be driven from this ground that has opened its arms to receive the blood of your murdered brother.
- 11 Now you are under a curse and driven from the ground, which opened its mouth to receive your brother's blood from your hand.
- 12 You'll farm this ground, but it will no longer give you its best. You'll be a homeless wanderer on Earth."
- 12 When you work the ground, it will no longer yield its crops for you. You will be a restless wanderer on the earth."
- 13 Cain said to GOD, "My punishment is too much. I can't take it!
- 13 Cain said to the LORD, "My punishment is more than I can bear.
- 14 You've thrown me off the land and I can never again face you. I'm a homeless wanderer on Earth and whoever finds me will kill me."
- 14 Today you are driving me from the land, and I will be hidden from your presence; I will be a restless wanderer on the earth, and whoever finds me will kill me."
- 15 GOD told him, "No. Anyone who kills Cain will pay for it seven times over." GOD put a mark on Cain to protect him so that no one who met him would kill him.
- 15 But the LORD said to him, "Not so; if anyone kills Cain, he will suffer vengeance seven times over." Then the LORD put a mark on Cain so that no one who found him would kill him.

- 16 Cain left the presence of GOD and lived in No-Man's-Land, east of Eden.
- 16 So Cain went out from the LORD's presence and lived in the land of Nod, east of Eden.
- 17 Cain slept with his wife. She conceived and had Enoch. He then built a city and named it after his son, Enoch.
- 17 Cain lay with his wife, and she became pregnant and gave birth to Enoch. Cain was then building a city, and he named it after his son Enoch.
- 18 Enoch had Irad, Irad had Mehujael, Mehujael had Methushael, Methushael had Lamech.
- 18 To Enoch was born Irad, and Irad was the father of Mehujael, and Mehujael was the father of Methushael, and Methushael was the father of Lamech.
- 19 Lamech married two wives, Adah and Zillah.
- 19 Lamech married two women, one named Adah and the other Zillah.
- 20 Adah gave birth to Jabal, the ancestor of all who live in tents and herd cattle.
- 20 Adah gave birth to Jabal; he was the father of those who live in tents and raise livestock.
- 21 His brother's name was Jubal, the ancestor of all who play the lyre and flute.
- 21 His brother's name was Jubal; he was the father of all who play the harp and flute.
- 22 Zillah gave birth to Tubal-Cain, who worked at the forge making bronze and iron tools. Tubal-Cain's sister was Naamah.
- 22 Zillah also had a son, Tubal-Cain, who forged all kinds of tools out of bronze and iron. Tubal-Cain's sister was Naamah.
- 23 Lamech said to his wives, Adah and Zillah, listen to me; you wives of Lamech, hear me out: I killed a man for wounding me, a young man who attacked me.
- 23 Lamech said to his wives, "Adah and Zillah, listen to me; wives of Lamech, hear my words. I have killed a man for wounding me, a young man for injuring me.
- 24 If Cain is avenged seven times, for Lamech it's seventy-seven!
- 24 If Cain is avenged seven times, then Lamech seventy-seven times."

- 25 Adam slept with his wife again. She had a son whom she named Seth. She said, "God has given me another child in place of Abel whom Cain killed."
- 25 Adam lay with his wife again, and she gave birth to a son and named him Seth, saying, "God has granted me another child in place of Abel, since Cain killed him."
- 26 And then Seth had a son whom he named Enosh. That's when men and women began praying and worshipping in the name of GOD.
- 26 Seth also had a son, and he named him Enosh. At that time men began to call on the name of the LORD.

Genesis 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 This is the family tree of the human race: When God created the human race, he made it godlike, with a nature akin to God.
- 1 This is the written account of Adam's line. When God created man, he made him in the likeness of God.
- 2 He created both male and female and blessed them, the whole human race.
- 2 He created them male and female and blessed them. And when they were created, he called them "man. "
- 3 When Adam was 130 years old, he had a son who was just like him, his very spirit and image, and named him Seth.
- 3 When Adam had lived 130 years, he had a son in his own likeness, in his own image; and he named him Seth.
- 4 After the birth of Seth, Adam lived another 800 years, having more sons and daughters.
- 4 After Seth was born, Adam lived 800 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 5 Adam lived a total of 930 years. And he died.
- 5 Altogether, Adam lived 930 years, and then he died.
- 6 When Seth was 105 years old, he had Enosh.
- 6 When Seth had lived 105 years, he became the father of Enosh.

- 7 After Seth had Enosh, he lived another 807 years, having more sons and daughters.
- 7 And after he became the father of Enosh, Seth lived 807 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 8 Seth lived a total of 912 years. And he died.
- 8 Altogether, Seth lived 912 years, and then he died.
- 9 When Enosh was ninety years old, he had Kenan.
- 9 When Enosh had lived 90 years, he became the father of Kenan.
- 10 After he had Kenan, he lived another 815 years, having more sons and daughters.
- 10 And after he became the father of Kenan, Enosh lived 815 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 11 Enosh lived a total of 905 years. And he died.
- 11 Altogether, Enosh lived 905 years, and then he died.
- 12 When Kenan was seventy years old, he had Mahalalel.
- 12 When Kenan had lived 70 years, he became the father of Mahalalel.
- 13 After he had Mahalalel, he lived another 840 years, having more sons and daughters.
- 13 And after he became the father of Mahalalel, Kenan lived 840 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 14 Kenan lived a total of 910 years. And he died.
- 14 Altogether, Kenan lived 910 years, and then he died.
- 15 When Mahalalel was sixty-five years old, he had Jared.
- 15 When Mahalalel had lived 65 years, he became the father of Jared.
- 16 After he had Jared, he lived another 830 years, having more sons and daughters.
- 16 And after he became the father of Jared, Mahalalel lived 830 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 17 Mahalalel lived a total of 895 years. And he died.
- 17 Altogether, Mahalalel lived 895 years, and then he died.
- 18 When Jared was 162 years old, he had Enoch.
- 18 When Jared had lived 162 years, he became the father of Enoch.
- 19 After he had Enoch, he lived another 800 years, having more sons and daughters.
- 19 And after he became the father of Enoch, Jared lived 800 years and had other sons and daughters.

20 Jared lived a total of 962 years. And he died.
20 Altogether, Jared lived 962 years, and then he died.
21 When Enoch was sixty-five years old, he had Methuselah.
21 When Enoch had lived 65 years, he became the father of Methuselah.
22 Enoch walked steadily with God. After he had Methuselah, he lived another 300 years, having more sons and daughters.
22 And after he became the father of Methuselah, Enoch walked with God 300 years and had other sons and daughters.
23 Enoch lived a total of 365 years.
23 Altogether, Enoch lived 365 years.
24 Enoch walked steadily with God. And then one day he was simply gone: God took him.
24 Enoch walked with God; then he was no more, because God took him away.
25 When Methuselah was 187 years old, he had Lamech.
25 When Methuselah had lived 187 years, he became the father of Lamech.
26 After he had Lamech, he lived another 782 years.
26 And after he became the father of Lamech, Methuselah lived 782 years and had other sons and daughters.
27 Methuselah lived a total of 969 years. And he died.
27 Altogether, Methuselah lived 969 years, and then he died.
28 When Lamech was 182 years old, he had a son.
28 When Lamech had lived 182 years, he had a son.
29 He named him Noah, saying, "This one will give us a break from the hard work of farming the ground that GOD cursed."
29 He named him Noah and said, "He will comfort us in the labor and painful toil of our hands caused by the ground the LORD has cursed."
30 After Lamech had Noah, he lived another 595 years, having more sons and daughters.
30 After Noah was born, Lamech lived 595 years and had other sons and daughters.
31 Lamech lived a total of 777 years. And he died.
31 Altogether, Lamech lived 777 years, and then he died.
32 When Noah was 500 years old, he had Shem, Ham, and Japheth.
32 After Noah was 500 years old, he became the father of Shem, Ham and Japheth.

Genesis 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 When the human race began to increase, with more and more daughters being born,
- 1 When men began to increase in number on the earth and daughters were born to them,
- 2 the sons of God noticed that the daughters of men were beautiful. They looked them over and picked out wives for themselves.
- 2 the sons of God saw that the daughters of men were beautiful, and they married any of them they chose.
- 3 Then GOD said, "I'm not going to breathe life into men and women endlessly. Eventually they're going to die; from now on they can expect a life span of 120 years."
- 3 Then the LORD said, "My Spirit will not contend with man forever, for he is mortal; his days will be a hundred and twenty years."
- 4 This was back in the days (and also later) when there were giants in the land. The giants came from the union of the sons of God and the daughters of men. These were the mighty men of ancient lore, the famous ones.
- 4 The Nephilim were on the earth in those days--and also afterward--when the sons of God went to the daughters of men and had children by them. They were the heroes of old, men of renown.
- 5 GOD saw that human evil was out of control. People thought evil, imagined evil--evil, evil, evil from morning to night.
- 5 The LORD saw how great man's wickedness on the earth had become, and that every inclination of the thoughts of his heart was only evil all the time.
- 6 GOD was sorry that he had made the human race in the first place; it broke his heart.
- 6 The LORD was grieved that he had made man on the earth, and his heart was filled with pain.
- 7 GOD said, "I'll get rid of my ruined creation, make a clean sweep: people, animals, snakes and bugs, birds--the works. I'm sorry I made them."

- 7 So the LORD said, "I will wipe mankind, whom I have created, from the face of the earth-- men and animals, and creatures that move along the ground, and birds of the air--for I am grieved that I have made them."
- 8 But Noah was different. GOD liked what he saw in Noah.
- 8 But Noah found favor in the eyes of the LORD.
- 9 This is the story of Noah: Noah was a good man, a man of integrity in his community. Noah walked with God.
- 9 This is the account of Noah. Noah was a righteous man, blameless among the people of his time, and he walked with God.
- 10 Noah had three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth.
- 10 Noah had three sons: Shem, Ham and Japheth.
- 11 As far as God was concerned, the Earth had become a sewer; there was violence everywhere.
- 11 Now the earth was corrupt in God's sight and was full of violence.
- 12 God took one look and saw how bad it was, everyone corrupt and corrupting--life itself corrupt to the core.
- 12 God saw how corrupt the earth had become, for all the people on earth had corrupted their ways.
- 13 God said to Noah, "It's all over. It's the end of the human race. The violence is everywhere; I'm making a clean sweep.
- 13 So God said to Noah, "I am going to put an end to all people, for the earth is filled with violence because of them. I am surely going to destroy both them and the earth.
- 14 "Build yourself a ship from teakwood. Make rooms in it. Coat it with pitch inside and out.
- 14 So make yourself an ark of cypress wood; make rooms in it and coat it with pitch inside and out.
- 15 Make it 450 feet long, seventy-five feet wide, and forty-five feet high.
- 15 This is how you are to build it: The ark is to be 450 feet long, 75 feet wide and 45 feet high.
- 16 Build a roof for it and put in a window eighteen inches from the top; put in a door on the side of the ship; and make three decks, lower, middle, and upper.
- 16 Make a roof for it and finish the ark to within 18 inches of the top. Put a door in the side of the ark and make lower, middle and upper decks.

- 17 "I'm going to bring a flood on the Earth that will destroy everything alive under Heaven. Total destruction.
- 17 I am going to bring floodwaters on the earth to destroy all life under the heavens, every creature that has the breath of life in it. Everything on earth will perish.
- 18 "But I'm going to establish a covenant with you: You'll board the ship, and your sons, your wife and your sons' wives will come on board with you.
- 18 But I will establish my covenant with you, and you will enter the ark--you and your sons and your wife and your sons' wives with you.
- 19 You are also to take two of each living creature, a male and a female, on board the ship, to preserve their lives with you:
- 19 You are to bring into the ark two of all living creatures, male and female, to keep them alive with you.
- 20 two of every species of bird, mammal, and reptile--two of everything so as to preserve their lives along with yours.
- 20 Two of every kind of bird, of every kind of animal and of every kind of creature that moves along the ground will come to you to be kept alive.
- 21 Also get all the food you'll need and store it up for you and them."
- 21 You are to take every kind of food that is to be eaten and store it away as food for you and for them."
- 22 Noah did everything God commanded him to do.
- 22 Noah did everything just as God commanded him.

Genesis 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 Next GOD said to Noah, "Now board the ship, you and all your family--out of everyone in this generation, you're the righteous one.
- 1 The LORD then said to Noah, "Go into the ark, you and your whole family, because I have found you righteous in this generation.
- 2 "Take on board with you seven pairs of every clean animal, a male and a female; one pair of every unclean animal, a male and a female;
- 2 Take with you seven of every kind of clean animal, a male and its mate, and two of every kind of unclean animal, a male and its mate,

- 3 and seven pairs of every kind of bird, a male and a female, to insure their survival on Earth.
- 3 and also seven of every kind of bird, male and female, to keep their various kinds alive throughout the earth.
- 4 In just seven days I will dump rain on Earth for forty days and forty nights. I'll make a clean sweep of everything that I've made."
- 4 Seven days from now I will send rain on the earth for forty days and forty nights, and I will wipe from the face of the earth every living creature I have made."
- 5 Noah did everything GOD commanded him.
- 5 And Noah did all that the LORD commanded him.
- 6 Noah was 600 years old when the floodwaters covered the Earth.
- 6 Noah was six hundred years old when the floodwaters came on the earth.
- 7 Noah and his wife and sons and their wives boarded the ship to escape the flood.
- 7 And Noah and his sons and his wife and his sons' wives entered the ark to escape the waters of the flood.
- 8 Clean and unclean animals, birds, and all the crawling creatures
- 8 Pairs of clean and unclean animals, of birds and of all creatures that move along the ground,
- 9 came in pairs to Noah and to the ship, male and female, just as God had commanded Noah.
- 9 male and female, came to Noah and entered the ark, as God had commanded Noah.
- 10 In seven days the floodwaters came.
- 10 And after the seven days the floodwaters came on the earth.
- 11 It was the six-hundredth year of Noah's life, in the second month, on the seventeenth day of the month that it happened: all the underground springs erupted and all the windows of Heaven were thrown open.
- 11 In the six hundredth year of Noah's life, on the seventeenth day of the second month--on that day all the springs of the great deep burst forth, and the floodgates of the heavens were opened.
- 12 Rain poured for forty days and forty nights.
- 12 And rain fell on the earth forty days and forty nights.
- 13 That's the day Noah and his sons Shem, Ham, and Japheth, accompanied by his wife and his sons' wives, boarded the ship.

- 13 On that very day Noah and his sons, Shem, Ham and Japheth, together with his wife and the wives of his three sons, entered the ark.
- 14 And with them every kind of wild and domestic animal, right down to all the kinds of creatures that crawl and all kinds of birds and anything that flies.
- 14 They had with them every wild animal according to its kind, all livestock according to their kinds, every creature that moves along the ground according to its kind and every bird according to its kind, everything with wings.
- 15 They came to Noah and to the ship in pairs--everything and anything that had the breath of life in it,
- 15 Pairs of all creatures that have the breath of life in them came to Noah and entered the ark.
- 16 male and female of every creature came just as God had commanded Noah. Then GOD shut the door behind him.
- 16 The animals going in were male and female of every living thing, as God had commanded Noah. Then the LORD shut him in.
- 17 The flood continued forty days and the waters rose and lifted the ship high over the Earth.
- 17 For forty days the flood kept coming on the earth, and as the waters increased they lifted the ark high above the earth.
- 18 The waters kept rising, the flood deepened on the Earth, the ship floated on the surface.
- 18 The waters rose and increased greatly on the earth, and the ark floated on the surface of the water.
- 19 The flood got worse until all the highest mountains were covered--
- 19 They rose greatly on the earth, and all the high mountains under the entire heavens were covered.
- 20 the high water mark reached twenty feet above the crest of the mountains.
- 20 The waters rose and covered the mountains to a depth of more than twenty feet.
- 21 Everything died. Anything that moved--dead. Birds, farm animals, wild animals, the entire teeming exuberance of life--dead. And all people--dead.

- 21 Every living thing that moved on the earth perished--birds, livestock, wild animals, all the creatures that swarm over the earth, and all mankind.
- 22 Every living, breathing creature that lived on dry land died;
- 22 Everything on dry land that had the breath of life in its nostrils died.
- 23 he wiped out the whole works--people and animals, crawling creatures and flying birds, every last one of them, gone. Only Noah and his company on the ship lived.
- 23 Every living thing on the face of the earth was wiped out; men and animals and the creatures that move along the ground and the birds of the air were wiped from the earth. Only Noah was left, and those with him in the ark.
- 24 The floodwaters took over for 150 days.
- 24 The waters flooded the earth for a hundred and fifty days.

Genesis 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then God turned his attention to Noah and all the wild animals and farm animals with him on the ship. God caused the wind to blow and the floodwaters began to go down.
- 1 But God remembered Noah and all the wild animals and the livestock that were with him in the ark, and he sent a wind over the earth, and the waters receded.
- 2 The underground springs were shut off, the windows of Heaven closed and the rain quit.
- 2 Now the springs of the deep and the floodgates of the heavens had been closed, and the rain had stopped falling from the sky.
- 3 Inch by inch the water lowered. After 150 days the worst was over.
- 3 The water receded steadily from the earth. At the end of the hundred and fifty days the water had gone down,
- 4 On the seventeenth day of the seventh month, the ship landed on the Ararat mountain range.
- 4 and on the seventeenth day of the seventh month the ark came to rest on the mountains of Ararat.

- 5 The water kept going down until the tenth month. On the first day of the tenth month the tops of the mountains came into view.
- 5 The waters continued to recede until the tenth month, and on the first day of the tenth month the tops of the mountains became visible.
- 6 After forty days Noah opened the window that he had built into the ship.
- 6 After forty days Noah opened the window he had made in the ark
- 7 He sent out a raven; it flew back and forth waiting for the floodwaters to dry up.
- 7 and sent out a raven, and it kept flying back and forth until the water had dried up from the earth.
- 8 Then he sent a dove to check on the flood conditions,
- 8 Then he sent out a dove to see if the water had receded from the surface of the ground.
- 9 but it couldn't even find a place to perch--water still covered the Earth. Noah reached out and caught it, brought it back into the ship.
- 9 But the dove could find no place to set its feet because there was water over all the surface of the earth; so it returned to Noah in the ark. He reached out his hand and took the dove and brought it back to himself in the ark.
- 10 He waited seven more days and sent out the dove again.
- 10 He waited seven more days and again sent out the dove from the ark.
- 11 It came back in the evening with a freshly picked olive leaf in its beak. Noah knew that the flood was about finished.
- 11 When the dove returned to him in the evening, there in its beak was a freshly plucked olive leaf! Then Noah knew that the water had receded from the earth.
- 12 He waited another seven days and sent the dove out a third time. This time it didn't come back.
- 12 He waited seven more days and sent the dove out again, but this time it did not return to him.
- 13 In the six-hundred-first year of Noah's life, on the first day of the first month, the flood had dried up. Noah opened the hatch of the ship and saw dry ground.
- 13 By the first day of the first month of Noah's six hundred and first year, the water had dried up from the earth. Noah then removed the covering from the ark and saw that the surface of the ground was dry.

- 14 By the twenty-seventh day of the second month, the Earth was completely dry.
- 14 By the twenty-seventh day of the second month the earth was completely dry.
- 15 God spoke to Noah:
- 15 Then God said to Noah,
- 16 "Leave the ship, you and your wife and your sons and your sons' wives.
- 16 Come out of the ark, you and your wife and your sons and their wives.
- 17 And take all the animals with you, the whole menagerie of birds and mammals and crawling creatures, all that brimming prodigality of life, so they can reproduce and flourish on the Earth."
- 17 Bring out every kind of living creature that is with you--the birds, the animals, and all the creatures that move along the ground--so they can multiply on the earth and be fruitful and increase in number upon it."
- 18 Noah disembarked with his sons and wife and his sons' wives.
- 18 So Noah came out, together with his sons and his wife and his sons' wives.
- 19 Then all the animals, crawling creatures, birds--every creature on the face of the Earth--left the ship family by family.
- 19 All the animals and all the creatures that move along the ground and all the birds--everything that moves on the earth--came out of the ark, one kind after another.
- 20 Noah built an altar to GOD. He selected clean animals and birds from every species and offered them as burnt-offerings on the altar.
- 20 Then Noah built an altar to the LORD and, taking some of all the clean animals and clean birds, he sacrificed burnt offerings on it.
- 21 GOD smelled the sweet fragrance and thought to himself, "I'll never again curse the ground because of people. I know they have this bent toward evil from an early age, but I'll never again kill off everything living as I've just done.
- 21 The LORD smelled the pleasing aroma and said in his heart: "Never again will I curse the ground because of man, even though every inclination of his heart is evil from childhood. And never again will I destroy all living creatures, as I have done.
- 22 For as long as Earth lasts, planting and harvest, cold and heat, Summer and winter, day and night will never stop."

22 As long as the earth endures, seedtime and harvest, cold and heat, summer and winter, day and night will never cease.

Genesis 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 God blessed Noah and his sons: He said, "Prosper! Reproduce! Fill the Earth!
- 1 Then God blessed Noah and his sons, saying to them, "Be fruitful and increase in number and fill the earth.
- 2 Every living creature--birds, animals, fish--will fall under your spell and be afraid of you. You're responsible for them.
- 2 The fear and dread of you will fall upon all the beasts of the earth and all the birds of the air, upon every creature that moves along the ground, and upon all the fish of the sea; they are given into your hands.
- 3 All living creatures are yours for food; just as I gave you the plants, now I give you everything else.
- 3 Everything that lives and moves will be food for you. Just as I gave you the green plants, I now give you everything.
- 4 Except for meat with its lifeblood still in it--don't eat that.
- 4 But you must not eat meat that has its lifeblood still in it.
- 5 "But your own lifeblood I will avenge; I will avenge it against both animals and other humans.
- 5 And for your lifeblood I will surely demand an accounting. I will demand an accounting from every animal. And from each man, too, I will demand an accounting for the life of his fellow man.
- 6 Whoever sheds human blood, by humans let his blood be shed, Because God made humans in his image reflecting God's very nature.
- 6 Whoever sheds the blood of man, by man shall his blood be shed; for in the image of God has God made man.
- 7 You're here to bear fruit, reproduce, lavish life on the Earth, live bountifully!"
- 7 As for you, be fruitful and increase in number; multiply on the earth and increase upon it."
- 8 Then God spoke to Noah and his sons:

- 8 Then God said to Noah and to his sons with him:
- 9 "I'm setting up my covenant with you including your children who will come after you,
- 9 I now establish my covenant with you and with your descendants after you
- 10 along with everything alive around you--birds, farm animals, wild animals--that came out of the ship with you.
- 10 and with every living creature that was with you--the birds, the livestock and all the wild animals, all those that came out of the ark with you--every living creature on earth.
- 11 I'm setting up my covenant with you that never again will everything living be destroyed by floodwaters; no, never again will a flood destroy the Earth."
- 11 I establish my covenant with you: Never again will all life be cut off by the waters of a flood; never again will there be a flood to destroy the earth."
- 12 God continued, "This is the sign of the covenant I am making between me and you and everything living around you and everyone living after you.
- 12 And God said, "This is the sign of the covenant I am making between me and you and every living creature with you, a covenant for all generations to come:
- 13 I'm putting my rainbow in the clouds, a sign of the covenant between me and the Earth.
- 13 I have set my rainbow in the clouds, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and the earth.
- 14 From now on, when I form a cloud over the Earth and the rainbow appears in the cloud,
- 14 Whenever I bring clouds over the earth and the rainbow appears in the clouds,
- 15 I'll remember my covenant between me and you and everything living, that never again will floodwaters destroy all life.
- 15 I will remember my covenant between me and you and all living creatures of every kind. Never again will the waters become a flood to destroy all life.

- 16 When the rainbow appears in the cloud, I'll see it and remember the eternal covenant between God and everything living, every last living creature on Earth."
- 16 Whenever the rainbow appears in the clouds, I will see it and remember the everlasting covenant between God and all living creatures of every kind on the earth."
- 17 And God said, "This is the sign of the covenant that I've set up between me and everything living on the Earth."
- 17 So God said to Noah, "This is the sign of the covenant I have established between me and all life on the earth."
- 18 The sons of Noah who came out of the ship were Shem, Ham, and Japheth. Ham was the father of Canaan.
- 18 The sons of Noah who came out of the ark were Shem, Ham and Japheth. (Ham was the father of Canaan.)
- 19 These are the three sons of Noah; from these three the whole Earth was populated.
- 19 These were the three sons of Noah, and from them came the people who were scattered over the earth.
- 20 Noah, a farmer, was the first to plant a vineyard.
- 20 Noah, a man of the soil, proceeded to plant a vineyard.
- 21 He drank from its wine, got drunk and passed out, naked in his tent.
- 21 When he drank some of its wine, he became drunk and lay uncovered inside his tent.
- 22 Ham, the father of Canaan, saw that his father was naked and told his two brothers who were outside the tent.
- 22 Ham, the father of Canaan, saw his father's nakedness and told his two brothers outside.
- 23 Shem and Japheth took a cloak, held it between them from their shoulders, walked backwards and covered their father's nakedness, keeping their faces turned away so they did not see their father's exposed body.
- 23 But Shem and Japheth took a garment and laid it across their shoulders; then they walked in backward and covered their father's nakedness. Their faces were turned the other way so that they would not see their father's nakedness.

- 24 When Noah woke up with his hangover, he learned what his youngest son had done.
- 24 When Noah awoke from his wine and found out what his youngest son had done to him,
- 25 He said, Cursed be Canaan! A slave of slaves, a slave to his brothers!
- 25 he said, "Cursed be Canaan! The lowest of slaves will he be to his brothers."
- 26 Blessed be GOD, the God of Shem, but Canaan shall be his slave.
- 26 He also said, "Blessed be the LORD, the God of Shem! May Canaan be the slave of Shem.
- 27 God prosper Japheth, living spaciously in the tents of Shem. But Canaan shall be his slave.
- 27 May God extend the territory of Japheth; may Japheth live in the tents of Shem, and may Canaan be his slave."
- 28 Noah lived another 350 years following the flood.
- 28 After the flood Noah lived 350 years.
- 29 He lived a total of 950 years. And he died.
- 29 Altogether, Noah lived 950 years, and then he died.

Genesis 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 This is the family tree of the sons of Noah: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. After the flood, they themselves had sons.
- 1 This is the account of Shem, Ham and Japheth, Noah's sons, who themselves had sons after the flood.
- 2 The sons of Japheth: Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, Tiras.
- 2 The sons of Japheth: Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech and Tiras.
- 3 The sons of Gomer: Ashkenaz, Riphath, Togarmah.
- 3 The sons of Gomer: Ashkenaz, Riphath and Togarmah.
- 4 The sons of Javan: Elishah, Tarshish, Kittim, Rodanim.
- 4 The sons of Javan: Elishah, Tarshish, the Kittim and the Rodanim.

- 5 The seafaring peoples developed from these, each in its own place by family, each with its own language.
- 5 (From these the maritime peoples spread out into their territories by their clans within their nations, each with its own language.)
- 6 The sons of Ham: Cush, Egypt, Put, Canaan.
- 6 The sons of Ham: Cush, Mizraim, Put and Canaan.
- 7 The sons of Cush: Seba, Havilah, Sabtah, Raamah, Sabteca. The sons of Raamah: Sheba, Dedan.
- 7 The sons of Cush: Seba, Havilah, Sabtah, Raamah and Sabteca. The sons of Raamah: Sheba and Dedan.
- 8 Cush also had Nimrod. He was the first great warrior on Earth.
- 8 Cush was the father of Nimrod, who grew to be a mighty warrior on the earth.
- 9 He was a great hunter before GOD. There was a saying, "Like Nimrod, a great hunter before GOD."
- 9 He was a mighty hunter before the LORD; that is why it is said, "Like Nimrod, a mighty hunter before the LORD."
- 10 His kingdom got its start with Babel; then Erech, Akkad, and Calneh in the country of Shinar.
- 10 The first centers of his kingdom were Babylon, Erech, Akkad and Calneh, in Shinar.
- 11 From there he went up to Asshur and built Nineveh, Rehoboth Ir, Calah,
- 11 From that land he went to Assyria, where he built Nineveh, Rehoboth Ir, Calah
- 12 and Resen between Nineveh and the great city Calah.
- 12 and Resen, which is between Nineveh and Calah; that is the great city.
- 13 Egypt was ancestor to the Ludim, the Anamim, the Lehabim, the Naphtuhim,
- 13 Mizraim was the father of the Ludites, Anamites, Lehabites, Naphtuhites,
- 14 the Pathrusim, the Casluhim (the origin of the Philistines), and the Kaphtorim.
- 14 Pathrusites, Casluhites (from whom the Philistines came) and Caphtorites.
- 15 Canaan had Sidon his firstborn, Heth,
- 15 Canaan was the father of Sidon his firstborn, and of the Hittites,

16 the Jebusites, the Amorites, the Girgashites,
16 Jebusites, Amorites, Girgashites,
17 the Hivites, the Arkites, the Sinites,
17 Hivites, Arkites, Sinites,
18 the Arvadites, the Zemarites, and the Hamathites. Later the Canaanites
spread out,
18 Arvadites, Zemarites and Hamathites. Later the Canaanite clans
scattered
19 going from Sidon toward Gerar, as far south as Gaza, and then east all
the way over to Sodom, Gomorrah, Admah, Zeboiim, and on to Lasha.
19 and the borders of Canaan reached from Sidon toward Gerar as far as
Gaza, and then toward Sodom, Gomorrah, Admah and Zeboiim, as far as
Lasha.
20 These are the descendants of Ham by family, language, country, and
nation.
20 These are the sons of Ham by their clans and languages, in their
territories and nations.
21 Shem, the older brother of Japheth, also had sons. Shem was ancestor to
all the children of Eber.
21 Sons were also born to Shem, whose older brother was Japheth; Shem
was the ancestor of all the sons of Eber.
22 The sons of Shem: Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, and Aram.
22 The sons of Shem: Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud and Aram.
23 The sons of Aram: Uz, Hul, Gether, Meshech.
23 The sons of Aram: Uz, Hul, Gether and Meshech.
24 Arphaxad had Shelah and Shelah had Eber.
24 Arphaxad was the father of Shelah, and Shelah the father of Eber.
25 Eber had two sons, Peleg (so named because in his days the human race
divided) and Joktan.
25 Two sons were born to Eber: One was named Peleg, because in his time
the earth was divided; his brother was named Joktan.
26 Joktan had Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah,
26 Joktan was the father of Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah,
27 Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah,
27 Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah,
28 Obal, Abimael, Sheba,

- 28 Obal, Abimael, Sheba,
29 Ophir, Havilah, and Jobab--all sons of Joktan.
29 Ophir, Havilah and Jobab. All these were sons of Joktan.
30 Their land goes from Mesha toward Sephar as far as the mountain ranges in the east.
30 The region where they lived stretched from Mesha toward Sephar, in the eastern hill country.
31 These are the descendants of Shem by family, language, country, and nation.
31 These are the sons of Shem by their clans and languages, in their territories and nations.
32 This is the family tree of the sons of Noah as they developed into nations. From them nations developed all across the Earth after the flood.
32 These are the clans of Noah's sons, according to their lines of descent, within their nations. From these the nations spread out over the earth after the flood.

Genesis 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 At one time, the whole Earth spoke the same language.
1 Now the whole world had one language and a common speech.
2 It so happened that as they moved out of the east, they came upon a plain in the land of Shinar and settled down.
2 As men moved eastward, they found a plain in Shinar and settled there.
3 They said to one another, "Come, let's make bricks and fire them well." They used brick for stone and tar for mortar.
3 They said to each other, "Come, let's make bricks and bake them thoroughly." They used brick instead of stone, and tar for mortar.
4 Then they said, "Come, let's build ourselves a city and a tower that reaches Heaven. Let's make ourselves famous so we won't be scattered here and there across the Earth."
4 Then they said, "Come, let us build ourselves a city, with a tower that reaches to the heavens, so that we may make a name for ourselves and

- not be scattered over the face of the whole earth."
- 5 GOD came down to look over the city and the tower those people had built.
- 5 But the LORD came down to see the city and the tower that the men were building.
- 6 GOD took one look and said, "One people, one language; why, this is only a first step. No telling what they'll come up with next--they'll stop at nothing!"
- 6 The LORD said, "If as one people speaking the same language they have begun to do this, then nothing they plan to do will be impossible for them.
- 7 Come, we'll go down and garble their speech so they won't understand each other."
- 7 Come, let us go down and confuse their language so they will not understand each other."
- 8 Then GOD scattered them from there all over the world. And they had to quit building the city.
- 8 So the LORD scattered them from there over all the earth, and they stopped building the city.
- 9 That's how it came to be called Babel, because there GOD turned their language into "babble." From there GOD scattered them all over the world.
- 9 That is why it was called Babel --because there the LORD confused the language of the whole world. From there the LORD scattered them over the face of the whole earth.
- 10 This is the story of Shem. When Shem was 100 years old, he had Arphaxad. It was two years after the flood.
- 10 This is the account of Shem. Two years after the flood, when Shem was 100 years old, he became the father of Arphaxad.
- 11 After he had Arphaxad, he lived 600 more years and had other sons and daughters.
- 11 And after he became the father of Arphaxad, Shem lived 500 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 12 When Arphaxad was thirty-five years old, he had Shelah.
- 12 When Arphaxad had lived 35 years, he became the father of Shelah.

- 13 After Arphaxad had Shelah, he lived 403 more years and had other sons and daughters.
- 13 And after he became the father of Shelah, Arphaxad lived 403 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 14 When Shelah was thirty years old, he had Eber.
- 14 When Shelah had lived 30 years, he became the father of Eber.
- 15 After Shelah had Eber, he lived 403 more years and had other sons and daughters.
- 15 And after he became the father of Eber, Shelah lived 403 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 16 When Eber was thirty-four years old, he had Peleg.
- 16 When Eber had lived 34 years, he became the father of Peleg.
- 17 After Eber had Peleg, he lived 403 more years and had other sons and daughters.
- 17 And after he became the father of Peleg, Eber lived 430 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 18 When Peleg was thirty years old, he had Reu.
- 18 When Peleg had lived 30 years, he became the father of Reu.
- 19 After he had Reu, he lived 209 more years and had other sons and daughters.
- 19 And after he became the father of Reu, Peleg lived 209 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 20 When Reu was thirty-two years old, he had Serug.
- 20 When Reu had lived 32 years, he became the father of Serug.
- 21 After Reu had Serug, he lived 207 more years and had other sons and daughters.
- 21 And after he became the father of Serug, Reu lived 207 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 22 When Serug was thirty years old, he had Nahor.
- 22 When Serug had lived 30 years, he became the father of Nahor.
- 23 After Serug had Nahor, he lived 200 more years and had other sons and daughters.
- 23 And after he became the father of Nahor, Serug lived 200 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 24 When Nahor was twenty-nine years old, he had Terah.
- 24 When Nahor had lived 29 years, he became the father of Terah.

- 25 After Nahor had Terah, he lived 119 more years and had other sons and daughters.
- 25 And after he became the father of Terah, Nahor lived 119 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 26 When Terah was seventy years old, he had Abram, Nahor, and Haran.
- 26 After Terah had lived 70 years, he became the father of Abram, Nahor and Haran.
- 27 This is the story of Terah. Terah had Abram, Nahor, and Haran. Haran had Lot.
- 27 This is the account of Terah. Terah became the father of Abram, Nahor and Haran. And Haran became the father of Lot.
- 28 Haran died before his father, Terah, in the country of his family, Ur of the Chaldees.
- 28 While his father Terah was still alive, Haran died in Ur of the Chaldeans, in the land of his birth.
- 29 Abram and Nahor each got married. Abram's wife was Sarai; Nahor's wife was Milcah, the daughter of his brother Haran. Haran had two daughters, Milcah and Iscah.
- 29 Abram and Nahor both married. The name of Abram's wife was Sarai, and the name of Nahor's wife was Milcah; she was the daughter of Haran, the father of both Milcah and Iscah.
- 30 Sarai was barren; she had no children.
- 30 Now Sarai was barren; she had no children.
- 31 Terah took his son Abram, his grandson Lot (Haran's son), and Sarai his daughter-in-law (his son Abram's wife) and set out with them from Ur of the Chaldees for the land of Canaan. But when they got as far as Haran, they settled down there.
- 31 Terah took his son Abram, his grandson Lot son of Haran, and his daughter-in-law Sarai, the wife of his son Abram, and together they set out from Ur of the Chaldeans to go to Canaan. But when they came to Haran, they settled there.
- 32 Terah lived 205 years. He died in Haran.
- 32 Terah lived 205 years, and he died in Haran.

Genesis 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD told Abram: "Leave your country, your family, and your father's home for a land that I will show you.
- 1 The LORD had said to Abram, "Leave your country, your people and your father's household and go to the land I will show you.
- 2 I'll make you a great nation and bless you. I'll make you famous; you'll be a blessing.
- 2 I will make you into a great nation and I will bless you; I will make your name great, and you will be a blessing.
- 3 I'll bless those who bless you; those who curse you I'll curse. All the families of the Earth will be blessed through you."
- 3 I will bless those who bless you, and whoever curses you I will curse; and all peoples on earth will be blessed through you."
- 4 So Abram left just as GOD said, and Lot left with him. Abram was seventy-five years old when he left Haran.
- 4 So Abram left, as the LORD had told him; and Lot went with him. Abram was seventy-five years old when he set out from Haran.
- 5 Abram took his wife Sarai and his nephew Lot with him, along with all the possessions and people they had gotten in Haran, and set out for the land of Canaan and arrived safe and sound.
- 5 He took his wife Sarai, his nephew Lot, all the possessions they had accumulated and the people they had acquired in Haran, and they set out for the land of Canaan, and they arrived there.
- 6 Abram passed through the country as far as Shechem and the Oak of Moreh. At that time the Canaanites occupied the land.
- 6 Abram traveled through the land as far as the site of the great tree of Moreh at Shechem. At that time the Canaanites were in the land.
- 7 GOD appeared to Abram and said, "I will give this land to your children." Abram built an altar at the place GOD had appeared to him.
- 7 The LORD appeared to Abram and said, "To your offspring I will give this land." So he built an altar there to the LORD, who had appeared to him.
- 8 He moved on from there to the hill country east of Bethel and pitched his tent between Bethel to the west and Ai to the east. He built an altar there and prayed to GOD.

- 8 From there he went on toward the hills east of Bethel and pitched his tent, with Bethel on the west and Ai on the east. There he built an altar to the LORD and called on the name of the LORD.
- 9 Abram kept moving, steadily making his way south, to the Negev.
- 9 Then Abram set out and continued toward the Negev.
- 10 Then a famine came to the land. Abram went down to Egypt to live; it was a hard famine.
- 10 Now there was a famine in the land, and Abram went down to Egypt to live there for a while because the famine was severe.
- 11 As he drew near to Egypt, he said to his wife, Sarai, "Look. We both know that you're a beautiful woman.
- 11 As he was about to enter Egypt, he said to his wife Sarai, "I know what a beautiful woman you are.
- 12 When the Egyptians see you they're going to say, 'Aha! That's his wife!' and kill me. But they'll let you live.
- 12 When the Egyptians see you, they will say, 'This is his wife.' Then they will kill me but will let you live.
- 13 Do me a favor: tell them you're my sister. Because of you, they'll welcome me and let me live."
- 13 Say you are my sister, so that I will be treated well for your sake and my life will be spared because of you."
- 14 When Abram arrived in Egypt, the Egyptians took one look and saw that his wife was stunningly beautiful.
- 14 When Abram came to Egypt, the Egyptians saw that she was a very beautiful woman.
- 15 Pharaoh's princes raved over her to Pharaoh. She was taken to live with Pharaoh.
- 15 And when Pharaoh's officials saw her, they praised her to Pharaoh, and she was taken into his palace.
- 16 Because of her, Abram got along very well: he accumulated sheep and cattle, male and female donkeys, men and women servants, and camels.
- 16 He treated Abram well for her sake, and Abram acquired sheep and cattle, male and female donkeys, menservants and maidservants, and camels.
- 17 But GOD hit Pharaoh hard because of Abram's wife Sarai; everybody in the palace got seriously sick.

- 17 But the LORD inflicted serious diseases on Pharaoh and his household because of Abram's wife Sarai.
- 18 Pharaoh called for Abram, "What's this that you've done to me? Why didn't you tell me that she's your wife?"
- 18 So Pharaoh summoned Abram. "What have you done to me?" he said. "Why didn't you tell me she was your wife?"
- 19 Why did you say, 'She's my sister' so that I'd take her as my wife? Here's your wife back--take her and get out!"
- 19 Why did you say, 'She is my sister,' so that I took her to be my wife? Now then, here is your wife. Take her and go!"
- 20 Pharaoh ordered his men to get Abram out of the country. They sent him and his wife and everything he owned on their way.
- 20 Then Pharaoh gave orders about Abram to his men, and they sent him on his way, with his wife and everything he had.

Genesis 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 So Abram left Egypt and went back to the Negev, he and his wife and everything he owned, and Lot still with him.
- 1 So Abram went up from Egypt to the Negev, with his wife and everything he had, and Lot went with him.
- 2 By now Abram was very rich, loaded with cattle and silver and gold.
- 2 Abram had become very wealthy in livestock and in silver and gold.
- 3 He moved on from the Negev, camping along the way, to Bethel, the place he had first set up his tent between Bethel and Ai
- 3 From the Negev he went from place to place until he came to Bethel, to the place between Bethel and Ai where his tent had been earlier
- 4 and built his first altar. Abram prayed there to GOD.
- 4 and where he had first built an altar. There Abram called on the name of the LORD.
- 5 Lot, who was traveling with Abram, was also rich in sheep and cattle and tents.
- 5 Now Lot, who was moving about with Abram, also had flocks and herds and tents.

- 6 But the land couldn't support both of them; they had too many possessions. They couldn't both live there--
- 6 But the land could not support them while they stayed together, for their possessions were so great that they were not able to stay together.
- 7 quarrels broke out between Abram's shepherds and Lot's shepherds. The Canaanites and Perizzites were also living on the land at the time.
- 7 And quarreling arose between Abram's herdsmen and the herdsmen of Lot. The Canaanites and Perizzites were also living in the land at that time.
- 8 Abram said to Lot, "Let's not have fighting between us, between your shepherds and my shepherds. After all, we're family.
- 8 So Abram said to Lot, "Let's not have any quarreling between you and me, or between your herdsmen and mine, for we are brothers.
- 9 Look around. Isn't there plenty of land out there? Let's separate. If you go left, I'll go right; if you go right, I'll go left."
- 9 Is not the whole land before you? Let's part company. If you go to the left, I'll go to the right; if you go to the right, I'll go to the left."
- 10 Lot looked. He saw the whole plain of the Jordan spread out, well watered (this was before GOD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah), like GOD's garden, like Egypt, and stretching all the way to Zoar.
- 10 Lot looked up and saw that the whole plain of the Jordan was well watered, like the garden of the LORD, like the land of Egypt, toward Zoar. (This was before the LORD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah.)
- 11 Lot took the whole plain of the Jordan. Lot set out to the east. That's how they came to part company, uncle and nephew.
- 11 So Lot chose for himself the whole plain of the Jordan and set out toward the east. The two men parted company:
- 12 Abram settled in Canaan; Lot settled in the cities of the plain and pitched his tent near Sodom.
- 12 Abram lived in the land of Canaan, while Lot lived among the cities of the plain and pitched his tents near Sodom.
- 13 The people of Sodom were evil--flagrant sinners against GOD.
- 13 Now the men of Sodom were wicked and were sinning greatly against the LORD.
- 14 After Lot separated from him, GOD said to Abram, "Open your eyes, look around. Look north, south, east, and west.

- 14 The LORD said to Abram after Lot had parted from him, "Lift up your eyes from where you are and look north and south, east and west.
- 15 Everything you see, the whole land spread out before you, I will give to you and your children forever.
- 15 All the land that you see I will give to you and your offspring forever.
- 16 I'll make your descendants like dust--counting your descendants will be as impossible as counting the dust of the Earth.
- 16 I will make your offspring like the dust of the earth, so that if anyone could count the dust, then your offspring could be counted.
- 17 So--on your feet, get moving! Walk through the country, its length and breadth; I'm giving it all to you."
- 17 Go, walk through the length and breadth of the land, for I am giving it to you."
- 18 Abram moved his tent. He went and settled by the Oaks of Mamre in Hebron. There he built an altar to GOD.
- 18 So Abram moved his tents and went to live near the great trees of Mamre at Hebron, where he built an altar to the LORD.

Genesis 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then this: Amraphel king of Shinar, Arioch king of Ellasar, Kedorlaomer king of Elam, and Tidal king of Goiim
- 1 At this time Amraphel king of Shinar, Arioch king of Ellasar, Kedorlaomer king of Elam and Tidal king of Goiim
- 2 went off to war to fight Bera king of Sodom, Birsha king of Gomorrah, Shinab king of Admah, Shemeber king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela, that is, Zoar.
- 2 went to war against Bera king of Sodom, Birsha king of Gomorrah, Shinab king of Admah, Shemeber king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela (that is, Zoar).
- 3 This second group of kings, the attacked, came together at the Valley of Siddim, that is, the Salt Sea.
- 3 All these latter kings joined forces in the Valley of Siddim (the Salt Sea).

- 4 They had been under the thumb of Kedorlaomer for twelve years. In the thirteenth year, they revolted.
- 4 For twelve years they had been subject to Kedorlaomer, but in the thirteenth year they rebelled.
- 5 In the fourteenth year, Kedorlaomer and the kings allied with him set out and defeated the Rephaim in Ashteroth Karnaim, the Zuzim in Ham, the Emim in Shaveh Kiriathaim,
- 5 In the fourteenth year, Kedorlaomer and the kings allied with him went out and defeated the Rephaites in Ashteroth Karnaim, the Zuzites in Ham, the Emmites in Shaveh Kiriathaim
- 6 and the Horites in their hill country of Seir as far as El Paran on the far edge of the desert.
- 6 and the Horites in the hill country of Seir, as far as El Paran near the desert.
- 7 On their way back they stopped at En Mishpat, that is, Kadesh, and conquered the whole region of the Amalekites as well as that of the Amorites who lived in Hazazon Tamar.
- 7 Then they turned back and went to En Mishpat (that is, Kadesh), and they conquered the whole territory of the Amalekites, as well as the Amorites who were living in Hazazon Tamar.
- 8 That's when the king of Sodom marched out with the king of Gomorrah, the king of Admah, the king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela, that is, Zoar. They drew up in battle formation against their enemies in the Valley of Siddim--
- 8 Then the king of Sodom, the king of Gomorrah, the king of Admah, the king of Zeboiim and the king of Bela (that is, Zoar) marched out and drew up their battle lines in the Valley of Siddim
- 9 against Kedorlaomer king of Elam, Tidal king of Goiim, Amraphel king of Shinar, and Arioch king of Ellasar, four kings against five.
- 9 against Kedorlaomer king of Elam, Tidal king of Goiim, Amraphel king of Shinar and Arioch king of Ellasar--four kings against five.
- 10 The Valley of Siddim was full of tar pits. When the kings of Sodom and Gomorrah fled, they fell into the tar pits, but the rest escaped into the mountains.
- 10 Now the Valley of Siddim was full of tar pits, and when the kings of Sodom and Gomorrah fled, some of the men fell into them and the rest

fled to the hills.

- 11 The four kings captured all the possessions of Sodom and Gomorrah, all their food and equipment, and went on their way.
- 11 The four kings seized all the goods of Sodom and Gomorrah and all their food; then they went away.
- 12 They captured Lot, Abram's nephew who was living in Sodom at the time, taking everything he owned with them.
- 12 They also carried off Abram's nephew Lot and his possessions, since he was living in Sodom.
- 13 A fugitive came and reported to Abram the Hebrew. Abram was living at the Oaks of Mamre the Amorite, brother of Eshcol and Aner. They were allies of Abram.
- 13 One who had escaped came and reported this to Abram the Hebrew. Now Abram was living near the great trees of Mamre the Amorite, a brother of Eshcol and Aner, all of whom were allied with Abram.
- 14 When Abram heard that his nephew had been taken prisoner, he lined up his servants, all of them born in his household--there were 318 of them--and chased after the captors all the way to Dan.
- 14 When Abram heard that his relative had been taken captive, he called out the 318 trained men born in his household and went in pursuit as far as Dan.
- 15 Abram and his men split into small groups and attacked by night. They chased them as far as Hobah, just north of Damascus.
- 15 During the night Abram divided his men to attack them and he routed them, pursuing them as far as Hobah, north of Damascus.
- 16 They recovered all the plunder along with nephew Lot and his possessions, including the women and the people.
- 16 He recovered all the goods and brought back his relative Lot and his possessions, together with the women and the other people.
- 17 After Abram returned from defeating Kedorlaomer and his allied kings, the king of Sodom came out to greet him in the Valley of Shaveh, the King's Valley.
- 17 After Abram returned from defeating Kedorlaomer and the kings allied with him, the king of Sodom came out to meet him in the Valley of Shaveh (that is, the King's Valley).

- 18 Melchizedek, king of Salem, brought out bread and wine--he was priest of The High God--
- 18 Then Melchizedek king of Salem brought out bread and wine. He was priest of God Most High,
- 19 and blessed him: Blessed be Abram by The High God, Creator of Heaven and Earth.
- 19 and he blessed Abram, saying, "Blessed be Abram by God Most High, Creator of heaven and earth.
- 20 And blessed be The High God, who handed your enemies over to you. Abram gave him a tenth of all the recovered plunder.
- 20 And blessed be God Most High, who delivered your enemies into your hand." Then Abram gave him a tenth of everything.
- 21 The king of Sodom said to Abram, "Give me back the people but keep all the plunder for yourself."
- 21 The king of Sodom said to Abram, "Give me the people and keep the goods for yourself."
- 22 But Abram told the king of Sodom, "I swear to GOD, The High God, Creator of Heaven and Earth, this solemn oath,
- 22 But Abram said to the king of Sodom, "I have raised my hand to the LORD, God Most High, Creator of heaven and earth, and have taken an oath
- 23 that I'll take nothing from you, not so much as a thread or a shoestring. I'm not going to have you go around saying, 'I made Abram rich.'
- 23 that I will accept nothing belonging to you, not even a thread or the thong of a sandal, so that you will never be able to say, 'I made Abram rich.'
- 24 Nothing for me other than what the young men ate and the share of the men who went with me, Aner, Eshcol, and Mamre; they're to get their share of the plunder."
- 24 I will accept nothing but what my men have eaten and the share that belongs to the men who went with me--to Aner, Eshcol and Mamre. Let them have their share."

Genesis 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 After all these things, this word of GOD came to Abram in a vision:
"Don't be afraid, Abram. I'm your shield. Your reward will be grand!"
- 1 After this, the word of the LORD came to Abram in a vision: "Do not be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your very great reward. "
- 2 Abram said, "GOD, Master, what use are your gifts as long as I'm childless and Eliezer of Damascus is going to inherit everything?"
- 2 But Abram said, "O Sovereign LORD, what can you give me since I remain childless and the one who will inherit my estate is Eliezer of Damascus?"
- 3 Abram continued, "See, you've given me no children, and now a mere house servant is going to get it all."
- 3 And Abram said, "You have given me no children; so a servant in my household will be my heir."
- 4 Then GOD's Message came: "Don't worry, he won't be your heir; a son from your body will be your heir."
- 4 Then the word of the LORD came to him: "This man will not be your heir, but a son coming from your own body will be your heir."
- 5 Then he took him outside and said, "Look at the sky. Count the stars. Can you do it? Count your descendants! You're going to have a big family, Abram!"
- 5 He took him outside and said, "Look up at the heavens and count the stars--if indeed you can count them." Then he said to him, "So shall your offspring be."
- 6 And he believed! Believed GOD! God declared him "Set-Right-with-God."
- 6 Abram believed the LORD, and he credited it to him as righteousness.
- 7 GOD continued, "I'm the same GOD who brought you from Ur of the Chaldees and gave you this land to own."
- 7 He also said to him, "I am the LORD, who brought you out of Ur of the Chaldeans to give you this land to take possession of it."
- 8 Abram said, "Master GOD, how am I to know this, that it will all be mine?"
- 8 But Abram said, "O Sovereign LORD, how can I know that I will gain possession of it?"

- 9 GOD said, "Bring me a heifer, a goat, and a ram, each three years old, and a dove and a young pigeon."
- 9 So the LORD said to him, "Bring me a heifer, a goat and a ram, each three years old, along with a dove and a young pigeon."
- 10 He brought all these animals to him, split them down the middle, and laid the halves opposite each other. But he didn't split the birds.
- 10 Abram brought all these to him, cut them in two and arranged the halves opposite each other; the birds, however, he did not cut in half.
- 11 Vultures swooped down on the carcasses, but Abram scared them off.
- 11 Then birds of prey came down on the carcasses, but Abram drove them away.
- 12 As the sun went down a deep sleep overcame Abram and then a sense of dread, dark and heavy.
- 12 As the sun was setting, Abram fell into a deep sleep, and a thick and dreadful darkness came over him.
- 13 GOD said to Abram, "Know this: your descendants will live as outsiders in a land not theirs; they'll be enslaved and beaten down for 400 years.
- 13 Then the LORD said to him, "Know for certain that your descendants will be strangers in a country not their own, and they will be enslaved and mistreated four hundred years.
- 14 Then I'll punish their slave masters; your offspring will march out of there loaded with plunder.
- 14 But I will punish the nation they serve as slaves, and afterward they will come out with great possessions.
- 15 But not you; you'll have a long and full life and die a good and peaceful death.
- 15 You, however, will go to your fathers in peace and be buried at a good old age.
- 16 Not until the fourth generation will your descendants return here; sin is still a thriving business among the Amorites."
- 16 In the fourth generation your descendants will come back here, for the sin of the Amorites has not yet reached its full measure."
- 17 When the sun was down and it was dark, a smoking firepot and a flaming torch moved between the split carcasses.

- 17 When the sun had set and darkness had fallen, a smoking firepot with a blazing torch appeared and passed between the pieces.
- 18 That's when GOD made a covenant with Abram: "I'm giving this land to your children, from the Nile River in Egypt to the River Euphrates in Assyria--
- 18 On that day the LORD made a covenant with Abram and said, "To your descendants I give this land, from the river of Egypt to the great river, the Euphrates--
- 19 the country of the Kenites, Kenizzites, Kadmonites,
- 19 the land of the Kenites, Kenizzites, Kadmonites,
- 20 Hittites, Perizzites, Rephaim,
- 20 Hittites, Perizzites, Rephaites,
- 21 Amorites, Canaanites, Girgashites, and Jebusites."
- 21 Amorites, Canaanites, Girgashites and Jebusites."

Genesis 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 Sarai, Abram's wife, hadn't yet produced a child. She had an Egyptian maid named Hagar.
- 1 Now Sarai, Abram's wife, had borne him no children. But she had an Egyptian maidservant named Hagar;
- 2 Sarai said to Abram, "GOD has not seen fit to let me have a child. Sleep with my maid. Maybe I can get a family from her." Abram agreed to do what Sarai said.
- 2 so she said to Abram, "The LORD has kept me from having children. Go, sleep with my maidservant; perhaps I can build a family through her." Abram agreed to what Sarai said.
- 3 So Sarai, Abram's wife, took her Egyptian maid Hagar and gave her to her husband Abram as a wife. Abram had been living ten years in Canaan when this took place.
- 3 So after Abram had been living in Canaan ten years, Sarai his wife took her Egyptian maidservant Hagar and gave her to her husband to be his wife.

- 4 He slept with Hagar and she got pregnant. When she learned she was pregnant, she looked down on her mistress.
- 4 He slept with Hagar, and she conceived. When she knew she was pregnant, she began to despise her mistress.
- 5 Sarai told Abram, "It's all your fault that I'm suffering this abuse. I put my maid in bed with you and the minute she knows she's pregnant, she treats me like I'm nothing. May GOD decide which of us is right."
- 5 Then Sarai said to Abram, "You are responsible for the wrong I am suffering. I put my servant in your arms, and now that she knows she is pregnant, she despises me. May the LORD judge between you and me."
- 6 "You decide," said Abram. "Your maid is your business." Sarai was abusive to Hagar and she ran away.
- 6 Your servant is in your hands, Abram said. "Do with her whatever you think best." Then Sarai mistreated Hagar; so she fled from her.
- 7 An angel of GOD found her beside a spring in the desert; it was the spring on the road to Shur.
- 7 The angel of the LORD found Hagar near a spring in the desert; it was the spring that is beside the road to Shur.
- 8 He said, "Hagar, maid of Sarai, what are you doing here?" She said, "I'm running away from Sarai my mistress."
- 8 And he said, "Hagar, servant of Sarai, where have you come from, and where are you going?" "I'm running away from my mistress Sarai," she answered.
- 9 The angel of GOD said, "Go back to your mistress. Put up with her abuse."
- 9 Then the angel of the LORD told her, "Go back to your mistress and submit to her."
- 10 He continued, "I'm going to give you a big family, children past counting.
- 10 The angel added, "I will so increase your descendants that they will be too numerous to count."
- 11 From this pregnancy, you'll get a son: Name him Ishmael; for GOD heard you, GOD answered you.
- 11 The angel of the LORD also said to her: "You are now with child and you will have a son. You shall name him Ishmael, for the LORD has heard of your misery.

- 12 He'll be a bucking bronco of a man, a real fighter, fighting and being fought, Always stirring up trouble, always at odds with his family."
- 12 He will be a wild donkey of a man; his hand will be against everyone and everyone's hand against him, and he will live in hostility toward all his brothers."
- 13 She answered GOD by name, praying to the God who spoke to her, "You're the God who sees me!" "Yes! He saw me; and then I saw him!"
- 13 She gave this name to the LORD who spoke to her: "You are the God who sees me," for she said, "I have now seen the One who sees me."
- 14 That's how that desert spring got named "God-Alive-Sees-Me Spring." That spring is still there, between Kadesh and Bered.
- 14 That is why the well was called Beer Lahai Roi; it is still there, between Kadesh and Bered.
- 15 Hagar gave Abram a son. Abram named him Ishmael.
- 15 So Hagar bore Abram a son, and Abram gave the name Ishmael to the son she had borne.
- 16 Abram was eighty-six years old when Hagar gave him his son, Ishmael.
- 16 Abram was eighty-six years old when Hagar bore him Ishmael.

Genesis 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 When Abram was ninety-nine years old, GOD showed up and said to him, "I am The Strong God, live entirely before me, live to the hilt!
- 1 When Abram was ninety-nine years old, the LORD appeared to him and said, "I am God Almighty; walk before me and be blameless.
- 2 I'll make a covenant between us and I'll give you a huge family."
- 2 I will confirm my covenant between me and you and will greatly increase your numbers."
- 3 Overwhelmed, Abram fell flat on his face. Then God said to him,
- 3 Abram fell facedown, and God said to him,
- 4 "This is my covenant with you: You'll be the father of many nations.
- 4 As for me, this is my covenant with you: You will be the father of many nations.

- 5 Your name will no longer be Abram, but Abraham, meaning that 'I'm making you the father of many nations.'
- 5 No longer will you be called Abram; your name will be Abraham, for I have made you a father of many nations.
- 6 I'll make you a father of fathers--I'll make nations from you, kings will issue from you.
- 6 I will make you very fruitful; I will make nations of you, and kings will come from you.
- 7 I'm establishing my covenant between me and you, a covenant that includes your descendants, a covenant that goes on and on and on, a covenant that commits me to be your God and the God of your descendants.
- 7 I will establish my covenant as an everlasting covenant between me and you and your descendants after you for the generations to come, to be your God and the God of your descendants after you.
- 8 And I'm giving you and your descendants this land where you're now just camping, this whole country of Canaan, to own forever. And I'll be their God."
- 8 The whole land of Canaan, where you are now an alien, I will give as an everlasting possession to you and your descendants after you; and I will be their God."
- 9 God continued to Abraham, "And you: You will honor my covenant, you and your descendants, generation after generation.
- 9 Then God said to Abraham, "As for you, you must keep my covenant, you and your descendants after you for the generations to come.
- 10 This is the covenant that you are to honor, the covenant that pulls in all your descendants: Circumcise every male.
- 10 This is my covenant with you and your descendants after you, the covenant you are to keep: Every male among you shall be circumcised.
- 11 Circumcise by cutting off the foreskin of the penis; it will be the sign of the covenant between us.
- 11 You are to undergo circumcision, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and you.
- 12 Every male baby will be circumcised when he is eight days old, generation after generation--this includes house-born slaves and slaves bought from outsiders who are not blood kin.

- 12 For the generations to come every male among you who is eight days old must be circumcised, including those born in your household or bought with money from a foreigner--those who are not your offspring.
- 13 Make sure you circumcise both your own children and anyone brought in from the outside. That way my covenant will be cut into your body, a permanent mark of my permanent covenant.
- 13 Whether born in your household or bought with your money, they must be circumcised. My covenant in your flesh is to be an everlasting covenant.
- 14 An uncircumcised male, one who has not had the foreskin of his penis cut off, will be cut off from his people--he has broken my covenant."
- 14 Any uncircumcised male, who has not been circumcised in the flesh, will be cut off from his people; he has broken my covenant."
- 15 God continued speaking to Abraham, "And Sarai your wife: Don't call her Sarai any longer; call her Sarah.
- 15 God also said to Abraham, "As for Sarai your wife, you are no longer to call her Sarai; her name will be Sarah.
- 16 I'll bless her--yes! I'll give you a son by her! Oh, how I'll bless her! Nations will come from her; kings of nations will come from her."
- 16 I will bless her and will surely give you a son by her. I will bless her so that she will be the mother of nations; kings of peoples will come from her."
- 17 Abraham fell flat on his face. And then he laughed, thinking, "Can a hundred-year-old man father a son? And can Sarah, at ninety years, have a baby?"
- 17 Abraham fell facedown; he laughed and said to himself, "Will a son be born to a man a hundred years old? Will Sarah bear a child at the age of ninety?"
- 18 Recovering, Abraham said to God, "Oh, keep Ishmael alive and well before you!"
- 18 And Abraham said to God, "If only Ishmael might live under your blessing!"
- 19 But God said, "That's not what I mean. Your wife, Sarah, will have a baby, a son. Name him Isaac (Laughter). I'll establish my covenant with him and his descendants, a covenant that lasts forever.

- 19 Then God said, "Yes, but your wife Sarah will bear you a son, and you will call him Isaac. I will establish my covenant with him as an everlasting covenant for his descendants after him.
- 20 "And Ishmael? Yes, I heard your prayer for him. I'll also bless him; I'll make sure he has plenty of children--a huge family. He'll father twelve princes; I'll make him a great nation.
- 20 And as for Ishmael, I have heard you: I will surely bless him; I will make him fruitful and will greatly increase his numbers. He will be the father of twelve rulers, and I will make him into a great nation.
- 21 But I'll establish my covenant with Isaac whom Sarah will give you about this time next year."
- 21 But my covenant I will establish with Isaac, whom Sarah will bear to you by this time next year."
- 22 God finished speaking with Abraham and left.
- 22 When he had finished speaking with Abraham, God went up from him.
- 23 Then Abraham took his son Ishmael and all his servants, whether houseborn or purchased--every male in his household--and circumcised them, cutting off their foreskins that very day, just as God had told him.
- 23 On that very day Abraham took his son Ishmael and all those born in his household or bought with his money, every male in his household, and circumcised them, as God told him.
- 24 Abraham was ninety-nine years old when he was circumcised.
- 24 Abraham was ninety-nine years old when he was circumcised,
- 25 His son Ishmael was thirteen years old when he was circumcised.
- 25 and his son Ishmael was thirteen;
- 26 Abraham and Ishmael were circumcised the same day
- 26 Abraham and his son Ishmael were both circumcised on that same day.
- 27 together with all the servants of his household, those born there and those purchased from outsiders--all were circumcised with him.
- 27 And every male in Abraham's household, including those born in his household or bought from a foreigner, was circumcised with him.

Genesis 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD appeared to Abraham at the Oaks of Mamre while he was sitting at the entrance of his tent. It was the hottest part of the day.
- 1 The LORD appeared to Abraham near the great trees of Mamre while he was sitting at the entrance to his tent in the heat of the day.
- 2 He looked up and saw three men standing. He ran from his tent to greet them and bowed before them.
- 2 Abraham looked up and saw three men standing nearby. When he saw them, he hurried from the entrance of his tent to meet them and bowed low to the ground.
- 3 He said, "Master, if it please you, stop for a while with your servant.
- 3 He said, "If I have found favor in your eyes, my lord, do not pass your servant by.
- 4 I'll get some water so you can wash your feet. Rest under this tree.
- 4 Let a little water be brought, and then you may all wash your feet and rest under this tree.
- 5 I'll get some food to refresh you on your way, since your travels have brought you across my path." They said, "Certainly. Go ahead."
- 5 Let me get you something to eat, so you can be refreshed and then go on your way--now that you have come to your servant." "Very well," they answered, "do as you say."
- 6 Abraham hurried into the tent to Sarah. He said, "Hurry. Get three cups of our best flour; knead it and make bread."
- 6 So Abraham hurried into the tent to Sarah. "Quick," he said, "get three seahs of fine flour and knead it and bake some bread."
- 7 Then Abraham ran to the cattle pen and picked out a nice plump calf and gave it to the servant who lost no time getting it ready.
- 7 Then he ran to the herd and selected a choice, tender calf and gave it to a servant, who hurried to prepare it.
- 8 Then he got curds and milk, brought them with the calf that had been roasted, set the meal before the men, and stood there under the tree while they ate.
- 8 He then brought some curds and milk and the calf that had been prepared, and set these before them. While they ate, he stood near them under a tree.
- 9 The men said to him, "Where is Sarah your wife?" He said, "In the tent."
- 9 Where is your wife Sarah? they asked him. "There, in the tent," he said.

- 10 One of them said, "I'm coming back about this time next year. When I arrive, your wife Sarah will have a son." Sarah was listening at the tent opening, just behind the man.
- 10 Then the LORD said, "I will surely return to you about this time next year, and Sarah your wife will have a son." Now Sarah was listening at the entrance to the tent, which was behind him.
- 11 Abraham and Sarah were old by this time, very old. Sarah was far past the age for having babies.
- 11 Abraham and Sarah were already old and well advanced in years, and Sarah was past the age of childbearing.
- 12 Sarah laughed within herself, "An old woman like me? Get pregnant? With this old man of a husband?"
- 12 So Sarah laughed to herself as she thought, "After I am worn out and my master is old, will I now have this pleasure?"
- 13 GOD said to Abraham, "Why did Sarah laugh saying, 'Me? Have a baby? An old woman like me?'"
- 13 Then the LORD said to Abraham, "Why did Sarah laugh and say, 'Will I really have a child, now that I am old?'"
- 14 Is anything too hard for GOD? I'll be back about this time next year and Sarah will have a baby."
- 14 Is anything too hard for the LORD? I will return to you at the appointed time next year and Sarah will have a son."
- 15 Sarah lied. She said, "I didn't laugh," because she was afraid. But he said, "Yes you did; you laughed."
- 15 Sarah was afraid, so she lied and said, "I did not laugh." But he said, "Yes, you did laugh."
- 16 When the men got up to leave, they set off for Sodom. Abraham walked with them to say good-bye.
- 16 When the men got up to leave, they looked down toward Sodom, and Abraham walked along with them to see them on their way.
- 17 Then GOD said, "Shall I keep back from Abraham what I'm about to do?"
- 17 Then the LORD said, "Shall I hide from Abraham what I am about to do?"
- 18 Abraham is going to become a large and strong nation; all the nations of the world are going to find themselves blessed through him.

- 18 Abraham will surely become a great and powerful nation, and all nations on earth will be blessed through him.
- 19 Yes, I've settled on him as the one to train his children and future family to observe GOD's way of life, live kindly and generously and fairly, so that GOD can complete in Abraham what he promised him."
- 19 For I have chosen him, so that he will direct his children and his household after him to keep the way of the LORD by doing what is right and just, so that the LORD will bring about for Abraham what he has promised him."
- 20 GOD continued, "The cries of the victims in Sodom and Gomorrah are deafening; the sin of those cities is immense.
- 20 Then the LORD said, "The outcry against Sodom and Gomorrah is so great and their sin so grievous
- 21 I'm going down to see for myself, see if what they're doing is as bad as it sounds. Then I'll know."
- 21 that I will go down and see if what they have done is as bad as the outcry that has reached me. If not, I will know."
- 22 The men set out for Sodom, but Abraham stood in GOD's path, blocking his way.
- 22 The men turned away and went toward Sodom, but Abraham remained standing before the LORD.
- 23 Abraham confronted him, "Are you serious? Are you planning on getting rid of the good people right along with the bad?
- 23 Then Abraham approached him and said: "Will you sweep away the righteous with the wicked?
- 24 What if there are fifty decent people left in the city; will you lump the good with the bad and get rid of the lot?
- 24 What if there are fifty righteous people in the city? Will you really sweep it away and not spare the place for the sake of the fifty righteous people in it?
- 25 Wouldn't you spare the city for the sake of those fifty innocents? I can't believe you'd do that, kill off the good and the bad alike as if there were no difference between them. Doesn't the Judge of all the Earth judge with justice?"
- 25 Far be it from you to do such a thing--to kill the righteous with the wicked, treating the righteous and the wicked alike. Far be it from you!

- Will not the Judge of all the earth do right?"
- 26 GOD said, "If I find fifty decent people in the city of Sodom, I'll spare the place just for them."
- 26 The LORD said, "If I find fifty righteous people in the city of Sodom, I will spare the whole place for their sake."
- 27 Abraham came back, "Do I, a mere mortal made from a handful of dirt, dare open my mouth again to my Master?"
- 27 Then Abraham spoke up again: "Now that I have been so bold as to speak to the Lord, though I am nothing but dust and ashes,
- 28 What if the fifty fall short by five--would you destroy the city because of those missing five?" He said, "I won't destroy it if there are forty-five."
- 28 what if the number of the righteous is five less than fifty? Will you destroy the whole city because of five people?" "If I find forty-five there," he said, "I will not destroy it."
- 29 Abraham spoke up again, "What if you only find forty?" "Neither will I destroy it if for forty."
- 29 Once again he spoke to him, "What if only forty are found there?" He said, "For the sake of forty, I will not do it."
- 30 He said, "Master, don't be irritated with me, but what if only thirty are found?" "No, I won't do it if I find thirty."
- 30 Then he said, "May the Lord not be angry, but let me speak. What if only thirty can be found there?" He answered, "I will not do it if I find thirty there."
- 31 He pushed on, "I know I'm trying your patience, Master, but how about for twenty?" "I won't destroy it for twenty."
- 31 Abraham said, "Now that I have been so bold as to speak to the Lord, what if only twenty can be found there?" He said, "For the sake of twenty, I will not destroy it."
- 32 He wouldn't quit, "Don't get angry, Master--this is the last time. What if you only come up with ten?" "For the sake of only ten, I won't destroy the city."
- 32 Then he said, "May the Lord not be angry, but let me speak just once more. What if only ten can be found there?" He answered, "For the sake of ten, I will not destroy it."

33 When GOD finished talking with Abraham, he left. And Abraham went home.

33 When the LORD had finished speaking with Abraham, he left, and Abraham returned home.

Genesis 19

MSG

NIV

1 The two angels arrived at Sodom in the evening. Lot was sitting at the city gate. He saw them and got up to welcome them, bowing before them

1 The two angels arrived at Sodom in the evening, and Lot was sitting in the gateway of the city. When he saw them, he got up to meet them and bowed down with his face to the ground.

2 and said, "Please, my friends, come to my house and stay the night. Wash up. You can rise early and be on your way refreshed." They said, "No, we'll sleep in the street."

2 My lords, he said, "please turn aside to your servant's house. You can wash your feet and spend the night and then go on your way early in the morning." "No," they answered, "we will spend the night in the square."

3 But he insisted, wouldn't take no for an answer; and they relented and went home with him. Lot fixed a hot meal for them and they ate.

3 But he insisted so strongly that they did go with him and entered his house. He prepared a meal for them, baking bread without yeast, and they ate.

4 Before they went to bed men from all over the city of Sodom, young and old, descended on the house from all sides and boxed them in.

4 Before they had gone to bed, all the men from every part of the city of Sodom--both young and old--surrounded the house.

5 They yelled to Lot, "Where are the men who are staying with you for the night? Bring them out so we can have our sport with them!"

5 They called to Lot, "Where are the men who came to you tonight? Bring them out to us so that we can have sex with them."

6 Lot went out, barring the door behind him,

6 Lot went outside to meet them and shut the door behind him

7 and said, "Brothers, please, don't be vile!

- 7 and said, "No, my friends. Don't do this wicked thing.
- 8 Look, I have two daughters, virgins; let me bring them out; you can take your pleasure with them, but don't touch these men--they're my guests."
- 8 Look, I have two daughters who have never slept with a man. Let me bring them out to you, and you can do what you like with them. But don't do anything to these men, for they have come under the protection of my roof."
- 9 They said, "Get lost! You drop in from nowhere and now you're going to tell us how to run our lives. We'll treat you worse than them!" And they charged past Lot to break down the door.
- 9 Get out of our way, they replied. And they said, "This fellow came here as an alien, and now he wants to play the judge! We'll treat you worse than them." They kept bringing pressure on Lot and moved forward to break down the door.
- 10 But the two men reached out and pulled Lot inside the house, locking the door.
- 10 But the men inside reached out and pulled Lot back into the house and shut the door.
- 11 Then they struck blind the men who were trying to break down the door, both leaders and followers, leaving them groping in the dark.
- 11 Then they struck the men who were at the door of the house, young and old, with blindness so that they could not find the door.
- 12 The two men said to Lot, "Do you have any other family here? Sons, daughters--anybody in the city? Get them out of here, and now!
- 12 The two men said to Lot, "Do you have anyone else here-- sons-in-law, sons or daughters, or anyone else in the city who belongs to you? Get them out of here,
- 13 We're going to destroy this place. The outcries of victims here to GOD are deafening; we've been sent to blast this place into oblivion."
- 13 because we are going to destroy this place. The outcry to the LORD against its people is so great that he has sent us to destroy it."
- 14 Lot went out and warned the fiancés of his daughters, "Evacuate this place; GOD is about to destroy this city!" But his daughters' would-be husbands treated it as a joke.
- 14 So Lot went out and spoke to his sons-in-law, who were pledged to marry his daughters. He said, "Hurry and get out of this place, because

the LORD is about to destroy the city!" But his sons- in-law thought he was joking.

15 At break of day, the angels pushed Lot to get going, "Hurry. Get your wife and two daughters out of here before it's too late and you're caught in the punishment of the city."

15 With the coming of dawn, the angels urged Lot, saying, "Hurry! Take your wife and your two daughters who are here, or you will be swept away when the city is punished."

16 Lot was dragging his feet. The men grabbed Lot's arm, and the arms of his wife and daughters--GOD was so merciful to them!--and dragged them to safety outside the city.

16 When he hesitated, the men grasped his hand and the hands of his wife and of his two daughters and led them safely out of the city, for the LORD was merciful to them.

17 When they had them outside, Lot was told, "Now run for your life! Don't look back! Don't stop anywhere on the plain--run for the hills or you'll be swept away."

17 As soon as they had brought them out, one of them said, "Flee for your lives! Don't look back, and don't stop anywhere in the plain! Flee to the mountains or you will be swept away!"

18 But Lot protested, "No, masters, you can't mean it!

18 But Lot said to them, "No, my lords, please!

19 I know that you've taken a liking to me and have done me an immense favor in saving my life, but I can't run for the mountains--who knows what terrible thing might happen to me in the mountains and leave me for dead.

19 Your servant has found favor in your eyes, and you have shown great kindness to me in sparing my life. But I can't flee to the mountains; this disaster will overtake me, and I'll die.

20 Look over there--that town is close enough to get to. It's a small town, hardly anything to it. Let me escape there and save my life--it's a mere wide place in the road."

20 Look, here is a town near enough to run to, and it is small. Let me flee to it--it is very small, isn't it? Then my life will be spared."

21 He said to him, "All right. If you insist. I'll let you have your way. And I won't stamp out the town you've spotted.

- 21 He said to him, "Very well, I will grant this request too; I will not overthrow the town you speak of.
- 22 But hurry up. Run for it! I can't do anything until you get there." That's why the town was called Zoar, that is, Smalltown.
- 22 But flee there quickly, because I cannot do anything until you reach it." (That is why the town was called Zoar.)
- 23 The sun was high in the sky when Lot arrived at Zoar.
- 23 By the time Lot reached Zoar, the sun had risen over the land.
- 24 Then GOD rained brimstone and fire down on Sodom and Gomorrah--a river of lava from GOD out of the sky!--
- 24 Then the LORD rained down burning sulfur on Sodom and Gomorrah--from the LORD out of the heavens.
- 25 and destroyed these cities and the entire plain and everyone who lived in the cities and everything that grew from the ground.
- 25 Thus he overthrew those cities and the entire plain, including all those living in the cities--and also the vegetation in the land.
- 26 But Lot's wife looked back and turned into a pillar of salt.
- 26 But Lot's wife looked back, and she became a pillar of salt.
- 27 Abraham got up early the next morning and went to the place he had so recently stood with GOD.
- 27 Early the next morning Abraham got up and returned to the place where he had stood before the LORD.
- 28 He looked out over Sodom and Gomorrah, surveying the whole plain. All he could see was smoke belching from the Earth, like smoke from a furnace.
- 28 He looked down toward Sodom and Gomorrah, toward all the land of the plain, and he saw dense smoke rising from the land, like smoke from a furnace.
- 29 And that's the story: When God destroyed the Cities of the Plain, he was mindful of Abraham and first got Lot out of there before he blasted those cities off the face of the Earth.
- 29 So when God destroyed the cities of the plain, he remembered Abraham, and he brought Lot out of the catastrophe that overthrew the cities where Lot had lived.
- 30 Lot left Zoar and went into the mountains to live with his two daughters; he was afraid to stay in Zoar. He lived in a cave with his

daughters.

- 30 Lot and his two daughters left Zoar and settled in the mountains, for he was afraid to stay in Zoar. He and his two daughters lived in a cave.
- 31 One day the older daughter said to the younger, "Our father is getting old and there's not a man left in the country by whom we can get pregnant.
- 31 One day the older daughter said to the younger, "Our father is old, and there is no man around here to lie with us, as is the custom all over the earth.
- 32 Let's get our father drunk with wine and lie with him. We'll get children through our father--it's our only chance to keep our family alive."
- 32 Let's get our father to drink wine and then lie with him and preserve our family line through our father."
- 33 They got their father drunk with wine that very night. The older daughter went and lay with him. He was oblivious, knowing nothing of what she did.
- 33 That night they got their father to drink wine, and the older daughter went in and lay with him. He was not aware of it when she lay down or when she got up.
- 34 The next morning the older said to the younger, "Last night I slept with my father. Tonight, it's your turn. We'll get him drunk again and then you sleep with him. We'll both get a child through our father and keep our family alive."
- 34 The next day the older daughter said to the younger, "Last night I lay with my father. Let's get him to drink wine again tonight, and you go in and lie with him so we can preserve our family line through our father."
- 35 So that night they got their father drunk again and the younger went in and slept with him. Again he was oblivious, knowing nothing of what she did.
- 35 So they got their father to drink wine that night also, and the younger daughter went and lay with him. Again he was not aware of it when she lay down or when she got up.
- 36 Both daughters became pregnant by their father, Lot.
- 36 So both of Lot's daughters became pregnant by their father.
- 37 The older daughter had a son and named him Moab, the ancestor of the present-day Moabites.

37 The older daughter had a son, and she named him Moab; he is the father of the Moabites of today.

38 The younger daughter had a son and named him Ben-Ammi, the ancestor of the present-day Ammonites.

38 The younger daughter also had a son, and she named him Ben-Ammi; he is the father of the Ammonites of today.

Genesis 20

MSG

NIV

1 Abraham traveled from there south to the Negev and settled down between Kadesh and Shur. While he was camping in Gerar,

1 Now Abraham moved on from there into the region of the Negev and lived between Kadesh and Shur. For a while he stayed in Gerar,

2 Abraham said of his wife Sarah, "She's my sister." So Abimelech, king of Gerar, sent for Sarah and took her.

2 and there Abraham said of his wife Sarah, "She is my sister." Then Abimelech king of Gerar sent for Sarah and took her.

3 But God came to Abimelech in a dream that night and told him, "You're as good as dead--that woman you took, she's a married woman."

3 But God came to Abimelech in a dream one night and said to him, "You are as good as dead because of the woman you have taken; she is a married woman."

4 Now Abimelech had not yet slept with her, hadn't so much as touched her. He said, "Master, would you kill an innocent man?"

4 Now Abimelech had not gone near her, so he said, "Lord, will you destroy an innocent nation?"

5 Didn't he tell me, 'She's my sister'? And didn't she herself say, 'He's my brother'? I had no idea I was doing anything wrong when I did this."

5 Did he not say to me, 'She is my sister,' and didn't she also say, 'He is my brother'? I have done this with a clear conscience and clean hands."

6 God said to him in the dream, "Yes, I know your intentions were pure, that's why I kept you from sinning against me; I was the one who kept you from going to bed with her.

- 6 Then God said to him in the dream, "Yes, I know you did this with a clear conscience, and so I have kept you from sinning against me. That is why I did not let you touch her.
- 7 So now give the man's wife back to him. He's a prophet and will pray for you--pray for your life. If you don't give her back, know that it's certain death both for you and everyone in your family."
- 7 Now return the man's wife, for he is a prophet, and he will pray for you and you will live. But if you do not return her, you may be sure that you and all yours will die."
- 8 Abimelech was up first thing in the morning. He called all his house servants together and told them the whole story. They were shocked.
- 8 Early the next morning Abimelech summoned all his officials, and when he told them all that had happened, they were very much afraid.
- 9 Then Abimelech called in Abraham and said, "What have you done to us? What have I ever done to you that you would bring on me and my kingdom this huge offense? What you've done to me ought never to have been done."
- 9 Then Abimelech called Abraham in and said, "What have you done to us? How have I wronged you that you have brought such great guilt upon me and my kingdom? You have done things to me that should not be done."
- 10 Abimelech went on to Abraham, "Whatever were you thinking of when you did this thing?"
- 10 And Abimelech asked Abraham, "What was your reason for doing this?"
- 11 Abraham said, "I just assumed that there was no fear of God in this place and that they'd kill me to get my wife.
- 11 Abraham replied, "I said to myself, 'There is surely no fear of God in this place, and they will kill me because of my wife.'
- 12 Besides, the truth is that she is my half sister; she's my father's daughter but not my mother's.
- 12 Besides, she really is my sister, the daughter of my father though not of my mother; and she became my wife.
- 13 When God sent me out as a wanderer from my father's home, I told her, 'Do me a favor; wherever we go, tell people that I'm your brother.'"

- 13 And when God had me wander from my father's household, I said to her, "This is how you can show your love to me: Everywhere we go, say of me, "He is my brother." ' ' "
- 14 Then Abimelech gave Sarah back to Abraham, and along with her sent sheep and cattle and servants, both male and female.
- 14 Then Abimelech brought sheep and cattle and male and female slaves and gave them to Abraham, and he returned Sarah his wife to him.
- 15 He said, "My land is open to you; live wherever you wish."
- 15 And Abimelech said, "My land is before you; live wherever you like."
- 16 And to Sarah he said, "I've given your brother a thousand pieces of silver--that clears you of even a shadow of suspicion before the eyes of the world. You're vindicated."
- 16 To Sarah he said, "I am giving your brother a thousand shekels of silver. This is to cover the offense against you before all who are with you; you are completely vindicated."
- 17 Then Abraham prayed to God and God healed Abimelech, his wife and his maidservants, and they started having babies again.
- 17 Then Abraham prayed to God, and God healed Abimelech, his wife and his slave girls so they could have children again,
- 18 For GOD had shut down every womb in Abimelech's household on account of Sarah, Abraham's wife.
- 18 for the LORD had closed up every womb in Abimelech's household because of Abraham's wife Sarah.

Genesis 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD visited Sarah exactly as he said he would; GOD did to Sarah what he promised:
- 1 Now the LORD was gracious to Sarah as he had said, and the LORD did for Sarah what he had promised.
- 2 Sarah became pregnant and gave Abraham a son in his old age, and at the very time God had set.
- 2 Sarah became pregnant and bore a son to Abraham in his old age, at the very time God had promised him.

- 3 Abraham named him Isaac.
- 3 Abraham gave the name Isaac to the son Sarah bore him.
- 4 When his son was eight days old, Abraham circumcised him just as God had commanded.
- 4 When his son Isaac was eight days old, Abraham circumcised him, as God commanded him.
- 5 Abraham was a hundred years old when his son Isaac was born.
- 5 Abraham was a hundred years old when his son Isaac was born to him.
- 6 Sarah said, God has blessed me with laughter and all who get the news will laugh with me!
- 6 Sarah said, "God has brought me laughter, and everyone who hears about this will laugh with me."
- 7 She also said, Whoever would have suggested to Abraham that Sarah would one day nurse a baby! Yet here I am! I've given the old man a son!
- 7 And she added, "Who would have said to Abraham that Sarah would nurse children? Yet I have borne him a son in his old age."
- 8 The baby grew and was weaned. Abraham threw a big party on the day Isaac was weaned.
- 8 The child grew and was weaned, and on the day Isaac was weaned Abraham held a great feast.
- 9 One day Sarah saw the son that Hagar the Egyptian had borne to Abraham, poking fun at her son Isaac.
- 9 But Sarah saw that the son whom Hagar the Egyptian had borne to Abraham was mocking,
- 10 She told Abraham, "Get rid of this slave woman and her son. No child of this slave is going to share inheritance with my son Isaac!"
- 10 and she said to Abraham, "Get rid of that slave woman and her son, for that slave woman's son will never share in the inheritance with my son Isaac."
- 11 The matter gave great pain to Abraham--after all, Ishmael was his son.
- 11 The matter distressed Abraham greatly because it concerned his son.
- 12 But God spoke to Abraham, "Don't feel badly about the boy and your maid. Do whatever Sarah tells you. Your descendants will come through Isaac.
- 12 But God said to him, "Do not be so distressed about the boy and your maidservant. Listen to whatever Sarah tells you, because it is through

- Isaac that your offspring will be reckoned.
- 13 Regarding your maid's son, be assured that I'll also develop a great nation from him--he's your son too."
- 13 I will make the son of the maidservant into a nation also, because he is your offspring."
- 14 Abraham got up early the next morning, got some food together and a canteen of water for Hagar, put them on her back and sent her away with the child. She wandered off into the desert of Beersheba.
- 14 Early the next morning Abraham took some food and a skin of water and gave them to Hagar. He set them on her shoulders and then sent her off with the boy. She went on her way and wandered in the desert of Beersheba.
- 15 When the water was gone, she left the child under a shrub
- 15 When the water in the skin was gone, she put the boy under one of the bushes.
- 16 and went off, fifty yards or so. She said, "I can't watch my son die." As she sat, she broke into sobs.
- 16 Then she went off and sat down nearby, about a bowshot away, for she thought, "I cannot watch the boy die." And as she sat there nearby, she began to sob.
- 17 Meanwhile, God heard the boy crying. The angel of God called from Heaven to Hagar, "What's wrong, Hagar? Don't be afraid. God has heard the boy and knows the fix he's in.
- 17 God heard the boy crying, and the angel of God called to Hagar from heaven and said to her, "What is the matter, Hagar? Do not be afraid; God has heard the boy crying as he lies there.
- 18 Up now; go get the boy. Hold him tight. I'm going to make of him a great nation."
- 18 Lift the boy up and take him by the hand, for I will make him into a great nation."
- 19 Just then God opened her eyes. She looked. She saw a well of water. She went to it and filled her canteen and gave the boy a long, cool drink.
- 19 Then God opened her eyes and she saw a well of water. So she went and filled the skin with water and gave the boy a drink.
- 20 God was on the boy's side as he grew up. He lived out in the desert and became a skilled archer.

20 God was with the boy as he grew up. He lived in the desert and became an archer.

21 He lived in the Paran wilderness. And his mother got him a wife from Egypt.

21 While he was living in the Desert of Paran, his mother got a wife for him from Egypt.

22 At about that same time, Abimelech and the captain of his troops, Phicol, spoke to Abraham: "No matter what you do, God is on your side.

22 At that time Abimelech and Phicol the commander of his forces said to Abraham, "God is with you in everything you do.

23 So swear to me that you won't do anything underhanded to me or any of my family. For as long as you live here, swear that you'll treat me and my land as well as I've treated you."

23 Now swear to me here before God that you will not deal falsely with me or my children or my descendants. Show to me and the country where you are living as an alien the same kindness I have shown to you."

24 Abraham said, "I swear it."

24 Abraham said, "I swear it."

25 At the same time, Abraham confronted Abimelech over the matter of a well of water that Abimelech's servants had taken.

25 Then Abraham complained to Abimelech about a well of water that Abimelech's servants had seized.

26 Abimelech said, "I have no idea who did this; you never told me about it; this is the first I've heard of it."

26 But Abimelech said, "I don't know who has done this. You did not tell me, and I heard about it only today."

27 So the two of them made a covenant. Abraham took sheep and cattle and gave them to Abimelech.

27 So Abraham brought sheep and cattle and gave them to Abimelech, and the two men made a treaty.

28 Abraham set aside seven sheep from his flock.

28 Abraham set apart seven ewe lambs from the flock,

29 Abimelech said, "What does this mean? These seven sheep you've set aside."

29 and Abimelech asked Abraham, "What is the meaning of these seven ewe lambs you have set apart by themselves?"

- 30 Abraham said, "It means that when you accept these seven sheep, you take it as proof that I dug this well, that it's my well."
- 30 He replied, "Accept these seven lambs from my hand as a witness that I dug this well."
- 31 That's how the place got named Beersheba (the Oath-Well), because the two of them swore a covenant oath there.
- 31 So that place was called Beersheba, because the two men swore an oath there.
- 32 After they had made the covenant at Beersheba, Abimelech and his commander, Phicol, left and went back to Philistine territory.
- 32 After the treaty had been made at Beersheba, Abimelech and Phicol the commander of his forces returned to the land of the Philistines.
- 33 Abraham planted a tamarisk tree in Beersheba and worshiped GOD there, praying to the Eternal God.
- 33 Abraham planted a tamarisk tree in Beersheba, and there he called upon the name of the LORD, the Eternal God.
- 34 Abraham lived in Philistine country for a long time.
- 34 And Abraham stayed in the land of the Philistines for a long time.

Genesis 22

MSG

NIV

- 1 After all this, God tested Abraham. God said, "Abraham!" "Yes?" answered Abraham. "I'm listening."
- 1 Some time later God tested Abraham. He said to him, "Abraham!" "Here I am," he replied.
- 2 He said, "Take your dear son Isaac whom you love and go to the land of Moriah. Sacrifice him there as a burnt offering on one of the mountains that I'll point out to you."
- 2 Then God said, "Take your son, your only son, Isaac, whom you love, and go to the region of Moriah. Sacrifice him there as a burnt offering on one of the mountains I will tell you about."
- 3 Abraham got up early in the morning and saddled his donkey. He took two of his young servants and his son Isaac. He had split wood for the burnt offering. He set out for the place God had directed him.

- 3 Early the next morning Abraham got up and saddled his donkey. He took with him two of his servants and his son Isaac. When he had cut enough wood for the burnt offering, he set out for the place God had told him about.
- 4 On the third day he looked up and saw the place in the distance.
- 4 On the third day Abraham looked up and saw the place in the distance.
- 5 Abraham told his two young servants, "Stay here with the donkey. The boy and I are going over there to worship; then we'll come back to you."
- 5 He said to his servants, "Stay here with the donkey while I and the boy go over there. We will worship and then we will come back to you."
- 6 Abraham took the wood for the burnt offering and gave it to Isaac his son to carry. He carried the flint and the knife. The two of them went off together.
- 6 Abraham took the wood for the burnt offering and placed it on his son Isaac, and he himself carried the fire and the knife. As the two of them went on together,
- 7 Isaac said to Abraham his father, "Father?" "Yes, my son." "We have flint and wood, but where's the sheep for the burnt offering?"
- 7 Isaac spoke up and said to his father Abraham, "Father?" "Yes, my son?" Abraham replied. "The fire and wood are here," Isaac said, "but where is the lamb for the burnt offering?"
- 8 Abraham said, "Son, God will see to it that there's a sheep for the burnt offering." And they kept on walking together.
- 8 Abraham answered, "God himself will provide the lamb for the burnt offering, my son." And the two of them went on together.
- 9 They arrived at the place to which God had directed him. Abraham built an altar. He laid out the wood. Then he tied up Isaac and laid him on the wood.
- 9 When they reached the place God had told him about, Abraham built an altar there and arranged the wood on it. He bound his son Isaac and laid him on the altar, on top of the wood.
- 10 Abraham reached out and took the knife to kill his son.
- 10 Then he reached out his hand and took the knife to slay his son.
- 11 Just then an angel of GOD called to him out of Heaven, "Abraham! Abraham!" "Yes, I'm listening."

- 11 But the angel of the LORD called out to him from heaven, "Abraham! Abraham!" "Here I am," he replied.
- 12 "Don't lay a hand on that boy! Don't touch him! Now I know how fearlessly you fear God; you didn't hesitate to place your son, your dear son, on the altar for me."
- 12 Do not lay a hand on the boy, he said. "Do not do anything to him. Now I know that you fear God, because you have not withheld from me your son, your only son."
- 13 Abraham looked up. He saw a ram caught by its horns in the thicket. Abraham took the ram and sacrificed it as a burnt offering instead of his son.
- 13 Abraham looked up and there in a thicket he saw a ram caught by its horns. He went over and took the ram and sacrificed it as a burnt offering instead of his son.
- 14 Abraham named that place GOD-Yireh (GOD-Sees-to-It). That's where we get the saying, "On the mountain of GOD, he sees to it."
- 14 So Abraham called that place The LORD Will Provide. And to this day it is said, "On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided."
- 15 The angel of GOD spoke from Heaven a second time to Abraham:
- 15 The angel of the LORD called to Abraham from heaven a second time
- 16 "I swear--GOD's sure word!--because you have gone through with this, and have not refused to give me your son, your dear, dear son,
- 16 and said, "I swear by myself, declares the LORD, that because you have done this and have not withheld your son, your only son,
- 17 I'll bless you--oh, how I'll bless you! And I'll make sure that your children flourish--like stars in the sky! like sand on the beaches! And your descendants will defeat their enemies.
- 17 I will surely bless you and make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky and as the sand on the seashore. Your descendants will take possession of the cities of their enemies,
- 18 All nations on Earth will find themselves blessed through your descendants because you obeyed me."
- 18 and through your offspring all nations on earth will be blessed, because you have obeyed me."
- 19 Then Abraham went back to his young servants. They got things together and returned to Beersheba. Abraham settled down in Beersheba.

- 19 Then Abraham returned to his servants, and they set off together for Beersheba. And Abraham stayed in Beersheba.
- 20 After all this, Abraham got the news: "Your brother Nahor is a father! Milcah has given him children:
- 20 Some time later Abraham was told, "Milcah is also a mother; she has borne sons to your brother Nahor:
- 21 Uz, his firstborn, his brother Buz, Kemuel (he was the father of Aram),
- 21 Uz the firstborn, Buz his brother, Kemuel (the father of Aram),
- 22 Kesed, Hazo, Pildash, Jidlaph, and Bethuel."
- 22 Kesed, Hazo, Pildash, Jidlaph and Bethuel."
- 23 (Bethuel was the father of Rebekah.) Milcah gave these eight sons to Nahor, Abraham's brother.
- 23 Bethuel became the father of Rebekah. Milcah bore these eight sons to Abraham's brother Nahor.
- 24 His concubine, Reumah, gave him four more children: Tebah, Gaham, Tahash, and Maacah.
- 24 His concubine, whose name was Reumah, also had sons: Tebah, Gaham, Tahash and Maacah.

Genesis 23

MSG

NIV

- 1 Sarah lived 127 years.
- 1 Sarah lived to be a hundred and twenty-seven years old.
- 2 Sarah died in Kiriath Arba, present-day Hebron, in the land of Canaan. Abraham mourned for Sarah and wept.
- 2 She died at Kiriath Arba (that is, Hebron) in the land of Canaan, and Abraham went to mourn for Sarah and to weep over her.
- 3 Then Abraham got up from mourning his dead wife and spoke to the Hittites:
- 3 Then Abraham rose from beside his dead wife and spoke to the Hittites. He said,
- 4 "I know I'm only an outsider here among you, but sell me a burial plot so that I can bury my dead decently."

- 4 I am an alien and a stranger among you. Sell me some property for a burial site here so I can bury my dead.
- 5 The Hittites responded,
- 5 The Hittites replied to Abraham,
- 6 "Why, you're no mere outsider here with us, you're a prince of God! Bury your dead wife in the best of our burial sites. None of us will refuse you a place for burial."
- 6 Sir, listen to us. You are a mighty prince among us. Bury your dead in the choicest of our tombs. None of us will refuse you his tomb for burying your dead.
- 7 Then Abraham got up, bowed respectfully to the people of the land, the Hittites,
- 7 Then Abraham rose and bowed down before the people of the land, the Hittites.
- 8 and said, "If you're serious about helping me give my wife a proper burial, intercede for me with Ephron son of Zohar.
- 8 He said to them, "If you are willing to let me bury my dead, then listen to me and intercede with Ephron son of Zohar on my behalf
- 9 Ask him to sell me the cave of Machpelah that he owns, the one at the end of his land. Ask him to sell it to me at its full price for a burial plot, with you as witnesses."
- 9 so he will sell me the cave of Machpelah, which belongs to him and is at the end of his field. Ask him to sell it to me for the full price as a burial site among you."
- 10 Ephron was part of the local Hittite community. Then Ephron the Hittite spoke up, answering Abraham with all the Hittites who were part of the town council listening:
- 10 Ephron the Hittite was sitting among his people and he replied to Abraham in the hearing of all the Hittites who had come to the gate of his city.
- 11 "Oh no, my master! I couldn't do that. The field is yours--a gift. I'll give it and the cave to you. With my people as witnesses, I give it to you. Bury your deceased wife."
- 11 No, my lord, he said. "Listen to me; I give you the field, and I give you the cave that is in it. I give it to you in the presence of my people. Bury your dead."

12 Abraham bowed respectfully before the assembled council
12 Again Abraham bowed down before the people of the land
13 and answered Ephron: "Please allow me--I want to pay the price of the land; take my money so that I can go ahead and bury my wife."
13 and he said to Ephron in their hearing, "Listen to me, if you will. I will pay the price of the field. Accept it from me so I can bury my dead there."
14 Then Ephron answered Abraham,
14 Ephron answered Abraham,
15 "If you insist, master. What's four hundred silver shekels between us? Now go ahead and bury your wife."
15 Listen to me, my lord; the land is worth four hundred shekels of silver, but what is that between me and you? Bury your dead.
16 Abraham accepted Ephron's offer and paid out the sum that Ephron had named before the town council of Hittites--four hundred silver shekels at the current exchange rate.
16 Abraham agreed to Ephron's terms and weighed out for him the price he had named in the hearing of the Hittites: four hundred shekels of silver, according to the weight current among the merchants.
17 That's how Ephron's field next to Mamre--the field, its cave, and all the trees within its borders--
17 So Ephron's field in Machpelah near Mamre--both the field and the cave in it, and all the trees within the borders of the field--was deeded
18 became Abraham's property. The town council of Hittites witnessed the transaction.
18 to Abraham as his property in the presence of all the Hittites who had come to the gate of the city.
19 Abraham then proceeded to bury his wife Sarah in the cave in the field of Machpelah that is next to Mamre, present-day Hebron, in the land of Canaan.
19 Afterward Abraham buried his wife Sarah in the cave in the field of Machpelah near Mamre (which is at Hebron) in the land of Canaan.
20 The field and its cave went from the Hittites into Abraham's possession as a burial plot.
20 So the field and the cave in it were deeded to Abraham by the Hittites as a burial site.

Genesis 24

MSG

NIV

- 1 Abraham was now an old man. GOD had blessed Abraham in every way.
- 1 Abraham was now old and well advanced in years, and the LORD had blessed him in every way.
- 2 Abraham spoke to the senior servant in his household, the one in charge of everything he had, "Put your hand under my thigh
- 2 He said to the chief servant in his household, the one in charge of all that he had, "Put your hand under my thigh.
- 3 and swear by GOD--God of Heaven, God of Earth--that you will not get a wife for my son from among the young women of the Canaanites here,
- 3 I want you to swear by the LORD, the God of heaven and the God of earth, that you will not get a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanites, among whom I am living,
- 4 but will go to the land of my birth and get a wife for my son Isaac."
- 4 but will go to my country and my own relatives and get a wife for my son Isaac."
- 5 The servant answered, "But what if the woman refuses to leave home and come with me? Do I then take your son back to your home country?"
- 5 The servant asked him, "What if the woman is unwilling to come back with me to this land? Shall I then take your son back to the country you came from?"
- 6 Abraham said, "Oh no. Never. By no means are you to take my son back there.
- 6 Make sure that you do not take my son back there, Abraham said.
- 7 GOD, the God of Heaven, took me from the home of my father and from the country of my birth and spoke to me in solemn promise, 'I'm giving this land to your descendants.' This God will send his angel ahead of you to get a wife for my son.
- 7 The LORD, the God of heaven, who brought me out of my father's household and my native land and who spoke to me and promised me on oath, saying, 'To your offspring I will give this land'--he will send his angel before you so that you can get a wife for my son from there.

- 8 And if the woman won't come, you are free from this oath you've sworn to me. But under no circumstances are you to take my son back there."
- 8 If the woman is unwilling to come back with you, then you will be released from this oath of mine. Only do not take my son back there."
- 9 So the servant put his hand under the thigh of his master Abraham and gave his solemn oath.
- 9 So the servant put his hand under the thigh of his master Abraham and swore an oath to him concerning this matter.
- 10 The servant took ten of his master's camels and, loaded with gifts from his master, traveled to Aram Naharaim and the city of Nahor.
- 10 Then the servant took ten of his master's camels and left, taking with him all kinds of good things from his master. He set out for Aram Naharaim and made his way to the town of Nahor.
- 11 Outside the city, he made the camels kneel at a well. It was evening, the time when the women came to draw water.
- 11 He had the camels kneel down near the well outside the town; it was toward evening, the time the women go out to draw water.
- 12 He prayed, "O GOD, God of my master Abraham, make things go smoothly this day; treat my master Abraham well!
- 12 Then he prayed, "O LORD, God of my master Abraham, give me success today, and show kindness to my master Abraham.
- 13 As I stand here by the spring while the young women of the town come out to get water,
- 13 See, I am standing beside this spring, and the daughters of the townspeople are coming out to draw water.
- 14 let the girl to whom I say, 'Lower your jug and give me a drink,' and who answers, 'Drink, and let me also water your camels'--let her be the woman you have picked out for your servant Isaac. Then I'll know that you're working graciously behind the scenes for my master."
- 14 May it be that when I say to a girl, 'Please let down your jar that I may have a drink,' and she says, 'Drink, and I'll water your camels too'--let her be the one you have chosen for your servant Isaac. By this I will know that you have shown kindness to my master."
- 15 It so happened that the words were barely out of his mouth when Rebekah, the daughter of Bethuel whose mother was Milcah the wife of Nahor, Abraham's brother, came out with a water jug on her shoulder.

- 15 Before he had finished praying, Rebekah came out with her jar on her shoulder. She was the daughter of Bethuel son of Milcah, who was the wife of Abraham's brother Nahor.
- 16 The girl was stunningly beautiful, a pure virgin. She went down to the spring, filled her jug, and came back up.
- 16 The girl was very beautiful, a virgin; no man had ever lain with her. She went down to the spring, filled her jar and came up again.
- 17 The servant ran to meet her and said, "Please, can I have a sip of water from your jug?"
- 17 The servant hurried to meet her and said, "Please give me a little water from your jar."
- 18 She said, "Certainly, drink!" And she held the jug so that he could drink.
- 18 Drink, my lord, she said, and quickly lowered the jar to her hands and gave him a drink.
- 19 When he had satisfied his thirst she said, "I'll get water for your camels, too, until they've drunk their fill."
- 19 After she had given him a drink, she said, "I'll draw water for your camels too, until they have finished drinking."
- 20 She promptly emptied her jug into the trough and ran back to the well to fill it, and she kept at it until she had watered all the camels.
- 20 So she quickly emptied her jar into the trough, ran back to the well to draw more water, and drew enough for all his camels.
- 21 The man watched, silent. Was this GOD's answer? Had GOD made his trip a success or not?
- 21 Without saying a word, the man watched her closely to learn whether or not the LORD had made his journey successful.
- 22 When the camels had finished drinking, the man brought out gifts, a gold nose ring weighing a little over a quarter of an ounce and two arm bracelets weighing about four ounces, and gave them to her.
- 22 When the camels had finished drinking, the man took out a gold nose ring weighing a beka and two gold bracelets weighing ten shekels.
- 23 He asked her, "Tell me about your family? Whose daughter are you? Is there room in your father's house for us to stay the night?"
- 23 Then he asked, "Whose daughter are you? Please tell me, is there room in your father's house for us to spend the night?"
- 24 She said, "I'm the daughter of Bethuel the son of Milcah and Nahor.

- 24 She answered him, "I am the daughter of Bethuel, the son that Milcah bore to Nahor."
- 25 And there's plenty of room in our house for you to stay--and lots of straw and feed besides."
- 25 And she added, "We have plenty of straw and fodder, as well as room for you to spend the night."
- 26 At this the man bowed in worship before GOD
- 26 Then the man bowed down and worshiped the LORD,
- 27 and prayed, "Blessed be GOD, God of my master Abraham: How generous and true you've been to my master; you've held nothing back. You led me right to the door of my master's brother!"
- 27 saying, "Praise be to the LORD, the God of my master Abraham, who has not abandoned his kindness and faithfulness to my master. As for me, the LORD has led me on the journey to the house of my master's relatives."
- 28 And the girl was off and running, telling everyone in her mother's house what had happened.
- 28 The girl ran and told her mother's household about these things.
- 29 Rebekah had a brother named Laban. Laban ran outside to the man at the spring.
- 29 Now Rebekah had a brother named Laban, and he hurried out to the man at the spring.
- 30 He had seen the nose ring and the bracelets on his sister and had heard her say, "The man said this and this and this to me." So he went to the man and there he was, still standing with his camels at the spring.
- 30 As soon as he had seen the nose ring, and the bracelets on his sister's arms, and had heard Rebekah tell what the man said to her, he went out to the man and found him standing by the camels near the spring.
- 31 Laban welcomed him: "Come on in, blessed of GOD! Why are you standing out here? I've got the house ready for you; and there's also a place for your camels."
- 31 Come, you who are blessed by the LORD, he said. "Why are you standing out here? I have prepared the house and a place for the camels."
- 32 So the man went into the house. The camels were unloaded and given straw and feed. Water was brought to bathe the feet of the man and the men with him.

32 So the man went to the house, and the camels were unloaded. Straw and fodder were brought for the camels, and water for him and his men to wash their feet.

33 Then Laban brought out food. But the man said, "I won't eat until I tell my story." Laban said, "Go ahead; tell us."

33 Then food was set before him, but he said, "I will not eat until I have told you what I have to say." "Then tell us," Laban said.

34 The servant said, "I'm the servant of Abraham.

34 So he said, "I am Abraham's servant.

35 GOD has blessed my master--he's a great man; GOD has given him sheep and cattle, silver and gold, servants and maidservants, camels and donkeys.

35 The LORD has blessed my master abundantly, and he has become wealthy. He has given him sheep and cattle, silver and gold, menservants and maidservants, and camels and donkeys.

36 And then to top it off, Sarah, my master's wife, gave him a son in her old age and he has passed everything on to his son.

36 My master's wife Sarah has borne him a son in her old age, and he has given him everything he owns.

37 My master made me promise, 'Don't get a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanites in whose land I live.

37 And my master made me swear an oath, and said, 'You must not get a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanites, in whose land I live,

38 No, go to my father's home, back to my family, and get a wife for my son there.'

38 but go to my father's family and to my own clan, and get a wife for my son.'

39 I said to my master, 'But what if the woman won't come with me?'

39 Then I asked my master, 'What if the woman will not come back with me?'

40 He said, 'GOD before whom I've walked faithfully will send his angel with you and he'll make things work out so that you'll bring back a wife for my son from my family, from the house of my father.

40 He replied, 'The LORD, before whom I have walked, will send his angel with you and make your journey a success, so that you can get a wife for

- my son from my own clan and from my father's family.
- 41 Then you'll be free from the oath. If you go to my family and they won't give her to you, you will also be free from the oath.'
- 41 Then, when you go to my clan, you will be released from my oath even if they refuse to give her to you--you will be released from my oath.'
- 42 "Well, when I came this very day to the spring, I prayed, 'GOD, God of my master Abraham, make things turn out well in this task I've been given.
- 42 When I came to the spring today, I said, 'O LORD, God of my master Abraham, if you will, please grant success to the journey on which I have come.
- 43 I'm standing at this well. When a young woman comes here to draw water and I say to her, Please, give me a sip of water from your jug,
- 43 See, I am standing beside this spring; if a maiden comes out to draw water and I say to her, "Please let me drink a little water from your jar,"
- 44 and she says, Not only will I give you a drink, I'll also water your camels--let that woman be the wife GOD has picked out for my master's son.'
- 44 and if she says to me, "Drink, and I'll draw water for your camels too," let her be the one the LORD has chosen for my master's son.'
- 45 "I had barely finished offering this prayer, when Rebekah arrived, her jug on her shoulder. She went to the spring and drew water and I said, 'Please, can I have a drink?'
- 45 Before I finished praying in my heart, Rebekah came out, with her jar on her shoulder. She went down to the spring and drew water, and I said to her, 'Please give me a drink.'
- 46 She didn't hesitate. She held out her jug and said, 'Drink; and when you're finished I'll also water your camels.' I drank, and she watered the camels.
- 46 She quickly lowered her jar from her shoulder and said, 'Drink, and I'll water your camels too.' So I drank, and she watered the camels also.
- 47 I asked her, 'Whose daughter are you?' She said, 'The daughter of Bethuel whose parents were Nahor and Milcah.' I gave her a ring for her nose, bracelets for her arms,
- 47 I asked her, 'Whose daughter are you?' She said, 'The daughter of Bethuel son of Nahor, whom Milcah bore to him.' "Then I put the ring in

her nose and the bracelets on her arms,

48 and bowed in worship to GOD. I praised GOD, the God of my master Abraham who had led me straight to the door of my master's family to get a wife for his son.

48 and I bowed down and worshiped the LORD. I praised the LORD, the God of my master Abraham, who had led me on the right road to get the granddaughter of my master's brother for his son.

49 "Now, tell me what you are going to do. If you plan to respond with a generous yes, tell me. But if not, tell me plainly so I can figure out what to do next."

49 Now if you will show kindness and faithfulness to my master, tell me; and if not, tell me, so I may know which way to turn."

50 Laban and Bethuel answered, "This is totally from GOD. We have no say in the matter, either yes or no.

50 Laban and Bethuel answered, "This is from the LORD; we can say nothing to you one way or the other.

51 Rebekah is yours: Take her and go; let her be the wife of your master's son, as GOD has made plain."

51 Here is Rebekah; take her and go, and let her become the wife of your master's son, as the LORD has directed."

52 When Abraham's servant heard their decision, he bowed in worship before GOD.

52 When Abraham's servant heard what they said, he bowed down to the ground before the LORD.

53 Then he brought out gifts of silver and gold and clothing and gave them to Rebekah. He also gave expensive gifts to her brother and mother.

53 Then the servant brought out gold and silver jewelry and articles of clothing and gave them to Rebekah; he also gave costly gifts to her brother and to her mother.

54 He and his men had supper and spent the night. But first thing in the morning they were up. He said, "Send me back to my master."

54 Then he and the men who were with him ate and drank and spent the night there. When they got up the next morning, he said, "Send me on my way to my master."

55 Her brother and mother said, "Let the girl stay a while, say another ten days, and then go."

55 But her brother and her mother replied, "Let the girl remain with us ten days or so; then you may go."

56 He said, "Oh, don't make me wait! GOD has worked everything out so well--send me off to my master."

56 But he said to them, "Do not detain me, now that the LORD has granted success to my journey. Send me on my way so I may go to my master."

57 They said, "We'll call the girl; we'll ask her."

57 Then they said, "Let's call the girl and ask her about it."

58 They called Rebekah and asked her, "Do you want to go with this man?" She said, "I'm ready to go."

58 So they called Rebekah and asked her, "Will you go with this man?" "I will go," she said.

59 So they sent them off, their sister Rebekah with her nurse, and Abraham's servant with his men.

59 So they sent their sister Rebekah on her way, along with her nurse and Abraham's servant and his men.

60 And they blessed Rebekah saying, "You're our sister--live bountifully! And your children, triumphantly!"

60 And they blessed Rebekah and said to her, "Our sister, may you increase to thousands upon thousands; may your offspring possess the gates of their enemies."

61 Rebekah and her young maids mounted the camels and followed the man. The servant took Rebekah and set off for home.

61 Then Rebekah and her maids got ready and mounted their camels and went back with the man. So the servant took Rebekah and left.

62 Isaac was living in the Negev. He had just come back from a visit to Beer Lahai Roi.

62 Now Isaac had come from Beer Lahai Roi, for he was living in the Negev.

63 In the evening he went out into the field; while meditating he looked up and saw camels coming.

63 He went out to the field one evening to meditate, and as he looked up, he saw camels approaching.

64 When Rebekah looked up and saw Isaac, she got down from her camel

64 Rebekah also looked up and saw Isaac. She got down from her camel

65 and asked the servant, "Who is that man out in the field coming toward us?" "That is my master." She took her veil and covered herself.

65 and asked the servant, "Who is that man in the field coming to meet us?" "He is my master," the servant answered. So she took her veil and covered herself.

66 After the servant told Isaac the whole story of the trip,

66 Then the servant told Isaac all he had done.

67 Isaac took Rebekah into the tent of his mother Sarah. He married Rebekah and she became his wife and he loved her. So Isaac found comfort after his mother's death.

67 Isaac brought her into the tent of his mother Sarah, and he married Rebekah. So she became his wife, and he loved her; and Isaac was comforted after his mother's death.

Genesis 25

MSG

NIV

1 Abraham married a second time; his new wife was named Keturah.

1 Abraham took another wife, whose name was Keturah.

2 She gave birth to Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, and Shuah.

2 She bore him Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak and Shuah.

3 Jokshan had Sheba and Dedan. Dedan's descendants were the Asshurim, the Letushim, and the Leummim.

3 Jokshan was the father of Sheba and Dedan; the descendants of Dedan were the Asshurites, the Letushites and the Leummites.

4 Midian had Ephah, Epher, Hanoch, Abida, and Eldaah--all from the line of Keturah.

4 The sons of Midian were Ephah, Epher, Hanoch, Abida and Eldaah. All these were descendants of Keturah.

5 But Abraham gave everything he possessed to Isaac.

5 Abraham left everything he owned to Isaac.

6 While he was still living, he gave gifts to the sons he had by his concubines, but then sent them away to the country of the east, putting a good distance between them and his son Isaac.

- 6 But while he was still living, he gave gifts to the sons of his concubines and sent them away from his son Isaac to the land of the east.
- 7 Abraham lived 175 years.
- 7 Altogether, Abraham lived a hundred and seventy-five years.
- 8 Then he took his final breath. He died happy at a ripe old age, full of years, and was buried with his family.
- 8 Then Abraham breathed his last and died at a good old age, an old man and full of years; and he was gathered to his people.
- 9 His sons Isaac and Ishmael buried him in the cave of Machpelah in the field of Ephron son of Zohar the Hittite, next to Mamre.
- 9 His sons Isaac and Ishmael buried him in the cave of Machpelah near Mamre, in the field of Ephron son of Zohar the Hittite,
- 10 It was the field that Abraham had bought from the Hittites. Abraham was buried next to his wife Sarah.
- 10 the field Abraham had bought from the Hittites. There Abraham was buried with his wife Sarah.
- 11 After Abraham's death, God blessed his son Isaac. Isaac lived at Beer Lahai Roi.
- 11 After Abraham's death, God blessed his son Isaac, who then lived near Beer Lahai Roi.
- 12 This is the family tree of Ishmael son of Abraham, the son that Hagar the Egyptian, Sarah's maid, bore to Abraham.
- 12 This is the account of Abraham's son Ishmael, whom Sarah's maidservant, Hagar the Egyptian, bore to Abraham.
- 13 These are the names of Ishmael's sons in the order of their births: Nebaioth, Ishmael's first-born, Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam,
- 13 These are the names of the sons of Ishmael, listed in the order of their birth: Nebaioth the firstborn of Ishmael, Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam,
- 14 Mishma, Dumah, Massa,
- 14 Mishma, Dumah, Massa,
- 15 Hadad, Tema, Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah--
- 15 Hadad, Tema, Jetur, Naphish and Kedemah.
- 16 all the sons of Ishmael. Their settlements and encampments were named after them. Twelve princes with their twelve tribes.
- 16 These were the sons of Ishmael, and these are the names of the twelve tribal rulers according to their settlements and camps.

- 17 Ishmael lived 137 years. When he breathed his last and died he was buried with his family.
- 17 Altogether, Ishmael lived a hundred and thirty-seven years. He breathed his last and died, and he was gathered to his people.
- 18 His children settled down all the way from Havilah near Egypt eastward to Shur in the direction of Assyria. The Ishmaelites didn't get along with any of their kin.
- 18 His descendants settled in the area from Havilah to Shur, near the border of Egypt, as you go toward Asshur. And they lived in hostility toward all their brothers.
- 19 This is the family tree of Isaac son of Abraham: Abraham had Isaac.
- 19 This is the account of Abraham's son Isaac. Abraham became the father of Isaac,
- 20 Isaac was forty years old when he married Rebekah daughter of Bethuel the Aramean of Paddan Aram. She was the sister of Laban the Aramean.
- 20 and Isaac was forty years old when he married Rebekah daughter of Bethuel the Aramean from Paddan Aram and sister of Laban the Aramean.
- 21 Isaac prayed hard to GOD for his wife because she was barren. GOD answered his prayer and Rebekah became pregnant.
- 21 Isaac prayed to the LORD on behalf of his wife, because she was barren. The LORD answered his prayer, and his wife Rebekah became pregnant.
- 22 But the children tumbled and kicked inside her so much that she said, "If this is the way it's going to be, why go on living?" She went to GOD to find out what was going on.
- 22 The babies jostled each other within her, and she said, "Why is this happening to me?" So she went to inquire of the LORD.
- 23 GOD told her, Two nations are in your womb, two peoples butting heads while still in your body. One people will overpower the other, and the older will serve the younger.
- 23 The LORD said to her, "Two nations are in your womb, and two peoples from within you will be separated; one people will be stronger than the other, and the older will serve the younger."
- 24 When her time to give birth came, sure enough, there were twins in her womb.

- 24 When the time came for her to give birth, there were twin boys in her womb.
- 25 The first came out reddish, as if snugly wrapped in a hairy blanket; they named him Esau (Hairy).
- 25 The first to come out was red, and his whole body was like a hairy garment; so they named him Esau.
- 26 His brother followed, his fist clutched tight to Esau's heel; they named him Jacob (Heel). Isaac was sixty years old when they were born.
- 26 After this, his brother came out, with his hand grasping Esau's heel; so he was named Jacob. Isaac was sixty years old when Rebekah gave birth to them.
- 27 The boys grew up. Esau became an expert hunter, an outdoorsman. Jacob was a quiet man preferring life indoors among the tents.
- 27 The boys grew up, and Esau became a skillful hunter, a man of the open country, while Jacob was a quiet man, staying among the tents.
- 28 Isaac loved Esau because he loved his game, but Rebekah loved Jacob.
- 28 Isaac, who had a taste for wild game, loved Esau, but Rebekah loved Jacob.
- 29 One day Jacob was cooking a stew. Esau came in from the field, starved.
- 29 Once when Jacob was cooking some stew, Esau came in from the open country, famished.
- 30 Esau said to Jacob, "Give me some of that red stew--I'm starved!" That's how he came to be called Edom (Red).
- 30 He said to Jacob, "Quick, let me have some of that red stew! I'm famished!" (That is why he was also called Edom.)
- 31 Jacob said, "Make me a trade: my stew for your rights as the firstborn."
- 31 Jacob replied, "First sell me your birthright."
- 32 Esau said, "I'm starving! What good is a birthright if I'm dead?"
- 32 Look, I am about to die, Esau said. "What good is the birthright to me?"
- 33 Jacob said, "First, swear to me." And he did it. On oath Esau traded away his rights as the firstborn.
- 33 But Jacob said, "Swear to me first." So he swore an oath to him, selling his birthright to Jacob.
- 34 Jacob gave him bread and the stew of lentils. He ate and drank, got up and left. That's how Esau shrugged off his rights as the firstborn.

34 Then Jacob gave Esau some bread and some lentil stew. He ate and drank, and then got up and left. So Esau despised his birthright.

Genesis 26

MSG

NIV

- 1 There was a famine in the land, as bad as the famine during the time of Abraham. And Isaac went down to Abimelech, king of the Philistines, in Gerar.
- 1 Now there was a famine in the land--besides the earlier famine of Abraham's time--and Isaac went to Abimelech king of the Philistines in Gerar.
- 2 GOD appeared to him and said, "Don't go down to Egypt; stay where I tell you.
- 2 The LORD appeared to Isaac and said, "Do not go down to Egypt; live in the land where I tell you to live.
- 3 Stay here in this land and I'll be with you and bless you. I'm giving you and your children all these lands, fulfilling the oath that I swore to your father Abraham.
- 3 Stay in this land for a while, and I will be with you and will bless you. For to you and your descendants I will give all these lands and will confirm the oath I swore to your father Abraham.
- 4 I'll make your descendants as many as the stars in the sky and give them all these lands. All the nations of the Earth will get a blessing for themselves through your descendants.
- 4 I will make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky and will give them all these lands, and through your offspring all nations on earth will be blessed,
- 5 And why? Because Abraham obeyed my summons and kept my charge--my commands, my guidelines, my teachings."
- 5 because Abraham obeyed me and kept my requirements, my commands, my decrees and my laws."
- 6 So Isaac stayed put in Gerar.
- 6 So Isaac stayed in Gerar.
- 7 The men of the place questioned him about his wife. He said, "She's my sister." He was afraid to say "She's my wife." He was thinking, "These men might kill me to get Rebekah, she's so beautiful."

- 7 When the men of that place asked him about his wife, he said, "She is my sister," because he was afraid to say, "She is my wife." He thought, "The men of this place might kill me on account of Rebekah, because she is beautiful."
- 8 One day, after they had been there quite a long time, Abimelech, king of the Philistines, looked out his window and saw Isaac fondling his wife Rebekah.
- 8 When Isaac had been there a long time, Abimelech king of the Philistines looked down from a window and saw Isaac caressing his wife Rebekah.
- 9 Abimelech sent for Isaac and said, "So, she's your wife. Why did you tell us 'She's my sister'?" Isaac said, "Because I thought I might get killed by someone who wanted her."
- 9 So Abimelech summoned Isaac and said, "She is really your wife! Why did you say, 'She is my sister'?" Isaac answered him, "Because I thought I might lose my life on account of her."
- 10 Abimelech said, "But think of what you might have done to us! Given a little more time, one of the men might have slept with your wife; you would have been responsible for bringing guilt down on us."
- 10 Then Abimelech said, "What is this you have done to us? One of the men might well have slept with your wife, and you would have brought guilt upon us."
- 11 Then Abimelech gave orders to his people: "Anyone who so much as lays a hand on this man or his wife dies."
- 11 So Abimelech gave orders to all the people: "Anyone who molests this man or his wife shall surely be put to death."
- 12 Isaac planted crops in that land and took in a huge harvest. GOD blessed him.
- 12 Isaac planted crops in that land and the same year reaped a hundredfold, because the LORD blessed him.
- 13 The man got richer and richer by the day until he was very wealthy.
- 13 The man became rich, and his wealth continued to grow until he became very wealthy.
- 14 He accumulated flocks and herds and many, many servants, so much so that the Philistines began to envy him.
- 14 He had so many flocks and herds and servants that the Philistines envied him.

- 15 They got back at him by throwing dirt and debris into all the wells that his father's servants had dug back in the days of his father Abraham, clogging up all the wells.
- 15 So all the wells that his father's servants had dug in the time of his father Abraham, the Philistines stopped up, filling them with earth.
- 16 Finally, Abimelech told Isaac: "Leave. You've become far too big for us."
- 16 Then Abimelech said to Isaac, "Move away from us; you have become too powerful for us."
- 17 So Isaac left. He camped in the valley of Gerar and settled down there.
- 17 So Isaac moved away from there and encamped in the Valley of Gerar and settled there.
- 18 Isaac dug again the wells which were dug in the days of his father Abraham but had been clogged up by the Philistines after Abraham's death. And he renamed them, using the original names his father had given them.
- 18 Isaac reopened the wells that had been dug in the time of his father Abraham, which the Philistines had stopped up after Abraham died, and he gave them the same names his father had given them.
- 19 One day, as Isaac's servants were digging in the valley, they came on a well of spring water.
- 19 Isaac's servants dug in the valley and discovered a well of fresh water there.
- 20 The shepherds of Gerar quarreled with Isaac's shepherds, claiming, "This water is ours." So Isaac named the well Esek (Quarrel) because they quarreled over it.
- 20 But the herdsmen of Gerar quarreled with Isaac's herdsmen and said, "The water is ours!" So he named the well Esek, because they disputed with him.
- 21 They dug another well and there was a difference over that one also, so he named it Sitnah (Accusation).
- 21 Then they dug another well, but they quarreled over that one also; so he named it Sitnah.
- 22 He went on from there and dug yet another well. But there was no fighting over this one so he named it Rehoboth (Wide-Open Spaces),

saying, "Now GOD has given us plenty of space to spread out in the land."

22 He moved on from there and dug another well, and no one quarreled over it. He named it Rehoboth, saying, "Now the LORD has given us room and we will flourish in the land."

23 From there he went up to Beersheba.

23 From there he went up to Beersheba.

24 That very night GOD appeared to him and said, I am the God of Abraham your father; don't fear a thing because I'm with you. I'll bless you and make your children flourish because of Abraham my servant.

24 That night the LORD appeared to him and said, "I am the God of your father Abraham. Do not be afraid, for I am with you; I will bless you and will increase the number of your descendants for the sake of my servant Abraham."

25 Isaac built an altar there and prayed, calling on GOD by name. He pitched his tent and his servants started digging another well.

25 Isaac built an altar there and called on the name of the LORD. There he pitched his tent, and there his servants dug a well.

26 Then Abimelech came to him from Gerar with Ahuzzath his advisor and Phicol the head of his troops.

26 Meanwhile, Abimelech had come to him from Gerar, with Ahuzzath his personal adviser and Phicol the commander of his forces.

27 Isaac asked them, "Why did you come to me? You hate me; you threw me out of your country."

27 Isaac asked them, "Why have you come to me, since you were hostile to me and sent me away?"

28 They said, "We've realized that GOD is on your side. We'd like to make a deal between us--a covenant

28 They answered, "We saw clearly that the LORD was with you; so we said, 'There ought to be a sworn agreement between us'-- between us and you. Let us make a treaty with you

29 that we maintain friendly relations. We haven't bothered you in the past; we treated you kindly and let you leave us in peace. So--GOD's blessing be with you!"

29 that you will do us no harm, just as we did not molest you but always treated you well and sent you away in peace. And now you are blessed

- by the LORD."
- 30 Isaac laid out a feast and they ate and drank together.
- 30 Isaac then made a feast for them, and they ate and drank.
- 31 Early in the morning they exchanged oaths. Then Isaac said good-bye and they parted as friends.
- 31 Early the next morning the men swore an oath to each other. Then Isaac sent them on their way, and they left him in peace.
- 32 Later that same day, Isaac's servants came to him with news about the well they had been digging, "We've struck water!"
- 32 That day Isaac's servants came and told him about the well they had dug. They said, "We've found water!"
- 33 Isaac named the well Sheba (Oath), and that's the name of the city, Beersheba (Oath-Well), to this day.
- 33 He called it Shibah, and to this day the name of the town has been Beersheba.
- 34 When Esau was forty years old he married Judith, daughter of Beerli the Hittite, and Basemath, daughter of Elon the Hittite.
- 34 When Esau was forty years old, he married Judith daughter of Beerli the Hittite, and also Basemath daughter of Elon the Hittite.
- 35 They turned out to be thorns in the sides of Isaac and Rebekah.
- 35 They were a source of grief to Isaac and Rebekah.

Genesis 27

MSG

NIV

- 1 When Isaac had become an old man and was nearly blind, he called his eldest son, Esau, and said, "My son." "Yes, Father?"
- 1 When Isaac was old and his eyes were so weak that he could no longer see, he called for Esau his older son and said to him, "My son." "Here I am," he answered.
- 2 "I'm an old man," he said; "I might die any day now.
- 2 Isaac said, "I am now an old man and don't know the day of my death.
- 3 Do me a favor: Get your quiver of arrows and your bow and go out in the country and hunt me some game.

- 3 Now then, get your weapons--your quiver and bow--and go out to the open country to hunt some wild game for me.
- 4 Then fix me a hearty meal, the kind that you know I like, and bring it to me to eat so that I can give you my personal blessing before I die."
- 4 Prepare me the kind of tasty food I like and bring it to me to eat, so that I may give you my blessing before I die."
- 5 Rebekah was eavesdropping as Isaac spoke to his son Esau. As soon as Esau had gone off to the country to hunt game for his father,
- 5 Now Rebekah was listening as Isaac spoke to his son Esau. When Esau left for the open country to hunt game and bring it back,
- 6 Rebekah spoke to her son Jacob. "I just overheard your father talking with your brother, Esau. He said,
- 6 Rebekah said to her son Jacob, "Look, I overheard your father say to your brother Esau,
- 7 'Bring me some game and fix me a hearty meal so that I can eat and bless you with GOD's blessing before I die.'
- 7 'Bring me some game and prepare me some tasty food to eat, so that I may give you my blessing in the presence of the LORD before I die.'
- 8 "Now, my son, listen to me. Do what I tell you.
- 8 Now, my son, listen carefully and do what I tell you:
- 9 Go to the flock and get me two young goats. Pick the best; I'll prepare them into a hearty meal, the kind that your father loves.
- 9 Go out to the flock and bring me two choice young goats, so I can prepare some tasty food for your father, just the way he likes it.
- 10 Then you'll take it to your father, he'll eat and bless you before he dies."
- 10 Then take it to your father to eat, so that he may give you his blessing before he dies."
- 11 "But Mother," Jacob said, "my brother Esau is a hairy man and I have smooth skin.
- 11 Jacob said to Rebekah his mother, "But my brother Esau is a hairy man, and I'm a man with smooth skin.
- 12 What happens if my father touches me? He'll think I'm playing games with him. I'll bring down a curse on myself instead of a blessing."
- 12 What if my father touches me? I would appear to be tricking him and would bring down a curse on myself rather than a blessing."

13 "If it comes to that," said his mother, "I'll take the curse on myself. Now, just do what I say. Go and get the goats."

13 His mother said to him, "My son, let the curse fall on me. Just do what I say; go and get them for me."

14 So he went and got them and brought them to his mother and she cooked a hearty meal, the kind his father loved so much.

14 So he went and got them and brought them to his mother, and she prepared some tasty food, just the way his father liked it.

15 Rebekah took the dress-up clothes of her older son Esau and put them on her younger son Jacob.

15 Then Rebekah took the best clothes of Esau her older son, which she had in the house, and put them on her younger son Jacob.

16 She took the goatskins and covered his hands and the smooth nape of his neck.

16 She also covered his hands and the smooth part of his neck with the goatskins.

17 Then she placed the hearty meal she had fixed and fresh bread she'd baked into the hands of her son Jacob.

17 Then she handed to her son Jacob the tasty food and the bread she had made.

18 He went to his father and said, "My father!" "Yes?" he said. "Which son are you?"

18 He went to his father and said, "My father." "Yes, my son," he answered. "Who is it?"

19 Jacob answered his father, "I'm your firstborn son Esau. I did what you told me. Come now; sit up and eat of my game so you can give me your personal blessing."

19 Jacob said to his father, "I am Esau your firstborn. I have done as you told me. Please sit up and eat some of my game so that you may give me your blessing."

20 Isaac said, "So soon? How did you get it so quickly?" "Because your GOD cleared the way for me."

20 Isaac asked his son, "How did you find it so quickly, my son?" "The LORD your God gave me success," he replied.

21 Isaac said, "Come close, son; let me touch you--are you really my son Esau?"

21 Then Isaac said to Jacob, "Come near so I can touch you, my son, to know whether you really are my son Esau or not."

22 So Jacob moved close to his father Isaac. Isaac felt him and said, "The voice is Jacob's voice but the hands are the hands of Esau."

22 Jacob went close to his father Isaac, who touched him and said, "The voice is the voice of Jacob, but the hands are the hands of Esau."

23 He didn't recognize him because his hands were hairy, like his brother Esau's. But as he was about to bless him

23 He did not recognize him, for his hands were hairy like those of his brother Esau; so he blessed him.

24 he pressed him, "You're sure? You are my son Esau?" "Yes. I am."

24 Are you really my son Esau? he asked. "I am," he replied.

25 Isaac said, "Bring the food so I can eat of my son's game and give you my personal blessing." Jacob brought it to him and he ate. He also brought him wine and he drank.

25 Then he said, "My son, bring me some of your game to eat, so that I may give you my blessing." Jacob brought it to him and he ate; and he brought some wine and he drank.

26 Then Isaac said, "Come close, son, and kiss me."

26 Then his father Isaac said to him, "Come here, my son, and kiss me."

27 He came close and kissed him and Isaac smelled the smell of his clothes. Finally, he blessed him, Ahhh. The smell of my son is like the smell of the open country blessed by GOD.

27 So he went to him and kissed him. When Isaac caught the smell of his clothes, he blessed him and said, "Ah, the smell of my son is like the smell of a field that the LORD has blessed.

28 May God give you of Heaven's dew and Earth's bounty of grain and wine.

28 May God give you of heaven's dew and of earth's richness-- an abundance of grain and new wine.

29 May peoples serve you and nations honor you. You will master your brothers, and your mother's sons will honor you. Those who curse you will be cursed, those who bless you will be blessed.

29 May nations serve you and peoples bow down to you. Be lord over your brothers, and may the sons of your mother bow down to you. May those who curse you be cursed and those who bless you be blessed."

30 And then right after Isaac had blessed Jacob and Jacob had left, Esau showed up from the hunt.

30 After Isaac finished blessing him and Jacob had scarcely left his father's presence, his brother Esau came in from hunting.

31 He also had prepared a hearty meal. He came to his father and said, "Let my father get up and eat of his son's game, that he may give me his personal blessing."

31 He too prepared some tasty food and brought it to his father. Then he said to him, "My father, sit up and eat some of my game, so that you may give me your blessing."

32 His father Isaac said, "And who are you?" "I am your son, your firstborn, Esau."

32 His father Isaac asked him, "Who are you?" "I am your son," he answered, "your firstborn, Esau."

33 Isaac started to tremble, shaking violently. He said, "Then who hunted game and brought it to me? I finished the meal just now, before you walked in. And I blessed him--he's blessed for good!"

33 Isaac trembled violently and said, "Who was it, then, that hunted game and brought it to me? I ate it just before you came and I blessed him--and indeed he will be blessed!"

34 Esau, hearing his father's words, sobbed violently and most bitterly, and cried to his father, "My father! Can't you also bless me?"

34 When Esau heard his father's words, he burst out with a loud and bitter cry and said to his father, "Bless me--me too, my father!"

35 "Your brother," he said, "came here falsely and took your blessing."

35 But he said, "Your brother came deceitfully and took your blessing."

36 Esau said, "Not for nothing was he named Jacob, the Heel. Twice now he's tricked me: first he took my birthright and now he's taken my blessing." He begged, "Haven't you kept back any blessing for me?"

36 Esau said, "Isn't he rightly named Jacob? He has deceived me these two times: He took my birthright, and now he's taken my blessing!" Then he asked, "Haven't you reserved any blessing for me?"

37 Isaac answered Esau, "I've made him your master, and all his brothers his servants, and lavished grain and wine on him. I've given it all away. What's left for you, my son?"

- 37 Isaac answered Esau, "I have made him lord over you and have made all his relatives his servants, and I have sustained him with grain and new wine. So what can I possibly do for you, my son?"
- 38 "But don't you have just one blessing for me, Father? Oh, bless me my father! Bless me!" Esau sobbed inconsolably.
- 38 Esau said to his father, "Do you have only one blessing, my father? Bless me too, my father!" Then Esau wept aloud.
- 39 Isaac said to him, You'll live far from Earth's bounty, remote from Heaven's dew.
- 39 His father Isaac answered him, "Your dwelling will be away from the earth's richness, away from the dew of heaven above.
- 40 You'll live by your sword, hand-to-mouth, and you'll serve your brother. But when you can't take it any more you'll break loose and run free.
- 40 You will live by the sword and you will serve your brother. But when you grow restless, you will throw his yoke from off your neck."
- 41 Esau seethed in anger against Jacob because of the blessing his father had given him; he brooded, "The time for mourning my father's death is close. And then I'll kill my brother Jacob."
- 41 Esau held a grudge against Jacob because of the blessing his father had given him. He said to himself, "The days of mourning for my father are near; then I will kill my brother Jacob."
- 42 When these words of her older son Esau were reported to Rebekah, she called her younger son Jacob and said, "Your brother Esau is plotting vengeance against you. He's going to kill you.
- 42 When Rebekah was told what her older son Esau had said, she sent for her younger son Jacob and said to him, "Your brother Esau is consoling himself with the thought of killing you.
- 43 Son, listen to me. Get out of here. Run for your life to Haran, to my brother Laban.
- 43 Now then, my son, do what I say: Flee at once to my brother Laban in Haran.
- 44 Live with him for a while until your brother cools down,
- 44 Stay with him for a while until your brother's fury subsides.
- 45 until his anger subsides and he forgets what you did to him. I'll then send for you and bring you back. Why should I lose both of you the same day?"

- 45 When your brother is no longer angry with you and forgets what you did to him, I'll send word for you to come back from there. Why should I lose both of you in one day?"
- 46 Rebekah spoke to Isaac, "I'm sick to death of these Hittite women. If Jacob also marries a native Hittite woman, why live?"
- 46 Then Rebekah said to Isaac, "I'm disgusted with living because of these Hittite women. If Jacob takes a wife from among the women of this land, from Hittite women like these, my life will not be worth living."

Genesis 28

MSG

NIV

- 1 So Isaac called in Jacob and blessed him. Then he ordered him, "Don't take a Canaanite wife.
- 1 So Isaac called for Jacob and blessed him and commanded him: "Do not marry a Canaanite woman.
- 2 Leave at once. Go to Paddan Aram to the family of your mother's father, Bethuel. Get a wife for yourself from the daughters of your uncle Laban.
- 2 Go at once to Paddan Aram, to the house of your mother's father Bethuel. Take a wife for yourself there, from among the daughters of Laban, your mother's brother.
- 3 "And may The Strong God bless you and give you many, many children, a congregation of peoples;
- 3 May God Almighty bless you and make you fruitful and increase your numbers until you become a community of peoples.
- 4 and pass on the blessing of Abraham to you and your descendants so that you will get this land in which you live, this land God gave Abraham."
- 4 May he give you and your descendants the blessing given to Abraham, so that you may take possession of the land where you now live as an alien, the land God gave to Abraham."
- 5 So Isaac sent Jacob off. He went to Paddan Aram, to Laban son of Bethuel the Aramean, the brother of Rebekah who was the mother of Jacob and Esau.
- 5 Then Isaac sent Jacob on his way, and he went to Paddan Aram, to Laban son of Bethuel the Aramean, the brother of Rebekah, who was the

mother of Jacob and Esau.

6 Esau learned that Isaac had blessed Jacob and sent him to Paddan Aram to get a wife there, and while blessing him commanded, "Don't marry a Canaanite woman,"

6 Now Esau learned that Isaac had blessed Jacob and had sent him to Paddan Aram to take a wife from there, and that when he blessed him he commanded him, "Do not marry a Canaanite woman,"

7 and that Jacob had obeyed his parents and gone to Paddan Aram.

7 and that Jacob had obeyed his father and mother and had gone to Paddan Aram.

8 When Esau realized how deeply his father Isaac disliked the Canaanite women,

8 Esau then realized how displeasing the Canaanite women were to his father Isaac;

9 he went to Ishmael and married Mahalath the sister of Nebaioth and daughter of Ishmael, Abraham's son. This was in addition to the wives he already had.

9 so he went to Ishmael and married Mahalath, the sister of Nebaioth and daughter of Ishmael son of Abraham, in addition to the wives he already had.

10 Jacob left Beersheba and went to Haran.

10 Jacob left Beersheba and set out for Haran.

11 He came to a certain place and camped for the night since the sun had set. He took one of the stones there, set it under his head and lay down to sleep.

11 When he reached a certain place, he stopped for the night because the sun had set. Taking one of the stones there, he put it under his head and lay down to sleep.

12 And he dreamed: A stairway was set on the ground and it reached all the way to the sky; angels of God were going up and going down on it.

12 He had a dream in which he saw a stairway resting on the earth, with its top reaching to heaven, and the angels of God were ascending and descending on it.

13 Then GOD was right before him, saying, "I am GOD, the God of Abraham your father and the God of Isaac. I'm giving the ground on which you are sleeping to you and to your descendants.

- 13 There above it stood the LORD, and he said: "I am the LORD, the God of your father Abraham and the God of Isaac. I will give you and your descendants the land on which you are lying.
- 14 Your descendants will be as the dust of the Earth; they'll stretch from west to east and from north to south. All the families of the Earth will bless themselves in you and your descendants.
- 14 Your descendants will be like the dust of the earth, and you will spread out to the west and to the east, to the north and to the south. All peoples on earth will be blessed through you and your offspring.
- 15 Yes. I'll stay with you, I'll protect you wherever you go, and I'll bring you back to this very ground. I'll stick with you until I've done everything I promised you."
- 15 I am with you and will watch over you wherever you go, and I will bring you back to this land. I will not leave you until I have done what I have promised you."
- 16 Jacob woke up from his sleep. He said, "GOD is in this place--truly. And I didn't even know it!"
- 16 When Jacob awoke from his sleep, he thought, "Surely the LORD is in this place, and I was not aware of it."
- 17 He was terrified. He whispered in awe, "Incredible. Wonderful. Holy. This is God's House. This is the Gate of Heaven."
- 17 He was afraid and said, "How awesome is this place! This is none other than the house of God; this is the gate of heaven."
- 18 Jacob was up first thing in the morning. He took the stone he had used for his pillow and stood it up as a memorial pillar and poured oil over it.
- 18 Early the next morning Jacob took the stone he had placed under his head and set it up as a pillar and poured oil on top of it.
- 19 He christened the place Bethel (God's House). The name of the town had been Luz until then.
- 19 He called that place Bethel, though the city used to be called Luz.
- 20 Jacob vowed a vow: "If God stands by me and protects me on this journey on which I'm setting out, keeps me in food and clothing,
- 20 Then Jacob made a vow, saying, "If God will be with me and will watch over me on this journey I am taking and will give me food to eat and clothes to wear

- 21 and brings me back in one piece to my father's house, this GOD will be my God.
- 21 so that I return safely to my father's house, then the LORD will be my God
- 22 This stone that I have set up as a memorial pillar will mark this as a place where God lives. And everything you give me, I'll return a tenth to you."
- 22 and this stone that I have set up as a pillar will be God's house, and of all that you give me I will give you a tenth."

Genesis 29

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jacob set out again on his way to the people of the east.
- 1 Then Jacob continued on his journey and came to the land of the eastern peoples.
- 2 He noticed a well out in an open field with three flocks of sheep bedded down around it. This was the common well from which the flocks were watered. The stone over the mouth of the well was huge.
- 2 There he saw a well in the field, with three flocks of sheep lying near it because the flocks were watered from that well. The stone over the mouth of the well was large.
- 3 When all the flocks were gathered, the shepherds would roll the stone from the well and water the sheep; then they would return the stone, covering the well.
- 3 When all the flocks were gathered there, the shepherds would roll the stone away from the well's mouth and water the sheep. Then they would return the stone to its place over the mouth of the well.
- 4 Jacob said, "Hello friends. Where are you from?" They said, "We're from Haran."
- 4 Jacob asked the shepherds, "My brothers, where are you from?" "We're from Haran," they replied.
- 5 Jacob asked, "Do you know Laban son of Nahor?" "We do."
- 5 He said to them, "Do you know Laban, Nahor's grandson?" "Yes, we know him," they answered.

- 6 "Are things well with him?" Jacob continued. "Very well," they said. "And here is his daughter Rachel coming with the flock."
- 6 Then Jacob asked them, "Is he well?" "Yes, he is," they said, "and here comes his daughter Rachel with the sheep."
- 7 Jacob said, "There's a lot of daylight still left; it isn't time to round up the sheep yet, is it? So why not water the flocks and go back to grazing?"
- 7 Look, he said, "the sun is still high; it is not time for the flocks to be gathered. Water the sheep and take them back to pasture."
- 8 "We can't," they said. "Not until all the shepherds get here. It takes all of us to roll the stone from the well. Not until then can we water the flocks."
- 8 We can't, they replied, "until all the flocks are gathered and the stone has been rolled away from the mouth of the well. Then we will water the sheep."
- 9 While Jacob was in conversation with them, Rachel came up with her father's sheep. She was the shepherd.
- 9 While he was still talking with them, Rachel came with her father's sheep, for she was a shepherdess.
- 10 The moment Jacob spotted Rachel, daughter of Laban his mother's brother, saw her arriving with his uncle Laban's sheep, he went and single-handedly rolled the stone from the mouth of the well and watered the sheep of his uncle Laban.
- 10 When Jacob saw Rachel daughter of Laban, his mother's brother, and Laban's sheep, he went over and rolled the stone away from the mouth of the well and watered his uncle's sheep.
- 11 Then he kissed Rachel and broke into tears.
- 11 Then Jacob kissed Rachel and began to weep aloud.
- 12 He told Rachel that he was related to her father, that he was Rebekah's son. She ran and told her father.
- 12 He had told Rachel that he was a relative of her father and a son of Rebekah. So she ran and told her father.
- 13 When Laban heard the news--Jacob, his sister's son!--he ran out to meet him, embraced and kissed him and brought him home. Jacob told Laban the story of everything that had happened.
- 13 As soon as Laban heard the news about Jacob, his sister's son, he hurried to meet him. He embraced him and kissed him and brought him

to his home, and there Jacob told him all these things.

14 Laban said, "You're family! My flesh and blood!" When Jacob had been with him for a month,

14 Then Laban said to him, "You are my own flesh and blood." After Jacob had stayed with him for a whole month,

15 Laban said, "Just because you're my nephew, you shouldn't work for me for nothing. Tell me what you want to be paid. What's a fair wage?"

15 Laban said to him, "Just because you are a relative of mine, should you work for me for nothing? Tell me what your wages should be."

16 Now Laban had two daughters; Leah was the older and Rachel the younger.

16 Now Laban had two daughters; the name of the older was Leah, and the name of the younger was Rachel.

17 Leah had nice eyes, but Rachel was stunningly beautiful.

17 Leah had weak eyes, but Rachel was lovely in form, and beautiful.

18 And it was Rachel that Jacob loved. So Jacob answered, "I will work for you seven years for your younger daughter Rachel."

18 Jacob was in love with Rachel and said, "I'll work for you seven years in return for your younger daughter Rachel."

19 "It is far better," said Laban, "that I give her to you than marry her to some outsider. Yes. Stay here with me."

19 Laban said, "It's better that I give her to you than to some other man. Stay here with me."

20 So Jacob worked seven years for Rachel. But it only seemed like a few days, he loved her so much.

20 So Jacob served seven years to get Rachel, but they seemed like only a few days to him because of his love for her.

21 Then Jacob said to Laban, "Give me my wife; I've completed what we agreed I'd do. I'm ready to consummate my marriage."

21 Then Jacob said to Laban, "Give me my wife. My time is completed, and I want to lie with her."

22 Laban invited everyone around and threw a big feast.

22 So Laban brought together all the people of the place and gave a feast.

23 At evening, though, he got his daughter Leah and brought her to the marriage bed, and Jacob slept with her.

23 But when evening came, he took his daughter Leah and gave her to Jacob, and Jacob lay with her.

24 (Laban gave his maid Zilpah to his daughter Leah as her maid.)

24 And Laban gave his servant girl Zilpah to his daughter as her maidservant.

25 Morning came: There was Leah in the marriage bed! Jacob confronted Laban, "What have you done to me? Didn't I work all this time for the hand of Rachel? Why did you cheat me?"

25 When morning came, there was Leah! So Jacob said to Laban, "What is this you have done to me? I served you for Rachel, didn't I? Why have you deceived me?"

26 "We don't do it that way in our country," said Laban. "We don't marry off the younger daughter before the older.

26 Laban replied, "It is not our custom here to give the younger daughter in marriage before the older one.

27 Enjoy your week of honeymoon, and then we'll give you the other one also. But it will cost you another seven years of work."

27 Finish this daughter's bridal week; then we will give you the younger one also, in return for another seven years of work."

28 Jacob agreed. When he'd completed the honeymoon week, Laban gave him his daughter Rachel to be his wife.

28 And Jacob did so. He finished the week with Leah, and then Laban gave him his daughter Rachel to be his wife.

29 (Laban gave his maid Bilhah to his daughter Rachel as her maid.)

29 Laban gave his servant girl Bilhah to his daughter Rachel as her maidservant.

30 Jacob then slept with her. And he loved Rachel more than Leah. He worked for Laban another seven years.

30 Jacob lay with Rachel also, and he loved Rachel more than Leah. And he worked for Laban another seven years.

31 When GOD realized that Leah was unloved, he opened her womb. But Rachel was barren.

31 When the LORD saw that Leah was not loved, he opened her womb, but Rachel was barren.

32 Leah became pregnant and had a son. She named him Reuben (Look-It's-a-Boy!). "This is a sign," she said, "that GOD has seen my misery;

and a sign that now my husband will love me."

32 Leah became pregnant and gave birth to a son. She named him Reuben, for she said, "It is because the LORD has seen my misery. Surely my husband will love me now."

33 She became pregnant again and had another son. "GOD heard," she said, "that I was unloved and so he gave me this son also." She named this one Simeon (GOD-Heard).

33 She conceived again, and when she gave birth to a son she said, "Because the LORD heard that I am not loved, he gave me this one too." So she named him Simeon.

34 She became pregnant yet again--another son. She said, "Now maybe my husband will connect with me--I've given him three sons!" That's why she named him Levi (Connect).

34 Again she conceived, and when she gave birth to a son she said, "Now at last my husband will become attached to me, because I have borne him three sons." So he was named Levi.

35 She became pregnant a final time and had a fourth son. She said, "This time I'll praise GOD." So she named him Judah (Praise-GOD). Then she stopped having children.

35 She conceived again, and when she gave birth to a son she said, "This time I will praise the LORD." So she named him Judah. Then she stopped having children.

Genesis 30

MSG

NIV

1 When Rachel realized that she wasn't having any children for Jacob, she became jealous of her sister. She told Jacob, "Give me sons or I'll die!"

1 When Rachel saw that she was not bearing Jacob any children, she became jealous of her sister. So she said to Jacob, "Give me children, or I'll die!"

2 Jacob got angry with Rachel and said, "Am I God? Am I the one who refused you babies?"

2 Jacob became angry with her and said, "Am I in the place of God, who has kept you from having children?"

- 3 Rachel said, "Here's my maid Bilhah. Sleep with her. Let her substitute for me so I can have a child through her and build a family."
- 3 Then she said, "Here is Bilhah, my maidservant. Sleep with her so that she can bear children for me and that through her I too can build a family."
- 4 So she gave him her maid Bilhah for a wife and Jacob slept with her.
- 4 So she gave him her servant Bilhah as a wife. Jacob slept with her,
- 5 Bilhah became pregnant and gave Jacob a son.
- 5 and she became pregnant and bore him a son.
- 6 Rachel said, "God took my side and vindicated me. He listened to me and gave me a son." She named him Dan (Vindication).
- 6 Then Rachel said, "God has vindicated me; he has listened to my plea and given me a son." Because of this she named him Dan.
- 7 Rachel's maid Bilhah became pregnant again and gave Jacob a second son.
- 7 Rachel's servant Bilhah conceived again and bore Jacob a second son.
- 8 Rachel said, "I've been in an all-out fight with my sister--and I've won." So she named him Naphtali (Fight).
- 8 Then Rachel said, "I have had a great struggle with my sister, and I have won." So she named him Naphtali.
- 9 When Leah saw that she wasn't having any more children, she gave her maid Zilpah to Jacob for a wife.
- 9 When Leah saw that she had stopped having children, she took her maidservant Zilpah and gave her to Jacob as a wife.
- 10 Zilpah had a son for Jacob.
- 10 Leah's servant Zilpah bore Jacob a son.
- 11 Leah said, "How fortunate!" and she named him Gad (Lucky).
- 11 Then Leah said, "What good fortune!" So she named him Gad.
- 12 When Leah's maid Zilpah had a second son for Jacob,
- 12 Leah's servant Zilpah bore Jacob a second son.
- 13 Leah said, "A happy day! The women will congratulate me in my happiness." So she named him Asher (Happy).
- 13 Then Leah said, "How happy I am! The women will call me happy." So she named him Asher.
- 14 One day during the wheat harvest Reuben found some mandrakes in the field and brought them home to his mother Leah. Rachel asked Leah,

- "Could I please have some of your son's mandrakes?"
- 14 During wheat harvest, Reuben went out into the fields and found some mandrake plants, which he brought to his mother Leah. Rachel said to Leah, "Please give me some of your son's mandrakes."
- 15 Leah said, "Wasn't it enough that you got my husband away from me? And now you also want my son's mandrakes?" Rachel said, "All right. I'll let him sleep with you tonight in exchange for your son's love-apples."
- 15 But she said to her, "Wasn't it enough that you took away my husband? Will you take my son's mandrakes too?" "Very well," Rachel said, "he can sleep with you tonight in return for your son's mandrakes."
- 16 When Jacob came home that evening from the fields, Leah was there to meet him: "Sleep with me tonight; I've bartered my son's mandrakes for a night with you." So he slept with her that night.
- 16 So when Jacob came in from the fields that evening, Leah went out to meet him. "You must sleep with me," she said. "I have hired you with my son's mandrakes." So he slept with her that night.
- 17 God listened to Leah; she became pregnant and gave Jacob a fifth son.
- 17 God listened to Leah, and she became pregnant and bore Jacob a fifth son.
- 18 She said, "God rewarded me for giving my maid to my husband." She named him Issachar (Bartered).
- 18 Then Leah said, "God has rewarded me for giving my maidservant to my husband." So she named him Issachar.
- 19 Leah became pregnant yet again and gave Jacob a sixth son,
- 19 Leah conceived again and bore Jacob a sixth son.
- 20 saying, "God has given me a great gift. This time my husband will honor me with gifts--I've given him six sons!" She named him Zebulun (Honor).
- 20 Then Leah said, "God has presented me with a precious gift. This time my husband will treat me with honor, because I have borne him six sons." So she named him Zebulun.
- 21 Last of all she had a daughter and named her Dinah.
- 21 Some time later she gave birth to a daughter and named her Dinah.
- 22 And then God remembered Rachel. God listened to her and opened her womb.

22 Then God remembered Rachel; he listened to her and opened her womb.

23 She became pregnant and had a son. She said, "God has taken away my humiliation."

23 She became pregnant and gave birth to a son and said, "God has taken away my disgrace."

24 She named him Joseph (Add), praying, "May GOD add yet another son to me."

24 She named him Joseph, and said, "May the LORD add to me another son."

25 After Rachel had had Joseph, Jacob spoke to Laban, "Let me go back home.

25 After Rachel gave birth to Joseph, Jacob said to Laban, "Send me on my way so I can go back to my own homeland.

26 Give me my wives and children for whom I've served you. You know how hard I've worked for you."

26 Give me my wives and children, for whom I have served you, and I will be on my way. You know how much work I've done for you."

27 Laban said, "If you please, I have learned through divine inquiry that GOD has blessed me because of you."

27 But Laban said to him, "If I have found favor in your eyes, please stay. I have learned by divination that the LORD has blessed me because of you."

28 He went on, "So name your wages. I'll pay you."

28 He added, "Name your wages, and I will pay them."

29 Jacob replied, "You know well what my work has meant to you and how your livestock has flourished under my care.

29 Jacob said to him, "You know how I have worked for you and how your livestock has fared under my care.

30 The little you had when I arrived has increased greatly; everything I did resulted in blessings for you. Isn't it about time that I do something for my own family?"

30 The little you had before I came has increased greatly, and the LORD has blessed you wherever I have been. But now, when may I do something for my own household?"

- 31 "So, what should I pay you?" Jacob said, "You don't have to pay me a thing. But how about this? I will go back to pasture and care for your flocks.
- 31 What shall I give you? he asked. "Don't give me anything," Jacob replied. "But if you will do this one thing for me, I will go on tending your flocks and watching over them:
- 32 Go through your entire flock today and take out every speckled or spotted sheep, every dark-colored lamb, every spotted or speckled goat. They will be my wages.
- 32 Let me go through all your flocks today and remove from them every speckled or spotted sheep, every dark-colored lamb and every spotted or speckled goat. They will be my wages.
- 33 That way you can check on my honesty when you assess my wages. If you find any goat that's not speckled or spotted or a sheep that's not black, you will know that I stole it."
- 33 And my honesty will testify for me in the future, whenever you check on the wages you have paid me. Any goat in my possession that is not speckled or spotted, or any lamb that is not dark-colored, will be considered stolen."
- 34 "Fair enough," said Laban. "It's a deal."
- 34 Agreed, said Laban. "Let it be as you have said."
- 35 But that very day Laban removed all the mottled and spotted billy goats and all the speckled and spotted nanny-goats, every animal that had even a touch of white on it plus all the black sheep and placed them under the care of his sons.
- 35 That same day he removed all the male goats that were streaked or spotted, and all the speckled or spotted female goats (all that had white on them) and all the dark-colored lambs, and he placed them in the care of his sons.
- 36 Then he put a three-day journey between himself and Jacob. Meanwhile Jacob went on tending what was left of Laban's flock.
- 36 Then he put a three-day journey between himself and Jacob, while Jacob continued to tend the rest of Laban's flocks.
- 37 But Jacob got fresh branches from poplar, almond, and plane trees and peeled the bark, leaving white stripes on them.

37 Jacob, however, took fresh-cut branches from poplar, almond and plane trees and made white stripes on them by peeling the bark and exposing the white inner wood of the branches.

38 He stuck the peeled branches in front of the watering troughs where the flocks came to drink. When the flocks were in heat, they came to drink

38 Then he placed the peeled branches in all the watering troughs, so that they would be directly in front of the flocks when they came to drink. When the flocks were in heat and came to drink,

39 and mated in front of the streaked branches. Then they gave birth to young that were streaked or spotted or speckled.

39 they mated in front of the branches. And they bore young that were streaked or speckled or spotted.

40 Jacob placed the ewes before the dark-colored animals of Laban. That way he got distinctive flocks for himself which he didn't mix with Laban's flocks.

40 Jacob set apart the young of the flock by themselves, but made the rest face the streaked and dark-colored animals that belonged to Laban. Thus he made separate flocks for himself and did not put them with Laban's animals.

41 And when the sturdier animals were mating, Jacob placed branches at the troughs in view of the animals so that they mated in front of the branches.

41 Whenever the stronger females were in heat, Jacob would place the branches in the troughs in front of the animals so they would mate near the branches,

42 But he wouldn't set up the branches before the feeble animals. That way the feeble animals went to Laban and the sturdy ones to Jacob.

42 but if the animals were weak, he would not place them there. So the weak animals went to Laban and the strong ones to Jacob.

43 The man got richer and richer, acquiring huge flocks, lots and lots of servants, not to mention camels and donkeys.

43 In this way the man grew exceedingly prosperous and came to own large flocks, and maidservants and menservants, and camels and donkeys.

Genesis 31

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jacob learned that Laban's sons were talking behind his back: "Jacob has used our father's wealth to make himself rich at our father's expense."
- 1 Jacob heard that Laban's sons were saying, "Jacob has taken everything our father owned and has gained all this wealth from what belonged to our father."
- 2 At the same time, Jacob noticed that Laban had changed toward him. He wasn't treating him the same.
- 2 And Jacob noticed that Laban's attitude toward him was not what it had been.
- 3 That's when GOD said to Jacob, "Go back home where you were born. I'll go with you."
- 3 Then the LORD said to Jacob, "Go back to the land of your fathers and to your relatives, and I will be with you."
- 4 So Jacob sent word for Rachel and Leah to meet him out in the field where his flocks were.
- 4 So Jacob sent word to Rachel and Leah to come out to the fields where his flocks were.
- 5 He said, "I notice that your father has changed toward me; he doesn't treat me the same as before. But the God of my father hasn't changed; he's still with me.
- 5 He said to them, "I see that your father's attitude toward me is not what it was before, but the God of my father has been with me.
- 6 You know how hard I've worked for your father.
- 6 You know that I've worked for your father with all my strength,
- 7 Still, your father has cheated me over and over, changing my wages time and again. But God never let him really hurt me.
- 7 yet your father has cheated me by changing my wages ten times. However, God has not allowed him to harm me.
- 8 If he said, 'Your wages will consist of speckled animals' the whole flock would start having speckled lambs and kids. And if he said, 'From now on your wages will be streaked animals' the whole flock would have streaked ones.

- 8 If he said, 'The speckled ones will be your wages,' then all the flocks gave birth to speckled young; and if he said, 'The streaked ones will be your wages,' then all the flocks bore streaked young.
- 9 Over and over God used your father's livestock to reward me.
- 9 So God has taken away your father's livestock and has given them to me.
- 10 "Once, while the flocks were mating, I had a dream and saw the billy goats, all of them streaked, speckled, and mottled, mounting their mates.
- 10 In breeding season I once had a dream in which I looked up and saw that the male goats mating with the flock were streaked, speckled or spotted.
- 11 In the dream an angel of God called out to me, 'Jacob!' "I said, 'Yes?'
- 11 The angel of God said to me in the dream, 'Jacob.' I answered, 'Here I am.'
- 12 "He said, 'Watch closely. Notice that all the goats in the flock that are mating are streaked, speckled, and mottled. I know what Laban's been doing to you.
- 12 And he said, 'Look up and see that all the male goats mating with the flock are streaked, speckled or spotted, for I have seen all that Laban has been doing to you.
- 13 I'm the God of Bethel where you consecrated a pillar and made a vow to me. Now be on your way, get out of this place, go home to your birthplace."
- 13 I am the God of Bethel, where you anointed a pillar and where you made a vow to me. Now leave this land at once and go back to your native land.' "
- 14 Rachel and Leah said, "Has he treated us any better?
- 14 Then Rachel and Leah replied, "Do we still have any share in the inheritance of our father's estate?
- 15 Aren't we treated worse than outsiders? All he wanted was the money he got from selling us, and he's spent all that.
- 15 Does he not regard us as foreigners? Not only has he sold us, but he has used up what was paid for us.
- 16 Any wealth that God has seen fit to return to us from our father is justly ours and our children's. Go ahead. Do what God told you."
- 16 Surely all the wealth that God took away from our father belongs to us and our children. So do whatever God has told you."

17 Jacob did it. He put his children and his wives on camels
17 Then Jacob put his children and his wives on camels,
18 and gathered all his livestock and everything he had gotten, everything
acquired in Paddan Aram, to go back home to his father Isaac in the land
of Canaan.
18 and he drove all his livestock ahead of him, along with all the goods he
had accumulated in Paddan Aram, to go to his father Isaac in the land of
Canaan.
19 Laban was off shearing sheep. Rachel stole her father's household gods.
19 When Laban had gone to shear his sheep, Rachel stole her father's
household gods.
20 And Jacob had concealed his plans so well that Laban the Aramean had
no idea what was going on--he was totally in the dark.
20 Moreover, Jacob deceived Laban the Aramean by not telling him he was
running away.
21 Jacob got away with everything he had and was soon across the
Euphrates headed for the hill country of Gilead.
21 So he fled with all he had, and crossing the River, he headed for the hill
country of Gilead.
22 Three days later, Laban got the news: "Jacob's run off."
22 On the third day Laban was told that Jacob had fled.
23 Laban rounded up his relatives and chased after him. Seven days later
they caught up with him in the hill country of Gilead.
23 Taking his relatives with him, he pursued Jacob for seven days and
caught up with him in the hill country of Gilead.
24 That night God came to Laban the Aramean in a dream and said, "Be
careful what you do to Jacob, whether good or bad."
24 Then God came to Laban the Aramean in a dream at night and said to
him, "Be careful not to say anything to Jacob, either good or bad."
25 When Laban reached him, Jacob's tents were pitched in the Gilead
mountains; Laban pitched his tents there too.
25 Jacob had pitched his tent in the hill country of Gilead when Laban
overtook him, and Laban and his relatives camped there too.
26 "What do you mean," said Laban, "by keeping me in the dark and
sneaking off, hauling my daughters off like prisoners of war?"

- 26 Then Laban said to Jacob, "What have you done? You've deceived me, and you've carried off my daughters like captives in war.
- 27 Why did you run off like a thief in the night? Why didn't you tell me? Why, I would have sent you off with a great celebration--music, timbrels, flutes!
- 27 Why did you run off secretly and deceive me? Why didn't you tell me, so I could send you away with joy and singing to the music of tambourines and harps?
- 28 But you wouldn't permit me so much as a kiss for my daughters and grandchildren. It was a stupid thing for you to do.
- 28 You didn't even let me kiss my grandchildren and my daughters good-bye. You have done a foolish thing.
- 29 If I had a mind to, I could destroy you right now, but the God of your father spoke to me last night, 'Be careful what you do to Jacob, whether good or bad.'
- 29 I have the power to harm you; but last night the God of your father said to me, 'Be careful not to say anything to Jacob, either good or bad.'
- 30 I understand. You left because you were homesick. But why did you steal my household gods?"
- 30 Now you have gone off because you longed to return to your father's house. But why did you steal my gods?"
- 31 Jacob answered Laban, "I was afraid. I thought you would take your daughters away from me by brute force.
- 31 Jacob answered Laban, "I was afraid, because I thought you would take your daughters away from me by force.
- 32 But as far as your gods are concerned, if you find that anybody here has them, that person dies. With all of us watching, look around. If you find anything here that belongs to you, take it." Jacob didn't know that Rachel had stolen the gods.
- 32 But if you find anyone who has your gods, he shall not live. In the presence of our relatives, see for yourself whether there is anything of yours here with me; and if so, take it." Now Jacob did not know that Rachel had stolen the gods.
- 33 Laban went through Jacob's tent, Leah's tent, and the tents of the two maids but didn't find them. He went from Leah's tent to Rachel's.

- 33 So Laban went into Jacob's tent and into Leah's tent and into the tent of the two maidservants, but he found nothing. After he came out of Leah's tent, he entered Rachel's tent.
- 34 But Rachel had taken the household gods, put them inside a camel cushion, and was sitting on them. When Laban had gone through the tent, searching high and low without finding a thing,
- 34 Now Rachel had taken the household gods and put them inside her camel's saddle and was sitting on them. Laban searched through everything in the tent but found nothing.
- 35 Rachel said to her father, "Don't think I'm being disrespectful, my master, that I can't stand before you, but I'm having my period." So even though he turned the place upside down in his search, he didn't find the household gods.
- 35 Rachel said to her father, "Don't be angry, my lord, that I cannot stand up in your presence; I'm having my period." So he searched but could not find the household gods.
- 36 Now it was Jacob's turn to get angry. He lit into Laban: "So what's my crime, what wrong have I done you that you badger me like this?"
- 36 Jacob was angry and took Laban to task. "What is my crime?" he asked Laban. "What sin have I committed that you hunt me down?"
- 37 You've ransacked the place. Have you turned up a single thing that's yours? Let's see it--display the evidence. Our two families can be the jury and decide between us.
- 37 Now that you have searched through all my goods, what have you found that belongs to your household? Put it here in front of your relatives and mine, and let them judge between the two of us.
- 38 "In the twenty years I've worked for you, ewes and she-goats never miscarried. I never feasted on the rams from your flock.
- 38 I have been with you for twenty years now. Your sheep and goats have not miscarried, nor have I eaten rams from your flocks.
- 39 I never brought you a torn carcass killed by wild animals but that I paid for it out of my own pocket--actually, you made me pay whether it was my fault or not.
- 39 I did not bring you animals torn by wild beasts; I bore the loss myself. And you demanded payment from me for whatever was stolen by day or night.

- 40 I was out in all kinds of weather, from torrid heat to freezing cold, putting in many a sleepless night.
- 40 This was my situation: The heat consumed me in the daytime and the cold at night, and sleep fled from my eyes.
- 41 For twenty years I've done this: I slaved away fourteen years for your two daughters and another six years for your flock and you changed my wages ten times.
- 41 It was like this for the twenty years I was in your household. I worked for you fourteen years for your two daughters and six years for your flocks, and you changed my wages ten times.
- 42 If the God of my father, the God of Abraham and the Fear of Isaac, had not stuck with me, you would have sent me off penniless. But God saw the fix I was in and how hard I had worked and last night rendered his verdict."
- 42 If the God of my father, the God of Abraham and the Fear of Isaac, had not been with me, you would surely have sent me away empty-handed. But God has seen my hardship and the toil of my hands, and last night he rebuked you."
- 43 Laban defended himself: "The daughters are my daughters, the children are my children, the flock is my flock--everything you see is mine. But what can I do about my daughters or for the children they've had?
- 43 Laban answered Jacob, "The women are my daughters, the children are my children, and the flocks are my flocks. All you see is mine. Yet what can I do today about these daughters of mine, or about the children they have borne?
- 44 So let's settle things between us, make a covenant--God will be the witness between us."
- 44 Come now, let's make a covenant, you and I, and let it serve as a witness between us."
- 45 Jacob took a stone and set it upright as a pillar.
- 45 So Jacob took a stone and set it up as a pillar.
- 46 Jacob called his family around, "Get stones!" They gathered stones and heaped them up and then ate there beside the pile of stones.
- 46 He said to his relatives, "Gather some stones." So they took stones and piled them in a heap, and they ate there by the heap.

- 47 Laban named it in Aramaic, Yegar-sahadutha (Witness Monument); Jacob echoed the naming in Hebrew, Galeed (Witness Monument).
- 47 Laban called it Jegar Sahadutha, and Jacob called it Galeed.
- 48 Laban said, "This monument of stones will be a witness, beginning now, between you and me." (That's why it is called Galeed--Witness Monument.)
- 48 Laban said, "This heap is a witness between you and me today." That is why it was called Galeed.
- 49 It is also called Mizpah (Watchtower) because Laban said, "GOD keep watch between you and me when we are out of each other's sight.
- 49 It was also called Mizpah, because he said, "May the LORD keep watch between you and me when we are away from each other.
- 50 If you mistreat my daughters or take other wives when there's no one around to see you, God will see you and stand witness between us."
- 50 If you mistreat my daughters or if you take any wives besides my daughters, even though no one is with us, remember that God is a witness between you and me."
- 51 Laban continued to Jacob, "This monument of stones and this stone pillar that I have set up is a witness,
- 51 Laban also said to Jacob, "Here is this heap, and here is this pillar I have set up between you and me.
- 52 a witness that I won't cross this line to hurt you and you won't cross this line to hurt me.
- 52 This heap is a witness, and this pillar is a witness, that I will not go past this heap to your side to harm you and that you will not go past this heap and pillar to my side to harm me.
- 53 The God of Abraham and the God of Nahor (the God of their ancestor) will keep things straight between us." Jacob promised, swearing by the Fear, the God of his father Isaac.
- 53 May the God of Abraham and the God of Nahor, the God of their father, judge between us." So Jacob took an oath in the name of the Fear of his father Isaac.
- 54 Then Jacob offered a sacrifice on the mountain and worshiped, calling in all his family members to the meal. They ate and slept that night on the mountain.

54 He offered a sacrifice there in the hill country and invited his relatives to a meal. After they had eaten, they spent the night there.

55 Laban got up early the next morning, kissed his grandchildren and his daughters, blessed them, and then set off for home.

55 Early the next morning Laban kissed his grandchildren and his daughters and blessed them. Then he left and returned home.

Genesis 32

MSG

NIV

1 And Jacob went his way. Angels of God met him.

1 Jacob also went on his way, and the angels of God met him.

2 When Jacob saw them he said, "Oh! God's Camp!" And he named the place Mahanaim (Campground).

2 When Jacob saw them, he said, "This is the camp of God!" So he named that place Mahanaim.

3 Then Jacob sent messengers on ahead to his brother Esau in the land of Seir in Edom.

3 Jacob sent messengers ahead of him to his brother Esau in the land of Seir, the country of Edom.

4 He instructed them: "Tell my master Esau this, 'A message from your servant Jacob: I've been staying with Laban and couldn't get away until now.

4 He instructed them: "This is what you are to say to my master Esau: 'Your servant Jacob says, I have been staying with Laban and have remained there till now.

5 I've acquired cattle and donkeys and sheep; also men and women servants. I'm telling you all this, my master, hoping for your approval.'"

5 I have cattle and donkeys, sheep and goats, menservants and maidservants. Now I am sending this message to my lord, that I may find favor in your eyes.' "

6 The messengers came back to Jacob and said, "We talked to your brother Esau and he's on his way to meet you. But he has four hundred men with him."

- 6 When the messengers returned to Jacob, they said, "We went to your brother Esau, and now he is coming to meet you, and four hundred men are with him."
- 7 Jacob was scared. Very scared. Panicked, he divided his people, sheep, cattle, and camels into two camps.
- 7 In great fear and distress Jacob divided the people who were with him into two groups, and the flocks and herds and camels as well.
- 8 He thought, "If Esau comes on the first camp and attacks it, the other camp has a chance to get away."
- 8 He thought, "If Esau comes and attacks one group, the group that is left may escape."
- 9 And then Jacob prayed, "God of my father Abraham, God of my father Isaac, GOD who told me, 'Go back to your parents' homeland and I'll treat you well.'
- 9 Then Jacob prayed, "O God of my father Abraham, God of my father Isaac, O LORD, who said to me, 'Go back to your country and your relatives, and I will make you prosper,'
- 10 I don't deserve all the love and loyalty you've shown me. When I left here and crossed the Jordan I only had the clothes on my back, and now look at me--two camps!
- 10 I am unworthy of all the kindness and faithfulness you have shown your servant. I had only my staff when I crossed this Jordan, but now I have become two groups.
- 11 Save me, please, from the violence of my brother, my angry brother! I'm afraid he'll come and attack us all, me, the mothers and the children.
- 11 Save me, I pray, from the hand of my brother Esau, for I am afraid he will come and attack me, and also the mothers with their children.
- 12 You yourself said, 'I will treat you well; I'll make your descendants like the sands of the sea, far too many to count.'"
- 12 But you have said, 'I will surely make you prosper and will make your descendants like the sand of the sea, which cannot be counted.' "
- 13 He slept the night there. Then he prepared a present for his brother Esau from his possessions:
- 13 He spent the night there, and from what he had with him he selected a gift for his brother Esau:

- 14 two hundred female goats, twenty male goats, two hundred ewes and twenty rams,
- 14 two hundred female goats and twenty male goats, two hundred ewes and twenty rams,
- 15 thirty camels with their nursing young, forty cows and ten bulls, twenty female donkeys and ten male donkeys.
- 15 thirty female camels with their young, forty cows and ten bulls, and twenty female donkeys and ten male donkeys.
- 16 He put a servant in charge of each herd and said, "Go ahead of me and keep a healthy space between each herd."
- 16 He put them in the care of his servants, each herd by itself, and said to his servants, "Go ahead of me, and keep some space between the herds."
- 17 Then he instructed the first one out: "When my brother Esau comes close and asks, 'Who is your master? Where are you going? Who owns these?'--
- 17 He instructed the one in the lead: "When my brother Esau meets you and asks, 'To whom do you belong, and where are you going, and who owns all these animals in front of you?'
- 18 answer him like this, 'Your servant Jacob. They are a gift to my master Esau. He's on his way.'"
- 18 then you are to say, 'They belong to your servant Jacob. They are a gift sent to my lord Esau, and he is coming behind us.' "
- 19 He gave the same instructions to the second servant and to the third--to each in turn as they set out with their herds:
- 19 He also instructed the second, the third and all the others who followed the herds: "You are to say the same thing to Esau when you meet him.
- 20 "Say 'Your servant Jacob is on his way behind us.'" He thought, "I will soften him up with the succession of gifts. Then when he sees me face-to-face, maybe he'll be glad to welcome me."
- 20 And be sure to say, 'Your servant Jacob is coming behind us.' " For he thought, "I will pacify him with these gifts I am sending on ahead; later, when I see him, perhaps he will receive me."
- 21 So his gifts went before him while he settled down for the night in the camp.
- 21 So Jacob's gifts went on ahead of him, but he himself spent the night in the camp.

22 But during the night he got up and took his two wives, his two maidservants, and his eleven children and crossed the ford of the Jabbok.

22 That night Jacob got up and took his two wives, his two maidservants and his eleven sons and crossed the ford of the Jabbok.

23 He got them safely across the brook along with all his possessions.

23 After he had sent them across the stream, he sent over all his possessions.

24 But Jacob stayed behind by himself, and a man wrestled with him until daybreak.

24 So Jacob was left alone, and a man wrestled with him till daybreak.

25 When the man saw that he couldn't get the best of Jacob as they wrestled, he deliberately threw Jacob's hip out of joint.

25 When the man saw that he could not overpower him, he touched the socket of Jacob's hip so that his hip was wrenched as he wrestled with the man.

26 The man said, "Let me go; it's daybreak." Jacob said, "I'm not letting you go 'til you bless me."

26 Then the man said, "Let me go, for it is daybreak." But Jacob replied, "I will not let you go unless you bless me."

27 The man said, "What's your name?" He answered, "Jacob."

27 The man asked him, "What is your name?" "Jacob," he answered.

28 The man said, "But no longer. Your name is no longer Jacob. From now on it's Israel (God-Wrestler); you've wrestled with God and you've come through."

28 Then the man said, "Your name will no longer be Jacob, but Israel, because you have struggled with God and with men and have overcome."

29 Jacob asked, "And what's your name?" The man said, "Why do you want to know my name?" And then, right then and there, he blessed him.

29 Jacob said, "Please tell me your name." But he replied, "Why do you ask my name?" Then he blessed him there.

30 Jacob named the place Peniel (God's Face) because, he said, "I saw God face-to-face and lived to tell the story!"

30 So Jacob called the place Peniel, saying, "It is because I saw God face to face, and yet my life was spared."

31 The sun came up as he left Peniel, limping because of his hip.

- 31 The sun rose above him as he passed Peniel, and he was limping because of his hip.
- 32 (This is why Israelites to this day don't eat the hip muscle; because Jacob's hip was thrown out of joint.)
- 32 Therefore to this day the Israelites do not eat the tendon attached to the socket of the hip, because the socket of Jacob's hip was touched near the tendon.

Genesis 33

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jacob looked up and saw Esau coming with his four hundred men. He divided the children between Leah and Rachel and the two maidservants.
- 1 Jacob looked up and there was Esau, coming with his four hundred men; so he divided the children among Leah, Rachel and the two maidservants.
- 2 He put the maidservants out in front, Leah and her children next, and Rachel and Joseph last.
- 2 He put the maidservants and their children in front, Leah and her children next, and Rachel and Joseph in the rear.
- 3 He led the way and, as he approached his brother, bowed seven times, honoring his brother.
- 3 He himself went on ahead and bowed down to the ground seven times as he approached his brother.
- 4 But Esau ran up and embraced him, held him tight and kissed him. And they both wept.
- 4 But Esau ran to meet Jacob and embraced him; he threw his arms around his neck and kissed him. And they wept.
- 5 Then Esau looked around and saw the women and children: "And who are these with you?" Jacob said, "The children that God saw fit to bless me with."
- 5 Then Esau looked up and saw the women and children. "Who are these with you?" he asked. Jacob answered, "They are the children God has graciously given your servant."
- 6 Then the maidservants came up with their children and bowed;

- 6 Then the maidservants and their children approached and bowed down.
- 7 then Leah and her children, also bowing; and finally, Joseph and Rachel came up and bowed to Esau.
- 7 Next, Leah and her children came and bowed down. Last of all came Joseph and Rachel, and they too bowed down.
- 8 Esau then asked, "And what was the meaning of all those herds that I met?" "I was hoping that they would pave the way for my master to welcome me."
- 8 Esau asked, "What do you mean by all these droves I met?" "To find favor in your eyes, my lord," he said.
- 9 Esau said, "Oh, brother. I have plenty of everything--keep what is yours for yourself."
- 9 But Esau said, "I already have plenty, my brother. Keep what you have for yourself."
- 10 Jacob said, "Please. If you can find it in your heart to welcome me, accept these gifts. When I saw your face, it was as the face of God smiling on me.
- 10 No, please! said Jacob. "If I have found favor in your eyes, accept this gift from me. For to see your face is like seeing the face of God, now that you have received me favorably.
- 11 Accept the gifts I have brought for you. God has been good to me and I have more than enough." Jacob urged the gifts on him and Esau accepted.
- 11 Please accept the present that was brought to you, for God has been gracious to me and I have all I need." And because Jacob insisted, Esau accepted it.
- 12 Then Esau said, "Let's start out on our way; I'll take the lead."
- 12 Then Esau said, "Let us be on our way; I'll accompany you."
- 13 But Jacob said, "My master can see that the children are frail. And the flocks and herds are nursing, making for slow going. If I push them too hard, even for a day, I'd lose them all.
- 13 But Jacob said to him, "My lord knows that the children are tender and that I must care for the ewes and cows that are nursing their young. If they are driven hard just one day, all the animals will die.
- 14 So, master, you go on ahead of your servant, while I take it easy at the pace of my flocks and children. I'll catch up with you in Seir."

- 14 So let my lord go on ahead of his servant, while I move along slowly at the pace of the droves before me and that of the children, until I come to my lord in Seir."
- 15 Esau said, "Let me at least lend you some of my men." "There's no need," said Jacob. "Your generous welcome is all I need or want."
- 15 Esau said, "Then let me leave some of my men with you." "But why do that?" Jacob asked. "Just let me find favor in the eyes of my lord."
- 16 So Esau set out that day and made his way back to Seir.
- 16 So that day Esau started on his way back to Seir.
- 17 And Jacob left for Succoth. He built a shelter for himself and sheds for his livestock. That's how the place came to be called Succoth (Sheds).
- 17 Jacob, however, went to Succoth, where he built a place for himself and made shelters for his livestock. That is why the place is called Succoth.
- 18 And that's how it happened that Jacob arrived all in one piece in Shechem in the land of Canaan--all the way from Paddan Aram. He camped near the city.
- 18 After Jacob came from Paddan Aram, he arrived safely at the city of Shechem in Canaan and camped within sight of the city.
- 19 He bought the land where he pitched his tent from the sons of Hamor, the father of Shechem. He paid a hundred silver coins for it.
- 19 For a hundred pieces of silver, he bought from the sons of Hamor, the father of Shechem, the plot of ground where he pitched his tent.
- 20 Then he built an altar there and named it El-Elohe-Israel (Mighty Is the God of Israel).
- 20 There he set up an altar and called it El Elohe Israel.

Genesis 34

MSG

NIV

- 1 One day Dinah, the daughter Leah had given Jacob, went to visit some of the women in that country.
- 1 Now Dinah, the daughter Leah had borne to Jacob, went out to visit the women of the land.
- 2 Shechem, the son of Hamor the Hivite who was chieftain there, saw her and raped her.

- 2 When Shechem son of Hamor the Hivite, the ruler of that area, saw her, he took her and violated her.
- 3 Then he felt a strong attraction to Dinah, Jacob's daughter, fell in love with her and wooed her.
- 3 His heart was drawn to Dinah daughter of Jacob, and he loved the girl and spoke tenderly to her.
- 4 Shechem went to his father Hamor, "Get me this girl for my wife."
- 4 And Shechem said to his father Hamor, "Get me this girl as my wife."
- 5 Jacob heard that Shechem had raped his daughter Dinah, but his sons were out in the fields with the livestock so he didn't say anything until they got home.
- 5 When Jacob heard that his daughter Dinah had been defiled, his sons were in the fields with his livestock; so he kept quiet about it until they came home.
- 6 Hamor, Shechem's father, went to Jacob to work out marriage arrangements.
- 6 Then Shechem's father Hamor went out to talk with Jacob.
- 7 Meanwhile Jacob's sons on their way back from the fields heard what had happened. They were outraged, explosive with anger. Shechem's rape of Jacob's daughter was intolerable in Israel and not to be put up with.
- 7 Now Jacob's sons had come in from the fields as soon as they heard what had happened. They were filled with grief and fury, because Shechem had done a disgraceful thing in Israel by lying with Jacob's daughter--a thing that should not be done.
- 8 Hamor spoke with Jacob and his sons, "My son Shechem is head over heels in love with your daughter--give her to him as his wife.
- 8 But Hamor said to them, "My son Shechem has his heart set on your daughter. Please give her to him as his wife.
- 9 Intermarry with us. Give your daughters to us and we'll give our daughters to you.
- 9 Intermarry with us; give us your daughters and take our daughters for yourselves.
- 10 Live together with us as one family. Settle down among us and make yourselves at home. Prosper among us."
- 10 You can settle among us; the land is open to you. Live in it, trade in it, and acquire property in it."

- 11 Shechem then spoke for himself, addressing Dinah's father and brothers:
"Please, say yes. I'll pay anything.
- 11 Then Shechem said to Dinah's father and brothers, "Let me find favor in your eyes, and I will give you whatever you ask.
- 12 Set the bridal price as high as you will--the sky's the limit! Only give me this girl for my wife."
- 12 Make the price for the bride and the gift I am to bring as great as you like, and I'll pay whatever you ask me. Only give me the girl as my wife."
- 13 Jacob's sons answered Shechem and his father with cunning. Their sister, after all, had been raped.
- 13 Because their sister Dinah had been defiled, Jacob's sons replied deceitfully as they spoke to Shechem and his father Hamor.
- 14 They said, "This is impossible. We could never give our sister to a man who was uncircumcised. Why, we'd be disgraced.
- 14 They said to them, "We can't do such a thing; we can't give our sister to a man who is not circumcised. That would be a disgrace to us.
- 15 The only condition on which we can talk business is if all your men become circumcised like us.
- 15 We will give our consent to you on one condition only: that you become like us by circumcising all your males.
- 16 Then we will freely exchange daughters in marriage and make ourselves at home among you and become one big, happy family.
- 16 Then we will give you our daughters and take your daughters for ourselves. We'll settle among you and become one people with you.
- 17 But if this is not an acceptable condition, we will take our sister and leave."
- 17 But if you will not agree to be circumcised, we'll take our sister and go."
- 18 That seemed fair enough to Hamor and his son Shechem.
- 18 Their proposal seemed good to Hamor and his son Shechem.
- 19 The young man was so smitten with Jacob's daughter that he proceeded to do what had been asked. He was also the most admired son in his father's family.
- 19 The young man, who was the most honored of all his father's household, lost no time in doing what they said, because he was delighted with Jacob's daughter.

- 20 So Hamor and his son Shechem went to the public square and spoke to the town council:
- 20 So Hamor and his son Shechem went to the gate of their city to speak to their fellow townsmen.
- 21 "These men like us; they are our friends. Let them settle down here and make themselves at home; there's plenty of room in the country for them. And, just think, we can even exchange our daughters in marriage.
- 21 These men are friendly toward us, they said. "Let them live in our land and trade in it; the land has plenty of room for them. We can marry their daughters and they can marry ours.
- 22 But these men will only accept our invitation to live with us and become one big family on one condition, that all our males become circumcised just as they themselves are.
- 22 But the men will consent to live with us as one people only on the condition that our males be circumcised, as they themselves are.
- 23 This is a very good deal for us--these people are very wealthy with great herds of livestock and we're going to get our hands on it. So let's do what they ask and have them settle down with us."
- 23 Won't their livestock, their property and all their other animals become ours? So let us give our consent to them, and they will settle among us."
- 24 Everyone who was anyone in the city agreed with Hamor and his son, Shechem; every male was circumcised.
- 24 All the men who went out of the city gate agreed with Hamor and his son Shechem, and every male in the city was circumcised.
- 25 Three days after the circumcision, while all the men were still very sore, two of Jacob's sons, Simeon and Levi, Dinah's brothers, each with his sword in hand, walked into the city as if they owned the place and murdered every man there.
- 25 Three days later, while all of them were still in pain, two of Jacob's sons, Simeon and Levi, Dinah's brothers, took their swords and attacked the unsuspecting city, killing every male.
- 26 They also killed Hamor and his son Shechem, rescued Dinah from Shechem's house, and left.
- 26 They put Hamor and his son Shechem to the sword and took Dinah from Shechem's house and left.

- 27 When the rest of Jacob's sons came on the scene of slaughter, they looted the entire city in retaliation for Dinah's rape.
- 27 The sons of Jacob came upon the dead bodies and looted the city where their sister had been defiled.
- 28 Flocks, herds, donkeys, belongings--everything, whether in the city or the fields--they took.
- 28 They seized their flocks and herds and donkeys and everything else of theirs in the city and out in the fields.
- 29 And then they took all the wives and children captive and ransacked their homes for anything valuable.
- 29 They carried off all their wealth and all their women and children, taking as plunder everything in the houses.
- 30 Jacob said to Simeon and Levi, "You've made my name stink to high heaven among the people here, these Canaanites and Perizzites. If they decided to gang up on us and attack, as few as we are we wouldn't stand a chance; they'd wipe me and my people right off the map."
- 30 Then Jacob said to Simeon and Levi, "You have brought trouble on me by making me a stench to the Canaanites and Perizzites, the people living in this land. We are few in number, and if they join forces against me and attack me, I and my household will be destroyed."
- 31 They said, "Nobody is going to treat our sister like a whore and get by with it."
- 31 But they replied, "Should he have treated our sister like a prostitute?"

Genesis 35

MSG

NIV

- 1 God spoke to Jacob: "Go back to Bethel. Stay there and build an altar to the God who revealed himself to you when you were running for your life from your brother Esau."
- 1 Then God said to Jacob, "Go up to Bethel and settle there, and build an altar there to God, who appeared to you when you were fleeing from your brother Esau."
- 2 Jacob told his family and all those who lived with him, "Throw out all the alien gods which you have, take a good bath and put on clean

clothes,

- 2 So Jacob said to his household and to all who were with him, "Get rid of the foreign gods you have with you, and purify yourselves and change your clothes.
- 3 we're going to Bethel. I'm going to build an altar there to the God who answered me when I was in trouble and has stuck with me everywhere I've gone since."
- 3 Then come, let us go up to Bethel, where I will build an altar to God, who answered me in the day of my distress and who has been with me wherever I have gone."
- 4 They turned over to Jacob all the alien gods they'd been holding on to, along with their lucky-charm earrings. Jacob buried them under the oak tree in Shechem.
- 4 So they gave Jacob all the foreign gods they had and the rings in their ears, and Jacob buried them under the oak at Shechem.
- 5 Then they set out. A paralyzing fear descended on all the surrounding villages so that they were unable to pursue the sons of Jacob.
- 5 Then they set out, and the terror of God fell upon the towns all around them so that no one pursued them.
- 6 Jacob and his company arrived at Luz, that is, Bethel, in the land of Canaan.
- 6 Jacob and all the people with him came to Luz (that is, Bethel) in the land of Canaan.
- 7 He built an altar there and named it El-Bethel (God-of-Bethel) because that's where God revealed himself to him when he was running from his brother.
- 7 There he built an altar, and he called the place El Bethel, because it was there that God revealed himself to him when he was fleeing from his brother.
- 8 And that's when Rebekah's nurse, Deborah, died. She was buried just below Bethel under the oak tree. It was named Allon-Bacuth (Weeping-Oak).
- 8 Now Deborah, Rebekah's nurse, died and was buried under the oak below Bethel. So it was named Allon Bacuth.
- 9 God revealed himself once again to Jacob, after he had come back from Paddan Aram and blessed him:

- 9 After Jacob returned from Paddan Aram, God appeared to him again and blessed him.
- 10 "Your name is Jacob (Heel); but that's your name no longer. From now on your name is Israel (God-Wrestler)."
- 10 God said to him, "Your name is Jacob, but you will no longer be called Jacob; your name will be Israel. " So he named him Israel.
- 11 God continued, I am The Strong God. Have children! Flourish! A nation--a whole company of nations!-- will come from you. Kings will come from your loins;
- 11 And God said to him, "I am God Almighty; be fruitful and increase in number. A nation and a community of nations will come from you, and kings will come from your body.
- 12 the land I gave Abraham and Isaac I now give to you, and pass it on to your descendants.
- 12 The land I gave to Abraham and Isaac I also give to you, and I will give this land to your descendants after you."
- 13 And then God was gone, ascended from the place where he had spoken with him.
- 13 Then God went up from him at the place where he had talked with him.
- 14 Jacob set up a stone pillar on the spot where God had spoken with him. He poured a drink offering on it and anointed it with oil.
- 14 Jacob set up a stone pillar at the place where God had talked with him, and he poured out a drink offering on it; he also poured oil on it.
- 15 Jacob dedicated the place where God had spoken with him, Bethel (God's-House).
- 15 Jacob called the place where God had talked with him Bethel.
- 16 They left Bethel. They were still quite a ways from Ephrath when Rachel went into labor--hard, hard labor.
- 16 Then they moved on from Bethel. While they were still some distance from Ephrath, Rachel began to give birth and had great difficulty.
- 17 When her labor pains were at their worst, the midwife said to her, "Don't be afraid--you have another boy."
- 17 And as she was having great difficulty in childbirth, the midwife said to her, "Don't be afraid, for you have another son."
- 18 With her last breath, for she was now dying, she named him Ben-oni (Son-of-My-Pain), but his father named him Ben-jamin (Son-of-Good-

Fortune).

18 As she breathed her last--for she was dying--she named her son Ben-Oni. But his father named him Benjamin.

19 Rachel died and was buried on the road to Ephrath, that is, Bethlehem.

19 So Rachel died and was buried on the way to Ephrath (that is, Bethlehem).

20 Jacob set up a pillar to mark her grave. It is still there today, "Rachel's Grave Stone."

20 Over her tomb Jacob set up a pillar, and to this day that pillar marks Rachel's tomb.

21 Israel kept on his way and set up camp at Migdal Eder.

21 Israel moved on again and pitched his tent beyond Migdal Eder.

22 While Israel was living in that region, Reuben went and slept with his father's concubine, Bilhah. And Israel heard of what he did. There were twelve sons of Jacob.

22 While Israel was living in that region, Reuben went in and slept with his father's concubine Bilhah, and Israel heard of it. Jacob had twelve sons:

23 The sons by Leah: Reuben, Jacob's firstborn, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zebulun.

23 The sons of Leah: Reuben the firstborn of Jacob, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar and Zebulun.

24 The sons by Rachel: Joseph, Benjamin.

24 The sons of Rachel: Joseph and Benjamin.

25 The sons by Bilhah, Rachel's maid: Dan, Naphtali.

25 The sons of Rachel's maidservant Bilhah: Dan and Naphtali.

26 The sons by Zilpah, Leah's maid: Gad, Asher. These were Jacob's sons, born to him in Paddan Aram.

26 The sons of Leah's maidservant Zilpah: Gad and Asher. These were the sons of Jacob, who were born to him in Paddan Aram.

27 Finally, Jacob made it back home to his father Isaac at Mamre in Kiriath Arba, present-day Hebron, where Abraham and Isaac had lived.

27 Jacob came home to his father Isaac in Mamre, near Kiriath Arba (that is, Hebron), where Abraham and Isaac had stayed.

28 Isaac was now 180 years old.

28 Isaac lived a hundred and eighty years.

29 Isaac breathed his last and died--an old man full of years. He was buried with his family by his sons Esau and Jacob.

29 Then he breathed his last and died and was gathered to his people, old and full of years. And his sons Esau and Jacob buried him.

Genesis 36

MSG

NIV

1 This is the family tree of Esau, who is also called Edom.

1 This is the account of Esau (that is, Edom).

2 Esau married women of Canaan: Adah, daughter of Elon the Hittite; Oholibamah, daughter of Anah and the granddaughter of Zibeon the Hivite;

2 Esau took his wives from the women of Canaan: Adah daughter of Elon the Hittite, and Oholibamah daughter of Anah and granddaughter of Zibeon the Hivite--

3 and Basemath, daughter of Ishmael and sister of Nebaioth.

3 also Basemath daughter of Ishmael and sister of Nebaioth.

4 Adah gave Esau Eliphaz; Basemath had Reuel;

4 Adah bore Eliphaz to Esau, Basemath bore Reuel,

5 Oholibamah had Jeush, Jalam, and Korah. These are the sons of Esau who were born to him in the land of Canaan.

5 and Oholibamah bore Jeush, Jalam and Korah. These were the sons of Esau, who were born to him in Canaan.

6 Esau gathered up his wives, sons and daughters, and everybody in his household, along with all his livestock--all the animals and possessions he had gotten in Canaan--and moved a considerable distance away from his brother Jacob.

6 Esau took his wives and sons and daughters and all the members of his household, as well as his livestock and all his other animals and all the goods he had acquired in Canaan, and moved to a land some distance from his brother Jacob.

7 The brothers had too many possessions to live together in the same place; the land couldn't support their combined herds of livestock.

- 7 Their possessions were too great for them to remain together; the land where they were staying could not support them both because of their livestock.
- 8 So Esau ended up settling in the hill country of Seir (Esau and Edom are the same).
- 8 So Esau (that is, Edom) settled in the hill country of Seir.
- 9 So this is the family tree of Esau, ancestor of the people of Edom, in the hill country of Seir.
- 9 This is the account of Esau the father of the Edomites in the hill country of Seir.
- 10 The names of Esau's sons: Eliphaz, son of Esau's wife Adah; Reuel, son of Esau's wife Basemath.
- 10 These are the names of Esau's sons: Eliphaz, the son of Esau's wife Adah, and Reuel, the son of Esau's wife Basemath.
- 11 The sons of Eliphaz: Teman, Omar, Zepho, Gatam, and Kenaz.
- 11 The sons of Eliphaz: Teman, Omar, Zepho, Gatam and Kenaz.
- 12 (Eliphaz also had a concubine Timna, who had Amalek.) These are the grandsons of Esau's wife Adah.
- 12 Esau's son Eliphaz also had a concubine named Timna, who bore him Amalek. These were grandsons of Esau's wife Adah.
- 13 And these are the sons of Reuel: Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah--grandsons of Esau's wife Basemath.
- 13 The sons of Reuel: Nahath, Zerah, Shammah and Mizzah. These were grandsons of Esau's wife Basemath.
- 14 These are the sons of Esau's wife Oholibamah, daughter of Anah the son of Zibeon. She gave Esau his sons Jeush, Jalam, and Korah.
- 14 The sons of Esau's wife Oholibamah daughter of Anah and granddaughter of Zibeon, whom she bore to Esau: Jeush, Jalam and Korah.
- 15 These are the chieftains in Esau's family tree. From the sons of Eliphaz, Esau's firstborn, came the chieftains Teman, Omar, Zepho, Kenaz,
- 15 These were the chiefs among Esau's descendants: The sons of Eliphaz the firstborn of Esau: Chiefs Teman, Omar, Zepho, Kenaz,
- 16 Korah, Gatam, and Amalek--the chieftains of Eliphaz in the land of Edom; all of them sons of Adah.

- 16 Korah, Gatam and Amalek. These were the chiefs descended from Eliphaz in Edom; they were grandsons of Adah.
- 17 From the sons of Esau's son Reuel, came the chieftains Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah. These are the chieftains of Reuel in the land of Edom; all these were sons of Esau's wife Basemath.
- 17 The sons of Esau's son Reuel: Chiefs Nahath, Zerah, Shammah and Mizzah. These were the chiefs descended from Reuel in Edom; they were grandsons of Esau's wife Basemath.
- 18 These are the sons of Esau's wife Oholibamah: the chieftains Jeush, Jalam, and Korah--chieftains born of Esau's wife Oholibamah, daughter of Anah.
- 18 The sons of Esau's wife Oholibamah: Chiefs Jeush, Jalam and Korah. These were the chiefs descended from Esau's wife Oholibamah daughter of Anah.
- 19 These are the sons of Esau, that is, Edom, and these are their chieftains.
- 19 These were the sons of Esau (that is, Edom), and these were their chiefs.
- 20 This is the family tree of Seir the Horite, who were native to that land: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah,
- 20 These were the sons of Seir the Horite, who were living in the region: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah,
- 21 Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan. These are the chieftains of the Horites, the sons of Seir in the land of Edom.
- 21 Dishon, Ezer and Dishan. These sons of Seir in Edom were Horite chiefs.
- 22 The sons of Lotan were Hori and Homam; Lotan's sister was Timna.
- 22 The sons of Lotan: Hori and Homam. Timna was Lotan's sister.
- 23 The sons of Shobal were Alvan, Manahath, Ebal, Shepho, and Onam.
- 23 The sons of Shobal: Alvan, Manahath, Ebal, Shepho and Onam.
- 24 The sons of Zibeon were Aiah and Anah--this is the same Anah who found the hot springs in the wilderness while herding his father Zibeon's donkeys.
- 24 The sons of Zibeon: Aiah and Anah. This is the Anah who discovered the hot springs in the desert while he was grazing the donkeys of his father Zibeon.
- 25 The children of Anah were Dishon and his daughter Oholibamah.
- 25 The children of Anah: Dishon and Oholibamah daughter of Anah.

26 The sons of Dishon were Hemdan, Eshban, Ithran, and Keran.
26 The sons of Dishon: Hemdan, Eshban, Ithran and Keran.
27 The sons of Ezer: Bilhan, Zaavan, and Akan.
27 The sons of Ezer: Bilhan, Zaavan and Akan.
28 The sons of Dishan: Uz and Aran.
28 The sons of Dishan: Uz and Aran.
29 And these were the Horite chieftains: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah,
29 These were the Horite chiefs: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah,
30 Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan--the Horite chieftains clan by clan in the land of Seir.
30 Dishon, Ezer and Dishan. These were the Horite chiefs, according to their divisions, in the land of Seir.
31 And these are the kings who ruled in Edom before there was a king in Israel:
31 These were the kings who reigned in Edom before any Israelite king reigned:
32 Bela son of Beor was the king of Edom; the name of his city was Dinhabah.
32 Bela son of Beor became king of Edom. His city was named Dinhabah.
33 When Bela died, Jobab son of Zerah from Bozrah became the next king.
33 When Bela died, Jobab son of Zerah from Bozrah succeeded him as king.
34 When Jobab died, he was followed by Hushan from the land of the Temanites.
34 When Jobab died, Husham from the land of the Temanites succeeded him as king.
35 When Hushan died, he was followed by Hadad son of Bedad; he was the king who defeated the Midianites in Moab; the name of his city was Avith.
35 When Husham died, Hadad son of Bedad, who defeated Midian in the country of Moab, succeeded him as king. His city was named Avith.
36 When Hadad died, Samlah of Masrekah became the next king.
36 When Hadad died, Samlah from Masrekah succeeded him as king.
37 When Samlah died, Shaul from Rehoboth-on-the-River became king.
37 When Samlah died, Shaul from Rehoboth on the river succeeded him as king.

- 38 When Shaul died, he was followed by Baal-Hanan son of Acbor.
- 38 When Shaul died, Baal-Hanan son of Acbor succeeded him as king.
- 39 When Baal-Hanan son of Acbor died, Hadad became king; the name of his city was Pau; his wife's name was Mehetabel daughter of Matred, daughter of Me-Zahab.
- 39 When Baal-Hanan son of Acbor died, Hadad succeeded him as king. His city was named Pau, and his wife's name was Mehetabel daughter of Matred, the daughter of Me-Zahab.
- 40 And these are the chieftains from the line of Esau, clan by clan, region by region: Timna, Alvah, Jetheth,
- 40 These were the chiefs descended from Esau, by name, according to their clans and regions: Timna, Alvah, Jetheth,
- 41 Oholibamah, Elah, Pinon,
- 41 Oholibamah, Elah, Pinon,
- 42 Kenaz, Teman, Mibzar,
- 42 Kenaz, Teman, Mibzar,
- 43 Magdiel, and Iram--the chieftains of Edom as they occupied their various regions. This accounts for the family tree of Esau, ancestor of all Edomites.
- 43 Magdiel and Iram. These were the chiefs of Edom, according to their settlements in the land they occupied. This was Esau the father of the Edomites.

Genesis 37

MSG

NIV

- 1 Meanwhile Jacob had settled down where his father had lived, the land of Canaan.
- 1 Jacob lived in the land where his father had stayed, the land of Canaan.
- 2 This is the story of Jacob. The story continues with Joseph, seventeen years old at the time, helping out his brothers in herding the flocks. These were his half brothers actually, the sons of his father's wives Bilhah and Zilpah. And Joseph brought his father bad reports on them.
- 2 This is the account of Jacob. Joseph, a young man of seventeen, was tending the flocks with his brothers, the sons of Bilhah and the sons of

- Zilpah, his father's wives, and he brought their father a bad report about them.
- 3 Israel loved Joseph more than any of his other sons because he was the child of his old age. And he made him an elaborately embroidered coat.
- 3 Now Israel loved Joseph more than any of his other sons, because he had been born to him in his old age; and he made a richly ornamented robe for him.
- 4 When his brothers realized that their father loved him more than them, they grew to hate him--they wouldn't even speak to him.
- 4 When his brothers saw that their father loved him more than any of them, they hated him and could not speak a kind word to him.
- 5 Joseph had a dream. When he told it to his brothers, they hated him even more.
- 5 Joseph had a dream, and when he told it to his brothers, they hated him all the more.
- 6 He said, "Listen to this dream I had.
- 6 He said to them, "Listen to this dream I had:
- 7 We were all out in the field gathering bundles of wheat. All of a sudden my bundle stood straight up and your bundles circled around it and bowed down to mine."
- 7 We were binding sheaves of grain out in the field when suddenly my sheaf rose and stood upright, while your sheaves gathered around mine and bowed down to it."
- 8 His brothers said, "So! You're going to rule us? You're going to boss us around?" And they hated him more than ever because of his dreams and the way he talked.
- 8 His brothers said to him, "Do you intend to reign over us? Will you actually rule us?" And they hated him all the more because of his dream and what he had said.
- 9 He had another dream and told this one also to his brothers: "I dreamed another dream--the sun and moon and eleven stars bowed down to me!"
- 9 Then he had another dream, and he told it to his brothers. "Listen," he said, "I had another dream, and this time the sun and moon and eleven stars were bowing down to me."
- 10 When he told it to his father and brothers, his father reprimanded him: "What's with all this dreaming? Am I and your mother and your brothers

- all supposed to bow down to you?"
- 10 When he told his father as well as his brothers, his father rebuked him and said, "What is this dream you had? Will your mother and I and your brothers actually come and bow down to the ground before you?"
- 11 Now his brothers were really jealous; but his father brooded over the whole business.
- 11 His brothers were jealous of him, but his father kept the matter in mind.
- 12 His brothers had gone off to Shechem where they were pasturing their father's flocks.
- 12 Now his brothers had gone to graze their father's flocks near Shechem,
- 13 Israel said to Joseph, "Your brothers are with flocks in Shechem. Come, I want to send you to them." Joseph said, "I'm ready."
- 13 and Israel said to Joseph, "As you know, your brothers are grazing the flocks near Shechem. Come, I am going to send you to them." "Very well," he replied.
- 14 He said, "Go and see how your brothers and the flocks are doing and bring me back a report." He sent him off from the valley of Hebron to Shechem.
- 14 So he said to him, "Go and see if all is well with your brothers and with the flocks, and bring word back to me." Then he sent him off from the Valley of Hebron. When Joseph arrived at Shechem,
- 15 A man met him as he was wandering through the fields and asked him, "What are you looking for?"
- 15 a man found him wandering around in the fields and asked him, "What are you looking for?"
- 16 "I'm trying to find my brothers. Do you have any idea where they are grazing their flocks?"
- 16 He replied, "I'm looking for my brothers. Can you tell me where they are grazing their flocks?"
- 17 The man said, "They've left here, but I overheard them say, 'Let's go to Dothan.'" So Joseph took off, tracked his brothers down, and found them in Dothan.
- 17 They have moved on from here, the man answered. "I heard them say, 'Let's go to Dothan.'" So Joseph went after his brothers and found them near Dothan.

- 18 They spotted him off in the distance. By the time he got to them they had cooked up a plot to kill him.
- 18 But they saw him in the distance, and before he reached them, they plotted to kill him.
- 19 The brothers were saying, "Here comes that dreamer.
- 19 Here comes that dreamer! they said to each other.
- 20 Let's kill him and throw him into one of these old cisterns; we can say that a vicious animal ate him up. We'll see what his dreams amount to."
- 20 Come now, let's kill him and throw him into one of these cisterns and say that a ferocious animal devoured him. Then we'll see what comes of his dreams.
- 21 Reuben heard the brothers talking and intervened to save him, "We're not going to kill him.
- 21 When Reuben heard this, he tried to rescue him from their hands. "Let's not take his life," he said.
- 22 No murder. Go ahead and throw him in this cistern out here in the wild, but don't hurt him." Reuben planned to go back later and get him out and take him back to his father.
- 22 Don't shed any blood. Throw him into this cistern here in the desert, but don't lay a hand on him. Reuben said this to rescue him from them and take him back to his father.
- 23 When Joseph reached his brothers, they ripped off the fancy coat he was wearing,
- 23 So when Joseph came to his brothers, they stripped him of his robe--the richly ornamented robe he was wearing--
- 24 grabbed him, and threw him into a cistern. The cistern was dry; there wasn't any water in it.
- 24 and they took him and threw him into the cistern. Now the cistern was empty; there was no water in it.
- 25 Then they sat down to eat their supper. Looking up, they saw a caravan of Ishmaelites on their way from Gilead, their camels loaded with spices, ointments, and perfumes to sell in Egypt.
- 25 As they sat down to eat their meal, they looked up and saw a caravan of Ishmaelites coming from Gilead. Their camels were loaded with spices, balm and myrrh, and they were on their way to take them down to Egypt.

- 26 Judah said, "Brothers, what are we going to get out of killing our brother and concealing the evidence?"
- 26 Judah said to his brothers, "What will we gain if we kill our brother and cover up his blood?"
- 27 Let's sell him to the Ishmaelites, but let's not kill him--he is, after all, our brother, our own flesh and blood." His brothers agreed.
- 27 Come, let's sell him to the Ishmaelites and not lay our hands on him; after all, he is our brother, our own flesh and blood." His brothers agreed.
- 28 By that time the Midianite traders were passing by. His brothers pulled Joseph out of the cistern and sold him for twenty pieces of silver to the Ishmaelites who took Joseph with them down to Egypt.
- 28 So when the Midianite merchants came by, his brothers pulled Joseph up out of the cistern and sold him for twenty shekels of silver to the Ishmaelites, who took him to Egypt.
- 29 Later Reuben came back and went to the cistern--no Joseph! He ripped his clothes in despair.
- 29 When Reuben returned to the cistern and saw that Joseph was not there, he tore his clothes.
- 30 Beside himself, he went to his brothers. "The boy's gone! What am I going to do!"
- 30 He went back to his brothers and said, "The boy isn't there! Where can I turn now?"
- 31 They took Joseph's coat, butchered a goat, and dipped the coat in the blood.
- 31 Then they got Joseph's robe, slaughtered a goat and dipped the robe in the blood.
- 32 They took the fancy coat back to their father and said, "We found this. Look it over--do you think this is your son's coat?"
- 32 They took the ornamented robe back to their father and said, "We found this. Examine it to see whether it is your son's robe."
- 33 He recognized it at once. "My son's coat--a wild animal has eaten him. Joseph torn limb from limb!"
- 33 He recognized it and said, "It is my son's robe! Some ferocious animal has devoured him. Joseph has surely been torn to pieces."
- 34 Jacob tore his clothes in grief, dressed in rough burlap, and mourned his son a long, long time.

- 34 Then Jacob tore his clothes, put on sackcloth and mourned for his son many days.
- 35 His sons and daughters tried to comfort him but he refused their comfort. "I'll go to the grave mourning my son." Oh, how his father wept for him.
- 35 All his sons and daughters came to comfort him, but he refused to be comforted. "No," he said, "in mourning will I go down to the grave to my son." So his father wept for him.
- 36 In Egypt the Midianites sold Joseph to Potiphar, one of Pharaoh's officials, manager of his household affairs.
- 36 Meanwhile, the Midianites sold Joseph in Egypt to Potiphar, one of Pharaoh's officials, the captain of the guard.

Genesis 38

MSG

NIV

- 1 About that time, Judah separated from his brothers and hooked up with a man in Adullam named Hirah.
- 1 At that time, Judah left his brothers and went down to stay with a man of Adullam named Hirah.
- 2 While there, Judah met the daughter of a Canaanite named Shua. He married her, they went to bed,
- 2 There Judah met the daughter of a Canaanite man named Shua. He married her and lay with her;
- 3 she became pregnant and had a son named Er.
- 3 she became pregnant and gave birth to a son, who was named Er.
- 4 She got pregnant again and had a son named Onan.
- 4 She conceived again and gave birth to a son and named him Onan.
- 5 She had still another son; she named this one Shelah. They were living at Kezib when she had him.
- 5 She gave birth to still another son and named him Shelah. It was at Kezib that she gave birth to him.
- 6 Judah got a wife for Er, his firstborn. Her name was Tamar.
- 6 Judah got a wife for Er, his firstborn, and her name was Tamar.

- 7 But Judah's firstborn, Er, grievously offended GOD and GOD took his life.
- 7 But Er, Judah's firstborn, was wicked in the LORD's sight; so the LORD put him to death.
- 8 So Judah told Onan, "Go and sleep with your brother's widow; it's the duty of a brother-in-law to keep your brother's line alive."
- 8 Then Judah said to Onan, "Lie with your brother's wife and fulfill your duty to her as a brother-in-law to produce offspring for your brother."
- 9 But Onan knew that the child wouldn't be his, so whenever he slept with his brother's widow he spilled his semen on the ground so he wouldn't produce a child for his brother.
- 9 But Onan knew that the offspring would not be his; so whenever he lay with his brother's wife, he spilled his semen on the ground to keep from producing offspring for his brother.
- 10 GOD was much offended by what he did and also took his life.
- 10 What he did was wicked in the LORD's sight; so he put him to death also.
- 11 So Judah stepped in and told his daughter-in-law Tamar, "Live as a widow at home with your father until my son Shelah grows up." He was worried that Shelah would also end up dead, just like his brothers. So Tamar went to live with her father.
- 11 Judah then said to his daughter-in-law Tamar, "Live as a widow in your father's house until my son Shelah grows up." For he thought, "He may die too, just like his brothers." So Tamar went to live in her father's house.
- 12 Time passed. Judah's wife, Shua's daughter, died. When the time of mourning was over, Judah with his friend Hirah of Adullam went to Timnah for the sheep shearing.
- 12 After a long time Judah's wife, the daughter of Shua, died. When Judah had recovered from his grief, he went up to Timnah, to the men who were shearing his sheep, and his friend Hirah the Adullamite went with him.
- 13 Tamar was told, "Your father-in-law has gone to Timnah to shear his sheep."
- 13 When Tamar was told, "Your father-in-law is on his way to Timnah to shear his sheep,"

- 14 She took off her widow's clothes, put on a veil to disguise herself, and sat at the entrance to Enaim which is on the road to Timnah. She realized by now that even though Shelah was grown up, she wasn't going to be married to him.
- 14 she took off her widow's clothes, covered herself with a veil to disguise herself, and then sat down at the entrance to Enaim, which is on the road to Timnah. For she saw that, though Shelah had now grown up, she had not been given to him as his wife.
- 15 Judah saw her and assumed she was a prostitute since she had veiled her face.
- 15 When Judah saw her, he thought she was a prostitute, for she had covered her face.
- 16 He left the road and went over to her. He said, "Let me sleep with you." He had no idea that she was his daughter-in-law. She said, "What will you pay me?"
- 16 Not realizing that she was his daughter- in-law, he went over to her by the roadside and said, "Come now, let me sleep with you." "And what will you give me to sleep with you?" she asked.
- 17 "I'll send you," he said, "a kid goat from the flock." She said, "Not unless you give me a pledge until you send it."
- 17 I'll send you a young goat from my flock, he said. "Will you give me something as a pledge until you send it?" she asked.
- 18 "So what would you want in the way of a pledge?" She said, "Your personal seal-and-cord and the staff you carry." He handed them over to her and slept with her. And she got pregnant.
- 18 He said, "What pledge should I give you?" "Your seal and its cord, and the staff in your hand," she answered. So he gave them to her and slept with her, and she became pregnant by him.
- 19 She then left and went home. She removed her veil and put her widow's clothes back on.
- 19 After she left, she took off her veil and put on her widow's clothes again.
- 20 Judah sent the kid goat by his friend from Adullam to recover the pledge from the woman. But he couldn't find her.

- 20 Meanwhile Judah sent the young goat by his friend the Adullamite in order to get his pledge back from the woman, but he did not find her.
- 21 He asked the men of that place, "Where's the prostitute that used to sit by the road here near Enaim?" They said, "There's never been a prostitute here."
- 21 He asked the men who lived there, "Where is the shrine prostitute who was beside the road at Enaim?" "There hasn't been any shrine prostitute here," they said.
- 22 He went back to Judah and said, "I couldn't find her. The men there said there never has been a prostitute there."
- 22 So he went back to Judah and said, "I didn't find her. Besides, the men who lived there said, 'There hasn't been any shrine prostitute here.' "
- 23 Judah said, "Let her have it then. If we keep looking, everyone will be poking fun at us. I kept my part of the bargain--I sent the kid goat but you couldn't find her."
- 23 Then Judah said, "Let her keep what she has, or we will become a laughingstock. After all, I did send her this young goat, but you didn't find her."
- 24 Three months or so later, Judah was told, "Your daughter-in-law has been playing the whore--and now she's a pregnant whore." Judah yelled, "Get her out here. Burn her up!"
- 24 About three months later Judah was told, "Your daughter- in-law Tamar is guilty of prostitution, and as a result she is now pregnant." Judah said, "Bring her out and have her burned to death!"
- 25 As they brought her out, she sent a message to her father-in-law, "I'm pregnant by the man who owns these things. Identify them, please. Who's the owner of the seal-and-cord and the staff?"
- 25 As she was being brought out, she sent a message to her father-in-law. "I am pregnant by the man who owns these," she said. And she added, "See if you recognize whose seal and cord and staff these are."
- 26 Judah saw they were his. He said, "She's in the right; I'm in the wrong--I wouldn't let her marry my son Shelah." He never slept with her again.
- 26 Judah recognized them and said, "She is more righteous than I, since I wouldn't give her to my son Shelah." And he did not sleep with her again.

- 27 When her time came to give birth, it turned out that there were twins in her womb.
- 27 When the time came for her to give birth, there were twin boys in her womb.
- 28 As she was giving birth, one put his hand out; the midwife tied a red thread on his hand, saying, "This one came first."
- 28 As she was giving birth, one of them put out his hand; so the midwife took a scarlet thread and tied it on his wrist and said, "This one came out first."
- 29 But then he pulled it back and his brother came out. She said, "Oh! A breakout!" So she named him Perez (Breakout).
- 29 But when he drew back his hand, his brother came out, and she said, "So this is how you have broken out!" And he was named Perez.
- 30 Then his brother came out with the red thread on his hand. They named him Zerah (Bright).
- 30 Then his brother, who had the scarlet thread on his wrist, came out and he was given the name Zerah.

Genesis 39

MSG

NIV

- 1 After Joseph had been taken to Egypt by the Ishmaelites, Potiphar an Egyptian, one of Pharaoh's officials and the manager of his household, bought him from them.
- 1 Now Joseph had been taken down to Egypt. Potiphar, an Egyptian who was one of Pharaoh's officials, the captain of the guard, bought him from the Ishmaelites who had taken him there.
- 2 As it turned out, GOD was with Joseph and things went very well with him. He ended up living in the home of his Egyptian master.
- 2 The LORD was with Joseph and he prospered, and he lived in the house of his Egyptian master.
- 3 His master recognized that GOD was with him, saw that GOD was working for good in everything he did.
- 3 When his master saw that the LORD was with him and that the LORD gave him success in everything he did,

- 4 He became very fond of Joseph and made him his personal aide. He put him in charge of all his personal affairs, turning everything over to him.
- 4 Joseph found favor in his eyes and became his attendant. Potiphar put him in charge of his household, and he entrusted to his care everything he owned.
- 5 From that moment on, GOD blessed the home of the Egyptian--all because of Joseph. The blessing of GOD spread over everything he owned, at home and in the fields,
- 5 From the time he put him in charge of his household and of all that he owned, the LORD blessed the household of the Egyptian because of Joseph. The blessing of the LORD was on everything Potiphar had, both in the house and in the field.
- 6 and all Potiphar had to concern himself with was eating three meals a day. Joseph was a strikingly handsome man.
- 6 So he left in Joseph's care everything he had; with Joseph in charge, he did not concern himself with anything except the food he ate. Now Joseph was well-built and handsome,
- 7 As time went on, his master's wife became infatuated with Joseph and one day said, "Sleep with me."
- 7 and after a while his master's wife took notice of Joseph and said, "Come to bed with me!"
- 8 He wouldn't do it. He said to his master's wife, "Look, with me here, my master doesn't give a second thought to anything that goes on here--he's put me in charge of everything he owns.
- 8 But he refused. "With me in charge," he told her, "my master does not concern himself with anything in the house; everything he owns he has entrusted to my care.
- 9 He treats me as an equal. The only thing he hasn't turned over to me is you. You're his wife, after all! How could I violate his trust and sin against God?"
- 9 No one is greater in this house than I am. My master has withheld nothing from me except you, because you are his wife. How then could I do such a wicked thing and sin against God?"
- 10 She pestered him day after day after day, but he stood his ground. He refused to go to bed with her.

- 10 And though she spoke to Joseph day after day, he refused to go to bed with her or even be with her.
- 11 On one of these days he came to the house to do his work and none of the household servants happened to be there.
- 11 One day he went into the house to attend to his duties, and none of the household servants was inside.
- 12 She grabbed him by his cloak, saying, "Sleep with me!" He left his coat in her hand and ran out of the house.
- 12 She caught him by his cloak and said, "Come to bed with me!" But he left his cloak in her hand and ran out of the house.
- 13 When she realized that he had left his coat in her hand and run outside,
- 13 When she saw that he had left his cloak in her hand and had run out of the house,
- 14 she called to her house servants: "Look--this Hebrew shows up and before you know it he's trying to seduce us. He tried to make love to me but I yelled as loud as I could.
- 14 she called her household servants. "Look," she said to them, "this Hebrew has been brought to us to make sport of us! He came in here to sleep with me, but I screamed.
- 15 With all my yelling and screaming, he left his coat beside me here and ran outside."
- 15 When he heard me scream for help, he left his cloak beside me and ran out of the house."
- 16 She kept his coat right there until his master came home.
- 16 She kept his cloak beside her until his master came home.
- 17 She told him the same story. She said, "The Hebrew slave, the one you brought to us, came after me and tried to use me for his plaything.
- 17 Then she told him this story: "That Hebrew slave you brought us came to me to make sport of me.
- 18 When I yelled and screamed, he left his coat with me and ran outside."
- 18 But as soon as I screamed for help, he left his cloak beside me and ran out of the house."
- 19 When his master heard his wife's story, telling him, "These are the things your slave did to me," he was furious.
- 19 When his master heard the story his wife told him, saying, "This is how your slave treated me," he burned with anger.

- 20 Joseph's master took him and threw him into the jail where the king's prisoners were locked up. But there in jail
- 20 Joseph's master took him and put him in prison, the place where the king's prisoners were confined. But while Joseph was there in the prison,
- 21 GOD was still with Joseph: He reached out in kindness to him; he put him on good terms with the head jailer.
- 21 the LORD was with him; he showed him kindness and granted him favor in the eyes of the prison warden.
- 22 The head jailer put Joseph in charge of all the prisoners--he ended up managing the whole operation.
- 22 So the warden put Joseph in charge of all those held in the prison, and he was made responsible for all that was done there.
- 23 The head jailer gave Joseph free rein, never even checked on him, because GOD was with him; whatever he did GOD made sure it worked out for the best.
- 23 The warden paid no attention to anything under Joseph's care, because the LORD was with Joseph and gave him success in whatever he did.

Genesis 40

MSG

NIV

- 1 As time went on, it happened that the cupbearer and the baker of the king of Egypt crossed their master, the king of Egypt.
- 1 Some time later, the cupbearer and the baker of the king of Egypt offended their master, the king of Egypt.
- 2 Pharaoh was furious with his two officials, the head cupbearer and the head baker,
- 2 Pharaoh was angry with his two officials, the chief cupbearer and the chief baker,
- 3 and put them in custody under the captain of the guard; it was the same jail where Joseph was held.
- 3 and put them in custody in the house of the captain of the guard, in the same prison where Joseph was confined.
- 4 The captain of the guard assigned Joseph to see to their needs. After they had been in custody for a while,

4 The captain of the guard assigned them to Joseph, and he attended them.
After they had been in custody for some time,
5 the king's cupbearer and baker, while being held in the jail, both had a
dream on the same night, each dream having its own meaning.
5 each of the two men--the cupbearer and the baker of the king of Egypt,
who were being held in prison--had a dream the same night, and each
dream had a meaning of its own.
6 When Joseph arrived in the morning, he noticed that they were feeling
low.
6 When Joseph came to them the next morning, he saw that they were
dejected.
7 So he asked them, the two officials of Pharaoh who had been thrown into
jail with him, "What's wrong? Why the long faces?"
7 So he asked Pharaoh's officials who were in custody with him in his
master's house, "Why are your faces so sad today?"
8 They said, "We dreamed dreams and there's no one to interpret them."
Joseph said, "Don't interpretations come from God? Tell me the dreams."
8 We both had dreams, they answered, "but there is no one to interpret
them." Then Joseph said to them, "Do not interpretations belong to God?
Tell me your dreams."
9 First the head cupbearer told his dream to Joseph: "In my dream there
was a vine in front of me
9 So the chief cupbearer told Joseph his dream. He said to him, "In my
dream I saw a vine in front of me,
10 with three branches on it: It budded, blossomed, and the clusters ripened
into grapes.
10 and on the vine were three branches. As soon as it budded, it
blossomed, and its clusters ripened into grapes.
11 I was holding Pharaoh's cup; I took the grapes, squeezed them into
Pharaoh's cup, and gave the cup to Pharaoh."
11 Pharaoh's cup was in my hand, and I took the grapes, squeezed them
into Pharaoh's cup and put the cup in his hand."
12 Joseph said, "Here's the meaning. The three branches are three days.
12 This is what it means, Joseph said to him. "The three branches are three
days.

- 13 Within three days, Pharaoh will get you out of here and put you back to your old work--you'll be giving Pharaoh his cup just as you used to do when you were his cupbearer.
- 13 Within three days Pharaoh will lift up your head and restore you to your position, and you will put Pharaoh's cup in his hand, just as you used to do when you were his cupbearer.
- 14 Only remember me when things are going well with you again--tell Pharaoh about me and get me out of this place.
- 14 But when all goes well with you, remember me and show me kindness; mention me to Pharaoh and get me out of this prison.
- 15 I was kidnapped from the land of the Hebrews. And since I've been here, I've done nothing to deserve being put in this hole."
- 15 For I was forcibly carried off from the land of the Hebrews, and even here I have done nothing to deserve being put in a dungeon."
- 16 When the head baker saw how well Joseph's interpretation turned out, he spoke up: "My dream went like this: I saw three wicker baskets on my head;
- 16 When the chief baker saw that Joseph had given a favorable interpretation, he said to Joseph, "I too had a dream: On my head were three baskets of bread.
- 17 the top basket had assorted pastries from the bakery and birds were picking at them from the basket on my head."
- 17 In the top basket were all kinds of baked goods for Pharaoh, but the birds were eating them out of the basket on my head."
- 18 Joseph said, "This is the interpretation: The three baskets are three days;
- 18 This is what it means, Joseph said. "The three baskets are three days.
- 19 within three days Pharaoh will take off your head, impale you on a post, and the birds will pick your bones clean."
- 19 Within three days Pharaoh will lift off your head and hang you on a tree. And the birds will eat away your flesh."
- 20 And sure enough, on the third day it was Pharaoh's birthday and he threw a feast for all his servants. He set the head cupbearer and the head baker in places of honor in the presence of all the guests.
- 20 Now the third day was Pharaoh's birthday, and he gave a feast for all his officials. He lifted up the heads of the chief cupbearer and the chief baker in the presence of his officials:

- 21 Then he restored the head cupbearer to his cupbearing post; he handed Pharaoh his cup just as before.
- 21 He restored the chief cupbearer to his position, so that he once again put the cup into Pharaoh's hand,
- 22 And then he impaled the head baker on a post, following Joseph's interpretations exactly.
- 22 but he hanged the chief baker, just as Joseph had said to them in his interpretation.
- 23 But the head cupbearer never gave Joseph another thought; he forgot all about him.
- 23 The chief cupbearer, however, did not remember Joseph; he forgot him.

Genesis 41

MSG

NIV

- 1 Two years passed and Pharaoh had a dream: He was standing by the Nile River.
- 1 When two full years had passed, Pharaoh had a dream: He was standing by the Nile,
- 2 Seven cows came up out of the Nile, all shimmering with health, and grazed on the marsh grass.
- 2 when out of the river there came up seven cows, sleek and fat, and they grazed among the reeds.
- 3 Then seven other cows, all skin and bones, came up out of the river after them and stood by them on the bank of the Nile.
- 3 After them, seven other cows, ugly and gaunt, came up out of the Nile and stood beside those on the riverbank.
- 4 The skinny cows ate the seven healthy cows. Then Pharaoh woke up.
- 4 And the cows that were ugly and gaunt ate up the seven sleek, fat cows. Then Pharaoh woke up.
- 5 He went back to sleep and dreamed a second time: Seven ears of grain, full-bodied and lush, grew out of a single stalk.
- 5 He fell asleep again and had a second dream: Seven heads of grain, healthy and good, were growing on a single stalk.

- 6 Then seven more ears grew up, but these were thin and dried out by the east wind.
- 6 After them, seven other heads of grain sprouted--thin and scorched by the east wind.
- 7 The thin ears swallowed up the full, healthy ears. Then Pharaoh woke up--another dream.
- 7 The thin heads of grain swallowed up the seven healthy, full heads. Then Pharaoh woke up; it had been a dream.
- 8 When morning came, he was upset. He sent for all the magicians and sages of Egypt. Pharaoh told them his dreams, but they couldn't interpret them to him.
- 8 In the morning his mind was troubled, so he sent for all the magicians and wise men of Egypt. Pharaoh told them his dreams, but no one could interpret them for him.
- 9 The head cupbearer then spoke up and said to Pharaoh, "I just now remembered something--I'm sorry, I should have told you this long ago.
- 9 Then the chief cupbearer said to Pharaoh, "Today I am reminded of my shortcomings.
- 10 Once when Pharaoh got angry with his servants, he locked me and the head baker in the house of the captain of the guard.
- 10 Pharaoh was once angry with his servants, and he imprisoned me and the chief baker in the house of the captain of the guard.
- 11 We both had dreams on the same night, each dream with its own meaning.
- 11 Each of us had a dream the same night, and each dream had a meaning of its own.
- 12 It so happened that there was a young Hebrew slave there with us; he belonged to the captain of the guard. We told him our dreams and he interpreted them for us, each dream separately.
- 12 Now a young Hebrew was there with us, a servant of the captain of the guard. We told him our dreams, and he interpreted them for us, giving each man the interpretation of his dream.
- 13 Things turned out just as he interpreted. I was returned to my position and the head baker was impaled."
- 13 And things turned out exactly as he interpreted them to us: I was restored to my position, and the other man was hanged. "

- 14 Pharaoh at once sent for Joseph. They brought him on the run from the jail cell. He cut his hair, put on clean clothes, and came to Pharaoh.
- 14 So Pharaoh sent for Joseph, and he was quickly brought from the dungeon. When he had shaved and changed his clothes, he came before Pharaoh.
- 15 "I dreamed a dream," Pharaoh told Joseph. "Nobody can interpret it. But I've heard that just by hearing a dream you can interpret it."
- 15 Pharaoh said to Joseph, "I had a dream, and no one can interpret it. But I have heard it said of you that when you hear a dream you can interpret it."
- 16 Joseph answered, "Not I, but God. God will set Pharaoh's mind at ease."
- 16 I cannot do it, Joseph replied to Pharaoh, "but God will give Pharaoh the answer he desires."
- 17 Then Pharaoh said to Joseph, "In my dream I was standing on the bank of the Nile.
- 17 Then Pharaoh said to Joseph, "In my dream I was standing on the bank of the Nile,
- 18 Seven cows, shimmering with health, came up out of the river and grazed on the marsh grass.
- 18 when out of the river there came up seven cows, fat and sleek, and they grazed among the reeds.
- 19 On their heels seven more cows, all skin and bones, came up. I've never seen uglier cows anywhere in Egypt.
- 19 After them, seven other cows came up--scrawny and very ugly and lean. I had never seen such ugly cows in all the land of Egypt.
- 20 Then the seven skinny, ugly cows ate up the first seven healthy cows.
- 20 The lean, ugly cows ate up the seven fat cows that came up first.
- 21 But you couldn't tell by looking--after eating them up they were just as skinny and ugly as before. Then I woke up.
- 21 But even after they ate them, no one could tell that they had done so; they looked just as ugly as before. Then I woke up.
- 22 "In my second dream I saw seven ears of grain, full-bodied and lush, growing out of a single stalk,
- 22 In my dreams I also saw seven heads of grain, full and good, growing on a single stalk.

23 and right behind them, seven other ears, shriveled, thin, and dried out by the east wind.

23 After them, seven other heads sprouted--withered and thin and scorched by the east wind.

24 And the thin ears swallowed up the full ears. I've told all this to the magicians but they can't figure it out."

24 The thin heads of grain swallowed up the seven good heads. I told this to the magicians, but none could explain it to me."

25 Joseph said to Pharaoh, "Pharaoh's two dreams both mean the same thing. God is telling Pharaoh what he is going to do.

25 Then Joseph said to Pharaoh, "The dreams of Pharaoh are one and the same. God has revealed to Pharaoh what he is about to do.

26 The seven healthy cows are seven years and the seven healthy ears of grain are seven years--they're the same dream.

26 The seven good cows are seven years, and the seven good heads of grain are seven years; it is one and the same dream.

27 The seven sick and ugly cows that followed them up are seven years and the seven scrawny ears of grain dried out by the east wind are the same--seven years of famine.

27 The seven lean, ugly cows that came up afterward are seven years, and so are the seven worthless heads of grain scorched by the east wind: They are seven years of famine.

28 "The meaning is what I said earlier: God is letting Pharaoh in on what he is going to do.

28 It is just as I said to Pharaoh: God has shown Pharaoh what he is about to do.

29 Seven years of plenty are on their way throughout Egypt.

29 Seven years of great abundance are coming throughout the land of Egypt,

30 But on their heels will come seven years of famine, leaving no trace of the Egyptian plenty. As the country is emptied by famine,

30 but seven years of famine will follow them. Then all the abundance in Egypt will be forgotten, and the famine will ravage the land.

31 there won't be even a scrap left of the previous plenty--the famine will be total.

- 31 The abundance in the land will not be remembered, because the famine that follows it will be so severe.
- 32 The fact that Pharaoh dreamed the same dream twice emphasizes God's determination to do this and do it soon.
- 32 The reason the dream was given to Pharaoh in two forms is that the matter has been firmly decided by God, and God will do it soon.
- 33 "So: Pharaoh needs to look for a wise and experienced man and put him in charge of the country.
- 33 And now let Pharaoh look for a discerning and wise man and put him in charge of the land of Egypt.
- 34 Then Pharaoh needs to appoint managers throughout the country of Egypt to organize it during the years of plenty.
- 34 Let Pharaoh appoint commissioners over the land to take a fifth of the harvest of Egypt during the seven years of abundance.
- 35 Their job will be to collect all the food produced in the good years ahead and stockpile the grain under Pharaoh's authority, storing it in the towns for food.
- 35 They should collect all the food of these good years that are coming and store up the grain under the authority of Pharaoh, to be kept in the cities for food.
- 36 This grain will be held back to be used later during the seven years of famine that are coming on Egypt. This way the country won't be devastated by the famine."
- 36 This food should be held in reserve for the country, to be used during the seven years of famine that will come upon Egypt, so that the country may not be ruined by the famine."
- 37 This seemed like a good idea to Pharaoh and his officials.
- 37 The plan seemed good to Pharaoh and to all his officials.
- 38 Then Pharaoh said to his officials, "Isn't this the man we need? Are we going to find anyone else who has God's spirit in him like this?"
- 38 So Pharaoh asked them, "Can we find anyone like this man, one in whom is the spirit of God?"
- 39 So Pharaoh said to Joseph, "You're the man for us. God has given you the inside story--no one is as qualified as you in experience and wisdom.
- 39 Then Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Since God has made all this known to you, there is no one so discerning and wise as you.

- 40 From now on, you're in charge of my affairs; all my people will report to you. Only as king will I be over you."
- 40 You shall be in charge of my palace, and all my people are to submit to your orders. Only with respect to the throne will I be greater than you."
- 41 So Pharaoh commissioned Joseph: "I'm putting you in charge of the entire country of Egypt."
- 41 So Pharaoh said to Joseph, "I hereby put you in charge of the whole land of Egypt."
- 42 Then Pharaoh removed his signet ring from his finger and slipped it on Joseph's hand. He outfitted him in robes of the best linen and put a gold chain around his neck.
- 42 Then Pharaoh took his signet ring from his finger and put it on Joseph's finger. He dressed him in robes of fine linen and put a gold chain around his neck.
- 43 He put the second-in-command chariot at his disposal, and as he rode people shouted "Bravo!" Joseph was in charge of the entire country of Egypt.
- 43 He had him ride in a chariot as his second-in-command, and men shouted before him, "Make way!" Thus he put him in charge of the whole land of Egypt.
- 44 Pharaoh told Joseph, "I am Pharaoh, but no one in Egypt will make a single move without your stamp of approval."
- 44 Then Pharaoh said to Joseph, "I am Pharaoh, but without your word no one will lift hand or foot in all Egypt."
- 45 Then Pharaoh gave Joseph an Egyptian name, Zaphenath-Paneah (God Speaks and He Lives). He also gave him an Egyptian wife, Asenath, the daughter of Potiphera, the priest of On (Heliopolis). And Joseph took up his duties over the land of Egypt.
- 45 Pharaoh gave Joseph the name Zaphenath-Paneah and gave him Asenath daughter of Potiphera, priest of On, to be his wife. And Joseph went throughout the land of Egypt.
- 46 Joseph was thirty years old when he went to work for Pharaoh the king of Egypt. As soon as Joseph left Pharaoh's presence, he began his work in Egypt.
- 46 Joseph was thirty years old when he entered the service of Pharaoh king of Egypt. And Joseph went out from Pharaoh's presence and traveled

throughout Egypt.

47 During the next seven years of plenty the land produced bumper crops.

47 During the seven years of abundance the land produced plentifully.

48 Joseph gathered up the food of the seven good years in Egypt and stored the food in cities. In each city he stockpiled surplus from the surrounding fields.

48 Joseph collected all the food produced in those seven years of abundance in Egypt and stored it in the cities. In each city he put the food grown in the fields surrounding it.

49 Joseph collected so much grain--it was like the sand of the ocean!--that he finally quit keeping track.

49 Joseph stored up huge quantities of grain, like the sand of the sea; it was so much that he stopped keeping records because it was beyond measure.

50 Joseph had two sons born to him before the years of famine came. Asenath, daughter of Potiphera the priest of On, was their mother.

50 Before the years of famine came, two sons were born to Joseph by Asenath daughter of Potiphera, priest of On.

51 Joseph named the firstborn Manasseh (Forget), saying, "God made me forget all my hardships and my parental home."

51 Joseph named his firstborn Manasseh and said, "It is because God has made me forget all my trouble and all my father's household."

52 He named his second son Ephraim (Double Prosperity), saying, "God has prospered me in the land of my sorrow."

52 The second son he named Ephraim and said, "It is because God has made me fruitful in the land of my suffering."

53 Then Egypt's seven good years came to an end

53 The seven years of abundance in Egypt came to an end,

54 and the seven years of famine arrived, just as Joseph had said. All countries experienced famine; Egypt was the only country that had bread.

54 and the seven years of famine began, just as Joseph had said. There was famine in all the other lands, but in the whole land of Egypt there was food.

55 When the famine spread throughout Egypt, the people called out in distress to Pharaoh, calling for bread. He told the Egyptians, "Go to Joseph. Do what he tells you."

- 55 When all Egypt began to feel the famine, the people cried to Pharaoh for food. Then Pharaoh told all the Egyptians, "Go to Joseph and do what he tells you."
- 56 As the famine got worse all over the country, Joseph opened the storehouses and sold emergency supplies to the Egyptians. The famine was very bad.
- 56 When the famine had spread over the whole country, Joseph opened the storehouses and sold grain to the Egyptians, for the famine was severe throughout Egypt.
- 57 Soon the whole world was coming to buy supplies from Joseph. The famine was bad all over.
- 57 And all the countries came to Egypt to buy grain from Joseph, because the famine was severe in all the world.

Genesis 42

MSG

NIV

- 1 When Jacob learned that there was food in Egypt, he said to his sons, "Why do you sit around here and look at one another?"
- 1 When Jacob learned that there was grain in Egypt, he said to his sons, "Why do you just keep looking at each other?"
- 2 I've heard that there is food in Egypt. Go down there and buy some so that we can survive and not starve to death."
- 2 He continued, "I have heard that there is grain in Egypt. Go down there and buy some for us, so that we may live and not die."
- 3 Ten of Joseph's brothers went down to Egypt to get food.
- 3 Then ten of Joseph's brothers went down to buy grain from Egypt.
- 4 Jacob didn't send Joseph's brother Benjamin with them; he was afraid that something bad might happen to him.
- 4 But Jacob did not send Benjamin, Joseph's brother, with the others, because he was afraid that harm might come to him.
- 5 So Israel's sons joined everyone else that was going to Egypt to buy food, for Canaan, too, was hit hard by the famine.
- 5 So Israel's sons were among those who went to buy grain, for the famine was in the land of Canaan also.

- 6 Joseph was running the country; he was the one who gave out rations to all the people. When Joseph's brothers arrived, they treated him with honor, bowing to him.
- 6 Now Joseph was the governor of the land, the one who sold grain to all its people. So when Joseph's brothers arrived, they bowed down to him with their faces to the ground.
- 7 Joseph recognized them immediately, but treated them as strangers and spoke roughly to them. He said, "Where do you come from?" "From Canaan," they said. "We've come to buy food."
- 7 As soon as Joseph saw his brothers, he recognized them, but he pretended to be a stranger and spoke harshly to them. "Where do you come from?" he asked. "From the land of Canaan," they replied, "to buy food."
- 8 Joseph knew who they were, but they didn't know who he was.
- 8 Although Joseph recognized his brothers, they did not recognize him.
- 9 Joseph, remembering the dreams he had dreamed of them, said, "You're spies. You've come to look for our weak spots."
- 9 Then he remembered his dreams about them and said to them, "You are spies! You have come to see where our land is unprotected."
- 10 "No, master," they said. "We've only come to buy food."
- 10 No, my lord, they answered. "Your servants have come to buy food."
- 11 We're all the sons of the same man; we're honest men; we'd never think of spying."
- 11 We are all the sons of one man. Your servants are honest men, not spies."
- 12 He said, "No. You're spies. You've come to look for our weak spots."
- 12 No! he said to them. "You have come to see where our land is unprotected."
- 13 They said, "There were twelve of us brothers--sons of the same father in the country of Canaan. The youngest is with our father, and one is no more."
- 13 But they replied, "Your servants were twelve brothers, the sons of one man, who lives in the land of Canaan. The youngest is now with our father, and one is no more."
- 14 But Joseph said, "It's just as I said, you're spies."
- 14 Joseph said to them, "It is just as I told you: You are spies!"

- 15 This is how I'll test you. As Pharaoh lives, you're not going to leave this place until your younger brother comes here.
- 15 And this is how you will be tested: As surely as Pharaoh lives, you will not leave this place unless your youngest brother comes here.
- 16 Send one of you to get your brother while the rest of you stay here in jail. We'll see if you're telling the truth or not. As Pharaoh lives, I say you're spies."
- 16 Send one of your number to get your brother; the rest of you will be kept in prison, so that your words may be tested to see if you are telling the truth. If you are not, then as surely as Pharaoh lives, you are spies!"
- 17 Then he threw them into jail for three days.
- 17 And he put them all in custody for three days.
- 18 On the third day, Joseph spoke to them. "Do this and you'll live. I'm a God-fearing man.
- 18 On the third day, Joseph said to them, "Do this and you will live, for I fear God:
- 19 If you're as honest as you say you are, one of your brothers will stay here in jail while the rest of you take the food back to your hungry families.
- 19 If you are honest men, let one of your brothers stay here in prison, while the rest of you go and take grain back for your starving households.
- 20 But you have to bring your youngest brother back to me, confirming the truth of your speech--and not one of you will die." They agreed.
- 20 But you must bring your youngest brother to me, so that your words may be verified and that you may not die." This they proceeded to do.
- 21 Then they started talking among themselves. "Now we're paying for what we did to our brother--we saw how terrified he was when he was begging us for mercy. We wouldn't listen to him and now we're the ones in trouble."
- 21 They said to one another, "Surely we are being punished because of our brother. We saw how distressed he was when he pleaded with us for his life, but we would not listen; that's why this distress has come upon us."
- 22 Reuben broke in. "Didn't I tell you, 'Don't hurt the boy'? But no, you wouldn't listen. And now we're paying for his murder."
- 22 Reuben replied, "Didn't I tell you not to sin against the boy? But you wouldn't listen! Now we must give an accounting for his blood."

- 23 Joseph had been using an interpreter, so they didn't know that Joseph was understanding every word.
- 23 They did not realize that Joseph could understand them, since he was using an interpreter.
- 24 Joseph turned away from them and cried. When he was able to speak again, he took Simeon and had him tied up, making a prisoner of him while they all watched.
- 24 He turned away from them and began to weep, but then turned back and spoke to them again. He had Simeon taken from them and bound before their eyes.
- 25 Then Joseph ordered that their sacks be filled with grain, that their money be put back in each sack, and that they be given rations for the road. That was all done for them.
- 25 Joseph gave orders to fill their bags with grain, to put each man's silver back in his sack, and to give them provisions for their journey. After this was done for them,
- 26 They loaded their food supplies on their donkeys and set off.
- 26 they loaded their grain on their donkeys and left.
- 27 When they stopped for the night, one of them opened his sack to get food for his donkey; there at the mouth of his bag was his money
- 27 At the place where they stopped for the night one of them opened his sack to get feed for his donkey, and he saw his silver in the mouth of his sack.
- 28 He called out to his brothers, "My money has been returned; it's right here in my bag!" They were puzzled--and frightened. "What's God doing to us?"
- 28 My silver has been returned, he said to his brothers. "Here it is in my sack." Their hearts sank and they turned to each other trembling and said, "What is this that God has done to us?"
- 29 When they got back to their father Jacob, back in the land of Canaan, they told him everything that had happened, saying,
- 29 When they came to their father Jacob in the land of Canaan, they told him all that had happened to them. They said,
- 30 "The man who runs the country spoke to us roughly and accused us of being spies.

- 30 The man who is lord over the land spoke harshly to us and treated us as though we were spying on the land.
- 31 We told him, 'We are honest men and in no way spies.
- 31 But we said to him, 'We are honest men; we are not spies.
- 32 There were twelve of us brothers, sons of one father; one is gone and the youngest is with our father in Canaan.'
- 32 We were twelve brothers, sons of one father. One is no more, and the youngest is now with our father in Canaan.'
- 33 "But the master of the country said, 'Leave one of your brothers with me, take food for your starving families, and go.
- 33 Then the man who is lord over the land said to us, 'This is how I will know whether you are honest men: Leave one of your brothers here with me, and take food for your starving households and go.
- 34 Bring your youngest brother back to me, proving that you're honest men and not spies. And then I'll give your brother back to you and you'll be free to come and go in this country.'"
- 34 But bring your youngest brother to me so I will know that you are not spies but honest men. Then I will give your brother back to you, and you can trade in the land.' "
- 35 As they were emptying their food sacks, each man came on his purse of money. On seeing their money, they and their father were upset.
- 35 As they were emptying their sacks, there in each man's sack was his pouch of silver! When they and their father saw the money pouches, they were frightened.
- 36 Their father said to them, "You're taking everything I've got! Joseph's gone, Simeon's gone, and now you want to take Benjamin. If you have your way, I'll be left with nothing."
- 36 Their father Jacob said to them, "You have deprived me of my children. Joseph is no more and Simeon is no more, and now you want to take Benjamin. Everything is against me!"
- 37 Reuben spoke up: "I'll put my two sons in your hands as hostages. If I don't bring Benjamin back, you can kill them. Trust me with Benjamin; I'll bring him back."
- 37 Then Reuben said to his father, "You may put both of my sons to death if I do not bring him back to you. Entrust him to my care, and I will bring him back."

38 But Jacob refused. "My son will not go down with you. His brother is dead and he is all I have left. If something bad happens to him on the road, you'll put my gray, sorrowing head in the grave."

38 But Jacob said, "My son will not go down there with you; his brother is dead and he is the only one left. If harm comes to him on the journey you are taking, you will bring my gray head down to the grave in sorrow."

Genesis 43

MSG

NIV

1 The famine got worse.

1 Now the famine was still severe in the land.

2 When they had eaten all the food they had brought back from Egypt, their father said, "Go back and get some more food."

2 So when they had eaten all the grain they had brought from Egypt, their father said to them, "Go back and buy us a little more food."

3 But Judah said, "The man warned us most emphatically, 'You won't so much as see my face if you don't have your brother with you.'

3 But Judah said to him, "The man warned us solemnly, 'You will not see my face again unless your brother is with you.'

4 If you're ready to release our brother to go with us, we'll go down and get you food.

4 If you will send our brother along with us, we will go down and buy food for you.

5 But if you're not ready, we aren't going. What would be the use? The man told us, 'You won't so much as see my face if you don't have your brother with you.'"

5 But if you will not send him, we will not go down, because the man said to us, 'You will not see my face again unless your brother is with you.' "

6 Israel said, "Why are you making my life so difficult! Why did you ever tell the man you had another brother?"

6 Israel asked, "Why did you bring this trouble on me by telling the man you had another brother?"

- 7 They said, "The man pressed us hard, asking pointed questions about our family: 'Is your father alive? Do you have another brother?' So we answered his questions. How did we know that he'd say, 'Bring your brother here'?"
- 7 They replied, "The man questioned us closely about ourselves and our family. 'Is your father still living?' he asked us. 'Do you have another brother?' We simply answered his questions. How were we to know he would say, 'Bring your brother down here'?"
- 8 Judah pushed his father Israel. "Let the boy go; I'll take charge of him. Let us go and be on our way--if we don't get going, we're all going to starve to death--we and you and our children too!
- 8 Then Judah said to Israel his father, "Send the boy along with me and we will go at once, so that we and you and our children may live and not die.
- 9 I'll take full responsibility for his safety; it's my life on the line for his. If I don't bring him back safe and sound, I'm the guilty one; I'll take all the blame.
- 9 I myself will guarantee his safety; you can hold me personally responsible for him. If I do not bring him back to you and set him here before you, I will bear the blame before you all my life.
- 10 If we had gone ahead in the first place instead of procrastinating like this, we could have been there and back twice over."
- 10 As it is, if we had not delayed, we could have gone and returned twice."
- 11 Their father Israel gave in. "If it has to be, it has to be. But do this: stuff your packs with the finest products from the land you can find and take them to the man as gifts--some balm and honey, some spices and perfumes, some pistachios and almonds.
- 11 Then their father Israel said to them, "If it must be, then do this: Put some of the best products of the land in your bags and take them down to the man as a gift--a little balm and a little honey, some spices and myrrh, some pistachio nuts and almonds.
- 12 And take plenty of money--pay back double what was returned to your sacks; that might have been a mistake.
- 12 Take double the amount of silver with you, for you must return the silver that was put back into the mouths of your sacks. Perhaps it was a

mistake.

- 13 Take your brother and get going. Go back to the man.
- 13 Take your brother also and go back to the man at once.
- 14 And may The Strong God give you grace in that man's eyes so that he'll send back your other brother along with Benjamin. For me, nothing's left; I've lost everything."
- 14 And may God Almighty grant you mercy before the man so that he will let your other brother and Benjamin come back with you. As for me, if I am bereaved, I am bereaved."
- 15 The men took the gifts, double the money, and Benjamin. They lost no time in getting to Egypt and meeting Joseph.
- 15 So the men took the gifts and double the amount of silver, and Benjamin also. They hurried down to Egypt and presented themselves to Joseph.
- 16 When Joseph saw that they had Benjamin with them, he told his house steward, "Take these men into the house and make them at home. Butcher an animal and prepare a meal; these men are going to eat with me at noon."
- 16 When Joseph saw Benjamin with them, he said to the steward of his house, "Take these men to my house, slaughter an animal and prepare dinner; they are to eat with me at noon."
- 17 The steward did what Joseph had said and took them inside.
- 17 The man did as Joseph told him and took the men to Joseph's house.
- 18 But they became anxious when they were brought into Joseph's home, thinking, "It's the money; he thinks we ran off with the money on our first trip down here. And now he's got us where he wants us--he's going to turn us into slaves and confiscate our donkeys."
- 18 Now the men were frightened when they were taken to his house. They thought, "We were brought here because of the silver that was put back into our sacks the first time. He wants to attack us and overpower us and seize us as slaves and take our donkeys."
- 19 So they went up to Joseph's house steward and talked to him in the doorway.
- 19 So they went up to Joseph's steward and spoke to him at the entrance to the house.
- 20 They said, "Listen, master. We came down here one other time to buy food.

20 Please, sir, they said, "we came down here the first time to buy food.

21 On our way home, the first night out we opened our bags and found our money at the mouth of the bag--the exact amount we'd paid. We've brought it all back

21 But at the place where we stopped for the night we opened our sacks and each of us found his silver--the exact weight--in the mouth of his sack. So we have brought it back with us.

22 and have plenty more to buy more food with. We have no idea who put the money in our bags."

22 We have also brought additional silver with us to buy food. We don't know who put our silver in our sacks."

23 The steward said, "Everything's in order. Don't worry. Your God and the God of your father must have given you a bonus. I was paid in full." And with that, he presented Simeon to them.

23 It's all right, he said. "Don't be afraid. Your God, the God of your father, has given you treasure in your sacks; I received your silver." Then he brought Simeon out to them.

24 He then took them inside Joseph's house and made them comfortable--gave them water to wash their feet and saw to the feeding of their donkeys.

24 The steward took the men into Joseph's house, gave them water to wash their feet and provided fodder for their donkeys.

25 The brothers spread out their gifts as they waited for Joseph to show up at noon--they had been told that they were to have dinner with him.

25 They prepared their gifts for Joseph's arrival at noon, because they had heard that they were to eat there.

26 When Joseph got home, they presented him with the gifts they had brought and bowed respectfully before him.

26 When Joseph came home, they presented to him the gifts they had brought into the house, and they bowed down before him to the ground.

27 Joseph welcomed them and said, "And your old father whom you mentioned to me, how is he? Is he still alive?"

27 He asked them how they were, and then he said, "How is your aged father you told me about? Is he still living?"

28 They said, "Yes--your servant our father is quite well, very much alive." And they again bowed respectfully before him.

- 28 They replied, "Your servant our father is still alive and well." And they bowed low to pay him honor.
- 29 Then Joseph picked out his brother Benjamin, his own mother's son. He asked, "And is this your youngest brother that you told me about?" Then he said, "God be gracious to you, my son."
- 29 As he looked about and saw his brother Benjamin, his own mother's son, he asked, "Is this your youngest brother, the one you told me about?" And he said, "God be gracious to you, my son."
- 30 Deeply moved on seeing his brother and about to burst into tears, Joseph hurried out into another room and had a good cry.
- 30 Deeply moved at the sight of his brother, Joseph hurried out and looked for a place to weep. He went into his private room and wept there.
- 31 Then he washed his face, got a grip on himself, and said, "Let's eat."
- 31 After he had washed his face, he came out and, controlling himself, said, "Serve the food."
- 32 Joseph was served at his private table, the brothers off by themselves and the Egyptians off by themselves (Egyptians won't eat at the same table with Hebrews; it's repulsive to them).
- 32 They served him by himself, the brothers by themselves, and the Egyptians who ate with him by themselves, because Egyptians could not eat with Hebrews, for that is detestable to Egyptians.
- 33 The brothers were seated facing Joseph, arranged in order of their age, from the oldest to the youngest. They looked at one another wide-eyed, wondering what would happen next.
- 33 The men had been seated before him in the order of their ages, from the firstborn to the youngest; and they looked at each other in astonishment.
- 34 When the brothers' plates were served from Joseph's table, Benjamin's plate came piled high, far more so than his brothers. And so the brothers feasted with Joseph, drinking freely.
- 34 When portions were served to them from Joseph's table, Benjamin's portion was five times as much as anyone else's. So they feasted and drank freely with him.

Genesis 44

MSG

NIV

- 1 Joseph ordered his house steward: "Fill the men's bags with food--all they can carry--and replace each one's money at the top of the bag.
- 1 Now Joseph gave these instructions to the steward of his house: "Fill the men's sacks with as much food as they can carry, and put each man's silver in the mouth of his sack.
- 2 Then put my chalice, my silver chalice, in the top of the bag of the youngest, along with the money for his food." He did as Joseph ordered.
- 2 Then put my cup, the silver one, in the mouth of the youngest one's sack, along with the silver for his grain." And he did as Joseph said.
- 3 At break of day the men were sent off with their donkeys.
- 3 As morning dawned, the men were sent on their way with their donkeys.
- 4 They were barely out of the city when Joseph said to his house steward, "Run after them. When you catch up with them, say, 'Why did you pay me back evil for good?
- 4 They had not gone far from the city when Joseph said to his steward, "Go after those men at once, and when you catch up with them, say to them, 'Why have you repaid good with evil?
- 5 This is the chalice my master drinks from; he also uses it for divination. This is outrageous!'"
- 5 Isn't this the cup my master drinks from and also uses for divination? This is a wicked thing you have done.' "
- 6 He caught up with them and repeated all this word for word.
- 6 When he caught up with them, he repeated these words to them.
- 7 They said, "What is my master talking about? We would never do anything like that!
- 7 But they said to him, "Why does my lord say such things? Far be it from your servants to do anything like that!
- 8 Why, the money we found in our bags earlier, we brought back all the way from Canaan--do you think we'd turn right around and steal it back from your master?
- 8 We even brought back to you from the land of Canaan the silver we found inside the mouths of our sacks. So why would we steal silver or gold from your master's house?
- 9 If that chalice is found on any of us, he'll die; and the rest of us will be your master's slaves."

- 9 If any of your servants is found to have it, he will die; and the rest of us will become my lord's slaves."
- 10 The steward said, "Very well then, but we won't go that far. Whoever is found with the chalice will be my slave; the rest of you can go free."
- 10 Very well, then, he said, "let it be as you say. Whoever is found to have it will become my slave; the rest of you will be free from blame."
- 11 They outdid each other in putting their bags on the ground and opening them up for inspection.
- 11 Each of them quickly lowered his sack to the ground and opened it.
- 12 The steward searched their bags, going from oldest to youngest. The chalice showed up in Benjamin's bag.
- 12 Then the steward proceeded to search, beginning with the oldest and ending with the youngest. And the cup was found in Benjamin's sack.
- 13 They ripped their clothes in despair, loaded up their donkeys, and went back to the city.
- 13 At this, they tore their clothes. Then they all loaded their donkeys and returned to the city.
- 14 Joseph was still at home when Judah and his brothers got back. They threw themselves down on the ground in front of him.
- 14 Joseph was still in the house when Judah and his brothers came in, and they threw themselves to the ground before him.
- 15 Joseph accused them: "How can you have done this? You have to know that a man in my position would have discovered this."
- 15 Joseph said to them, "What is this you have done? Don't you know that a man like me can find things out by divination?"
- 16 Judah as spokesman for the brothers said, "What can we say, master? What is there to say? How can we prove our innocence? God is behind this, exposing how bad we are. We stand guilty before you and ready to be your slaves--we're all in this together, the rest of us as guilty as the one with the chalice."
- 16 What can we say to my lord? Judah replied. "What can we say? How can we prove our innocence? God has uncovered your servants' guilt. We are now my lord's slaves--we ourselves and the one who was found to have the cup."
- 17 "I'd never do that to you," said Joseph. "Only the one involved with the chalice will be my slave. The rest of you are free to go back to your

father."

17 But Joseph said, "Far be it from me to do such a thing! Only the man who was found to have the cup will become my slave. The rest of you, go back to your father in peace."

18 Judah came forward. He said, "Please, master; can I say just one thing to you? Don't get angry. Don't think I'm presumptuous--you're the same as Pharaoh as far as I'm concerned.

18 Then Judah went up to him and said: "Please, my lord, let your servant speak a word to my lord. Do not be angry with your servant, though you are equal to Pharaoh himself.

19 You, master, asked us, 'Do you have a father and a brother?'

19 My lord asked his servants, 'Do you have a father or a brother?'

20 And we answered honestly, 'We have a father who is old and a younger brother who was born to him in his old age. His brother is dead and he is the only son left from that mother. And his father loves him more than anything.'

20 And we answered, 'We have an aged father, and there is a young son born to him in his old age. His brother is dead, and he is the only one of his mother's sons left, and his father loves him.'

21 "Then you told us, 'Bring him down here so I can see him.'

21 Then you said to your servants, 'Bring him down to me so I can see him for myself.'

22 We told you, master, that it was impossible: 'The boy can't leave his father; if he leaves, his father will die.'

22 And we said to my lord, 'The boy cannot leave his father; if he leaves him, his father will die.'

23 "And then you said, 'If your youngest brother doesn't come with you, you won't be allowed to see me.'

23 But you told your servants, 'Unless your youngest brother comes down with you, you will not see my face again.'

24 "When we returned to our father, we told him everything you said to us.

24 When we went back to your servant my father, we told him what my lord had said.

25 So when our father said, 'Go back and buy some more food,'

25 Then our father said, 'Go back and buy a little more food.'

- 26 we told him flatly, 'We can't. The only way we can go back is if our youngest brother is with us. We aren't allowed to even see the man if our youngest brother doesn't come with us.'
- 26 But we said, 'We cannot go down. Only if our youngest brother is with us will we go. We cannot see the man's face unless our youngest brother is with us.'
- 27 "Your servant, my father, told us, 'You know very well that my wife gave me two sons.
- 27 Your servant my father said to us, 'You know that my wife bore me two sons.
- 28 One turned up missing. I concluded that he'd been ripped to pieces. I've never seen him since.
- 28 One of them went away from me, and I said, "He has surely been torn to pieces." And I have not seen him since.
- 29 If you now go and take this one and something bad happens to him, you'll put my old gray, grieving head in the grave for sure.'
- 29 If you take this one from me too and harm comes to him, you will bring my gray head down to the grave in misery.'
- 30 "And now, can't you see that if I show up before your servant, my father, without the boy, this son with whom his life is so bound up,
- 30 So now, if the boy is not with us when I go back to your servant my father and if my father, whose life is closely bound up with the boy's life,
- 31 the moment he realizes the boy is gone, he'll die on the spot. He'll die of grief and we, your servants who are standing here before you, will have killed him.
- 31 sees that the boy isn't there, he will die. Your servants will bring the gray head of our father down to the grave in sorrow.
- 32 And that's not all. I got my father to release the boy to show him to you by promising, 'If I don't bring him back, I'll stand condemned before you, Father, all my life.'
- 32 Your servant guaranteed the boy's safety to my father. I said, 'If I do not bring him back to you, I will bear the blame before you, my father, all my life!'
- 33 "So let me stay here as your slave, not this boy. Let the boy go back with his brothers.

- 33 Now then, please let your servant remain here as my lord's slave in place of the boy, and let the boy return with his brothers.
- 34 How can I go back to my father if the boy is not with me? Oh, don't make me go back and watch my father die in grief!"
- 34 How can I go back to my father if the boy is not with me? No! Do not let me see the misery that would come upon my father."

Genesis 45

MSG

NIV

- 1 Joseph couldn't hold himself in any longer, keeping up a front before all his attendants. He cried out, "Leave! Clear out--everyone leave!" So there was no one with Joseph when he identified himself to his brothers.
- 1 Then Joseph could no longer control himself before all his attendants, and he cried out, "Have everyone leave my presence!" So there was no one with Joseph when he made himself known to his brothers.
- 2 But his sobbing was so violent that the Egyptians couldn't help but hear him. The news was soon reported to Pharaoh's palace.
- 2 And he wept so loudly that the Egyptians heard him, and Pharaoh's household heard about it.
- 3 Joseph spoke to his brothers: "I am Joseph. Is my father really still alive?" But his brothers couldn't say a word. They were speechless--they couldn't believe what they were hearing and seeing.
- 3 Joseph said to his brothers, "I am Joseph! Is my father still living?" But his brothers were not able to answer him, because they were terrified at his presence.
- 4 "Come closer to me," Joseph said to his brothers. They came closer. "I am Joseph your brother whom you sold into Egypt.
- 4 Then Joseph said to his brothers, "Come close to me." When they had done so, he said, "I am your brother Joseph, the one you sold into Egypt!
- 5 But don't feel badly, don't blame yourselves for selling me. God was behind it. God sent me here ahead of you to save lives.
- 5 And now, do not be distressed and do not be angry with yourselves for selling me here, because it was to save lives that God sent me ahead of you.

- 6 There has been a famine in the land now for two years; the famine will continue for five more years--neither plowing nor harvesting.
- 6 For two years now there has been famine in the land, and for the next five years there will not be plowing and reaping.
- 7 God sent me on ahead to pave the way and make sure there was a remnant in the land, to save your lives in an amazing act of deliverance.
- 7 But God sent me ahead of you to preserve for you a remnant on earth and to save your lives by a great deliverance.
- 8 So you see, it wasn't you who sent me here but God. He set me in place as a father to Pharaoh, put me in charge of his personal affairs, and made me ruler of all Egypt.
- 8 So then, it was not you who sent me here, but God. He made me father to Pharaoh, lord of his entire household and ruler of all Egypt.
- 9 "Hurry back to my father. Tell him, 'Your son Joseph says: I'm master of all of Egypt. Come as fast as you can and join me here.
- 9 Now hurry back to my father and say to him, 'This is what your son Joseph says: God has made me lord of all Egypt. Come down to me; don't delay.
- 10 I'll give you a place to live in Goshen where you'll be close to me--you, your children, your grandchildren, your flocks, your herds, and anything else you can think of.
- 10 You shall live in the region of Goshen and be near me--you, your children and grandchildren, your flocks and herds, and all you have.
- 11 I'll take care of you there completely. There are still five more years of famine ahead; I'll make sure all your needs are taken care of, you and everyone connected with you--you won't want for a thing.'
- 11 I will provide for you there, because five years of famine are still to come. Otherwise you and your household and all who belong to you will become destitute.'
- 12 "Look at me. You can see for yourselves, and my brother Benjamin can see for himself, that it's me, my own mouth, telling you all this.
- 12 You can see for yourselves, and so can my brother Benjamin, that it is really I who am speaking to you.
- 13 Tell my father all about the high position I hold in Egypt, tell him everything you've seen here, but don't take all day--hurry up and get my father down here."

13 Tell my father about all the honor accorded me in Egypt and about everything you have seen. And bring my father down here quickly."

14 Then Joseph threw himself on his brother Benjamin's neck and wept, and Benjamin wept on his neck.

14 Then he threw his arms around his brother Benjamin and wept, and Benjamin embraced him, weeping.

15 He then kissed all his brothers and wept over them. Only then were his brothers able to talk with him.

15 And he kissed all his brothers and wept over them. Afterward his brothers talked with him.

16 The story was reported in Pharaoh's palace: "Joseph's brothers have come." It was good news to Pharaoh and all who worked with him.

16 When the news reached Pharaoh's palace that Joseph's brothers had come, Pharaoh and all his officials were pleased.

17 Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Tell your brothers, 'This is the plan: Load up your pack animals; go to Canaan,

17 Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Tell your brothers, 'Do this: Load your animals and return to the land of Canaan,

18 get your father and your families and bring them back here. I'll settle you on the best land in Egypt--you'll live off the fat of the land.'

18 and bring your father and your families back to me. I will give you the best of the land of Egypt and you can enjoy the fat of the land.'

19 "Also tell them this: 'Here's what I want you to do: Take wagons from Egypt to carry your little ones and your wives and load up your father and come back.

19 You are also directed to tell them, 'Do this: Take some carts from Egypt for your children and your wives, and get your father and come.

20 Don't worry about having to leave things behind; the best in all of Egypt will be yours.'"

20 Never mind about your belongings, because the best of all Egypt will be yours.' "

21 And they did just that, the sons of Israel. Joseph gave them the wagons that Pharaoh had promised and food for the trip.

21 So the sons of Israel did this. Joseph gave them carts, as Pharaoh had commanded, and he also gave them provisions for their journey.

- 22 He outfitted all the brothers in brand-new clothes, but he gave Benjamin three hundred pieces of silver and several suits of clothes.
- 22 To each of them he gave new clothing, but to Benjamin he gave three hundred shekels of silver and five sets of clothes.
- 23 He sent his father these gifts: ten donkeys loaded with Egypt's best products and another ten donkeys loaded with grain and bread, provisions for his father's journey back.
- 23 And this is what he sent to his father: ten donkeys loaded with the best things of Egypt, and ten female donkeys loaded with grain and bread and other provisions for his journey.
- 24 Then he sent his brothers off. As they left he told them, "Take it easy on the journey; try to get along with each other."
- 24 Then he sent his brothers away, and as they were leaving he said to them, "Don't quarrel on the way!"
- 25 They left Egypt and went back to their father Jacob in Canaan.
- 25 So they went up out of Egypt and came to their father Jacob in the land of Canaan.
- 26 When they told him, "Joseph is still alive--and he's the ruler over the whole land of Egypt!" he went numb; he couldn't believe his ears.
- 26 They told him, "Joseph is still alive! In fact, he is ruler of all Egypt." Jacob was stunned; he did not believe them.
- 27 But the more they talked, telling him everything that Joseph had told them and when he saw the wagons that Joseph had sent to carry him back, the blood started to flow again--their father Jacob's spirit revived.
- 27 But when they told him everything Joseph had said to them, and when he saw the carts Joseph had sent to carry him back, the spirit of their father Jacob revived.
- 28 Israel said, "I've heard enough--my son Joseph is still alive. I've got to go and see him before I die."
- 28 And Israel said, "I'm convinced! My son Joseph is still alive. I will go and see him before I die."

Genesis 46

MSG

NIV

- 1 So Israel set out on the journey with everything he owned. He arrived at Beersheba and worshiped, offering sacrifices to the God of his father Isaac.
- 1 So Israel set out with all that was his, and when he reached Beersheba, he offered sacrifices to the God of his father Isaac.
- 2 God spoke to Israel in a vision that night: "Jacob! Jacob!" "Yes?" he said. "I'm listening."
- 2 And God spoke to Israel in a vision at night and said, "Jacob! Jacob!" "Here I am," he replied.
- 3 God said, "I am the God of your father. Don't be afraid of going down to Egypt. I'm going to make you a great nation there.
- 3 I am God, the God of your father, he said. "Do not be afraid to go down to Egypt, for I will make you into a great nation there.
- 4 I'll go with you down to Egypt; I'll also bring you back here. And when you die, Joseph will be with you; with his own hand he'll close your eyes."
- 4 I will go down to Egypt with you, and I will surely bring you back again. And Joseph's own hand will close your eyes."
- 5 Then Jacob left Beersheba. Israel's sons loaded their father and their little ones and their wives on the wagons Pharaoh had sent to carry him.
- 5 Then Jacob left Beersheba, and Israel's sons took their father Jacob and their children and their wives in the carts that Pharaoh had sent to transport him.
- 6 They arrived in Egypt with the livestock and the wealth they had accumulated in Canaan. Jacob brought everyone in his family with him--
- 6 They also took with them their livestock and the possessions they had acquired in Canaan, and Jacob and all his offspring went to Egypt.
- 7 sons and grandsons, daughters and granddaughters. Everyone.
- 7 He took with him to Egypt his sons and grandsons and his daughters and granddaughters--all his offspring.
- 8 These are the names of the Israelites, Jacob and his descendants, who went to Egypt: Reuben, Jacob's firstborn.
- 8 These are the names of the sons of Israel (Jacob and his descendants) who went to Egypt: Reuben the firstborn of Jacob.
- 9 Reuben's sons: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi.
- 9 The sons of Reuben: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron and Carmi.

- 10 Simeon's sons: Jemuel, Jamin, Ohad, Jakin, Zohar, and Shaul the son of a Canaanite woman.
- 10 The sons of Simeon: Jemuel, Jamin, Ohad, Jakin, Zohar and Shaul the son of a Canaanite woman.
- 11 Levi's sons: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.
- 11 The sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath and Merari.
- 12 Judah's sons: Er, Onan, Shelah, Perez, and Zerah (Er and Onan had already died in the land of Canaan). The sons of Perez were Hezron and Hamul.
- 12 The sons of Judah: Er, Onan, Shelah, Perez and Zerah (but Er and Onan had died in the land of Canaan). The sons of Perez: Hezron and Hamul.
- 13 Issachar's sons: Tola, Puah, Jashub, and Shimron.
- 13 The sons of Issachar: Tola, Puah, Jashub and Shimron.
- 14 Zebulun's sons: Sered, Elon, and Jahleel.
- 14 The sons of Zebulun: Sered, Elon and Jahleel.
- 15 These are the sons that Leah bore to Jacob in Paddan Aram. There was also his daughter Dinah. Altogether, sons and daughters, they numbered thirty-three.
- 15 These were the sons Leah bore to Jacob in Paddan Aram, besides his daughter Dinah. These sons and daughters of his were thirty-three in all.
- 16 Gad's sons: Zephon, Haggi, Shuni, Ezbon, Eri, Arodi, and Areli.
- 16 The sons of Gad: Zephon, Haggi, Shuni, Ezbon, Eri, Arodi and Areli.
- 17 Asher's sons: Imnah, Ishvah, Ishvi, and Beriah. Also their sister Serah, and Beriah's sons, Heber and Malkiel.
- 17 The sons of Asher: Imnah, Ishvah, Ishvi and Beriah. Their sister was Serah. The sons of Beriah: Heber and Malkiel.
- 18 These are the children that Zilpah, the maid that Laban gave to his daughter Leah, bore to Jacob--sixteen of them.
- 18 These were the children born to Jacob by Zilpah, whom Laban had given to his daughter Leah--sixteen in all.
- 19 The sons of Jacob's wife Rachel were Joseph and Benjamin.
- 19 The sons of Jacob's wife Rachel: Joseph and Benjamin.
- 20 Joseph was the father of two sons, Manasseh and Ephraim, from his marriage to Asenath daughter of Potiphera, priest of On. They were born to him in Egypt.

- 20 In Egypt, Manasseh and Ephraim were born to Joseph by Asenath daughter of Potiphera, priest of On.
- 21 Benjamin's sons were Bela, Beker, Ashbel, Gera, Naaman, Ehi, Rosh, Muppm, Huppm, and Ard.
- 21 The sons of Benjamin: Bela, Beker, Ashbel, Gera, Naaman, Ehi, Rosh, Muppm, Huppm and Ard.
- 22 These are the children born to Jacob through Rachel--fourteen.
- 22 These were the sons of Rachel who were born to Jacob-- fourteen in all.
- 23 Dan's son: Hushim.
- 23 The son of Dan: Hushim.
- 24 Naphtali's sons: Jahziel, Guni, Jezer, and Shillem.
- 24 The sons of Naphtali: Jahziel, Guni, Jezer and Shillem.
- 25 These are the children born to Jacob through Bilhah, the maid Laban had given to his daughter Rachel--seven.
- 25 These were the sons born to Jacob by Bilhah, whom Laban had given to his daughter Rachel--seven in all.
- 26 Summing up, all those who went down to Egypt with Jacob--his own children, not counting his sons' wives--numbered sixty-six.
- 26 All those who went to Egypt with Jacob--those who were his direct descendants, not counting his sons' wives--numbered sixty- six persons.
- 27 Counting in the two sons born to Joseph in Egypt, the members of Jacob's family who ended up in Egypt numbered seventy.
- 27 With the two sons who had been born to Joseph in Egypt, the members of Jacob's family, which went to Egypt, were seventy in all.
- 28 Jacob sent Judah on ahead to get directions to Goshen from Joseph. When they got to Goshen,
- 28 Now Jacob sent Judah ahead of him to Joseph to get directions to Goshen. When they arrived in the region of Goshen,
- 29 Joseph gave orders for his chariot and went to Goshen to meet his father Israel. The moment Joseph saw him, he threw himself on his neck and wept. He wept a long time.
- 29 Joseph had his chariot made ready and went to Goshen to meet his father Israel. As soon as Joseph appeared before him, he threw his arms around his father and wept for a long time.
- 30 Israel said to Joseph, "I'm ready to die. I've looked into your face--you are indeed alive."

- 30 Israel said to Joseph, "Now I am ready to die, since I have seen for myself that you are still alive."
- 31 Joseph then spoke to his brothers and his father's family. "I'll go and tell Pharaoh, 'My brothers and my father's family, all of whom lived in Canaan, have come to me.
- 31 Then Joseph said to his brothers and to his father's household, "I will go up and speak to Pharaoh and will say to him, 'My brothers and my father's household, who were living in the land of Canaan, have come to me.
- 32 The men are shepherds; they've always made their living by raising livestock. And they've brought their flocks and herds with them, along with everything else they own.'
- 32 The men are shepherds; they tend livestock, and they have brought along their flocks and herds and everything they own.'
- 33 When Pharaoh calls you in and asks what kind of work you do,
- 33 When Pharaoh calls you in and asks, 'What is your occupation?'
- 34 tell him, 'Your servants have always kept livestock for as long as we can remember--we and our parents also.' That way he'll let you stay apart in the area of Goshen--for Egyptians look down on anyone who is a shepherd."
- 34 you should answer, 'Your servants have tended livestock from our boyhood on, just as our fathers did.' Then you will be allowed to settle in the region of Goshen, for all shepherds are detestable to the Egyptians."

Genesis 47

MSG

NIV

- 1 Joseph went to Pharaoh and told him, "My father and brothers with their flocks and herds and everything they own have come from Canaan. Right now they are in Goshen."
- 1 Joseph went and told Pharaoh, "My father and brothers, with their flocks and herds and everything they own, have come from the land of Canaan and are now in Goshen."
- 2 He had taken five of his brothers with him and introduced them to Pharaoh.

- 2 He chose five of his brothers and presented them before Pharaoh.
- 3 Pharaoh asked them, "What kind of work do you do?" "Your servants are shepherds, the same as our fathers were.
- 3 Pharaoh asked the brothers, "What is your occupation?" "Your servants are shepherds," they replied to Pharaoh, "just as our fathers were."
- 4 We have come to this country to find a new place to live. There is no pasture for our flocks in Canaan. The famine has been very bad there. Please, would you let your servants settle in the region of Goshen?"
- 4 They also said to him, "We have come to live here awhile, because the famine is severe in Canaan and your servants' flocks have no pasture. So now, please let your servants settle in Goshen."
- 5 Pharaoh looked at Joseph. "So, your father and brothers have arrived--a reunion!
- 5 Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Your father and your brothers have come to you, Egypt welcomes them. Settle your father and brothers on the choicest land--yes, give them Goshen. And if you know any among them that are especially good at their work, put them in charge of my own livestock."
- 6 and the land of Egypt is before you; settle your father and your brothers in the best part of the land. Let them live in Goshen. And if you know of any among them with special ability, put them in charge of my own livestock."
- 7 Next Joseph brought his father Jacob in and introduced him to Pharaoh. Jacob blessed Pharaoh.
- 7 Then Joseph brought his father Jacob in and presented him before Pharaoh. After Jacob blessed Pharaoh,
- 8 Pharaoh asked Jacob, "How old are you?"
- 8 Pharaoh asked him, "How old are you?"
- 9 Jacob answered Pharaoh, "The years of my sojourning are 130--a short and hard life and not nearly as long as my ancestors were given."
- 9 And Jacob said to Pharaoh, "The years of my pilgrimage are a hundred and thirty. My years have been few and difficult, and they do not equal the years of the pilgrimage of my fathers."
- 10 Then Jacob blessed Pharaoh and left.
- 10 Then Jacob blessed Pharaoh and went out from his presence.
- 11 Joseph settled his father and brothers in Egypt, made them proud owners of choice land--it was the region of Rameses (that is, Goshen)--

just as Pharaoh had ordered.

- 11 So Joseph settled his father and his brothers in Egypt and gave them property in the best part of the land, the district of Rameses, as Pharaoh directed.
- 12 Joseph took good care of them--his father and brothers and all his father's family, right down to the smallest baby. He made sure they had plenty of everything.
- 12 Joseph also provided his father and his brothers and all his father's household with food, according to the number of their children.
- 13 The time eventually came when there was no food anywhere. The famine was very bad. Egypt and Canaan alike were devastated by the famine.
- 13 There was no food, however, in the whole region because the famine was severe; both Egypt and Canaan wasted away because of the famine.
- 14 Joseph collected all the money that was to be found in Egypt and Canaan to pay for the distribution of food. He banked the money in Pharaoh's palace.
- 14 Joseph collected all the money that was to be found in Egypt and Canaan in payment for the grain they were buying, and he brought it to Pharaoh's palace.
- 15 When the money from Egypt and Canaan had run out, the Egyptians came to Joseph. "Food! Give us food! Are you going to watch us die right in front of you? The money is all gone."
- 15 When the money of the people of Egypt and Canaan was gone, all Egypt came to Joseph and said, "Give us food. Why should we die before your eyes? Our money is used up."
- 16 Joseph said, "Bring your livestock. I'll trade you food for livestock since your money's run out."
- 16 Then bring your livestock, said Joseph. "I will sell you food in exchange for your livestock, since your money is gone."
- 17 So they brought Joseph their livestock. He traded them food for their horses, sheep, cattle, and donkeys. He got them through that year in exchange for all their livestock.
- 17 So they brought their livestock to Joseph, and he gave them food in exchange for their horses, their sheep and goats, their cattle and donkeys.

And he brought them through that year with food in exchange for all their livestock.

18 When that year was over, the next year rolled around and they were back, saying, "Master, it's no secret to you that we're broke: our money's gone and we've traded you all our livestock. We've nothing left to barter with but our bodies and our farms.

18 When that year was over, they came to him the following year and said, "We cannot hide from our lord the fact that since our money is gone and our livestock belongs to you, there is nothing left for our lord except our bodies and our land.

19 What use are our bodies and our land if we stand here and starve to death right in front of you? Trade us food for our bodies and our land. We'll be slaves to Pharaoh and give up our land--all we ask is seed for survival, just enough to live on and keep the farms alive."

19 Why should we perish before your eyes--we and our land as well? Buy us and our land in exchange for food, and we with our land will be in bondage to Pharaoh. Give us seed so that we may live and not die, and that the land may not become desolate."

20 So Joseph bought up all the farms in Egypt for Pharaoh. Every Egyptian sold his land--the famine was that bad. That's how Pharaoh ended up owning all the land

20 So Joseph bought all the land in Egypt for Pharaoh. The Egyptians, one and all, sold their fields, because the famine was too severe for them. The land became Pharaoh's,

21 and the people ended up slaves; Joseph reduced the people to slavery from one end of Egypt to the other.

21 and Joseph reduced the people to servitude, from one end of Egypt to the other.

22 Joseph made an exception for the priests. He didn't buy their land because they received a fixed salary from Pharaoh and were able to live off of that salary. So they didn't need to sell their land.

22 However, he did not buy the land of the priests, because they received a regular allotment from Pharaoh and had food enough from the allotment Pharaoh gave them. That is why they did not sell their land.

23 Joseph then announced to the people: "Here's how things stand: I've bought you and your land for Pharaoh. In exchange I'm giving you seed

- so you can plant the ground.
- 23 Joseph said to the people, "Now that I have bought you and your land today for Pharaoh, here is seed for you so you can plant the ground.
- 24 When the crops are harvested, you must give a fifth to Pharaoh and keep four-fifths for yourselves, for seed for yourselves and your families--you're going to be able to feed your children!"
- 24 But when the crop comes in, give a fifth of it to Pharaoh. The other four-fifths you may keep as seed for the fields and as food for yourselves and your households and your children."
- 25 They said, "You've saved our lives! Master, we're grateful and glad to be slaves to Pharaoh."
- 25 You have saved our lives, they said. "May we find favor in the eyes of our lord; we will be in bondage to Pharaoh."
- 26 Joseph decreed a land law in Egypt that is still in effect, A Fifth Goes to Pharaoh. Only the priests' lands were not owned by Pharaoh.
- 26 So Joseph established it as a law concerning land in Egypt--still in force today--that a fifth of the produce belongs to Pharaoh. It was only the land of the priests that did not become Pharaoh's.
- 27 And so Israel settled down in Egypt in the region of Goshen. They acquired property and flourished. They became a large company of people.
- 27 Now the Israelites settled in Egypt in the region of Goshen. They acquired property there and were fruitful and increased greatly in number.
- 28 Jacob lived in Egypt for seventeen years. In all, he lived 147 years.
- 28 Jacob lived in Egypt seventeen years, and the years of his life were a hundred and forty-seven.
- 29 When the time came for Israel to die, he called his son Joseph and said, "Do me this favor. Put your hand under my thigh, a sign that you're loyal and true to me to the end. Don't bury me in Egypt.
- 29 When the time drew near for Israel to die, he called for his son Joseph and said to him, "If I have found favor in your eyes, put your hand under my thigh and promise that you will show me kindness and faithfulness. Do not bury me in Egypt,
- 30 When I lie down with my fathers, carry me out of Egypt and bury me alongside them." "I will," he said. "I'll do what you've asked."

- 30 but when I rest with my fathers, carry me out of Egypt and bury me where they are buried." "I will do as you say," he said.
- 31 Israel said, "Promise me." Joseph promised. Israel bowed his head in submission and gratitude from his bed.
- 31 Swear to me, he said. Then Joseph swore to him, and Israel worshiped as he leaned on the top of his staff.

Genesis 48

MSG

NIV

- 1 Some time after this conversation, Joseph was told, "Your father is ill." He took his two sons, Manasseh and Ephraim, and went to Jacob.
- 1 Some time later Joseph was told, "Your father is ill." So he took his two sons Manasseh and Ephraim along with him.
- 2 When Jacob was told, "Your son Joseph has come," he roused himself and sat up in bed.
- 2 When Jacob was told, "Your son Joseph has come to you," Israel rallied his strength and sat up on the bed.
- 3 Jacob said to Joseph, "The Strong God appeared to me at Luz in the land of Canaan and blessed me.
- 3 Jacob said to Joseph, "God Almighty appeared to me at Luz in the land of Canaan, and there he blessed me
- 4 He said, 'I'm going to make you prosperous and numerous, turn you into a congregation of tribes; and I'll turn this land over to your children coming after you as a permanent inheritance.'
- 4 and said to me, 'I am going to make you fruitful and will increase your numbers. I will make you a community of peoples, and I will give this land as an everlasting possession to your descendants after you.'
- 5 I'm adopting your two sons who were born to you here in Egypt before I joined you; they have equal status with Reuben and Simeon.
- 5 Now then, your two sons born to you in Egypt before I came to you here will be reckoned as mine; Ephraim and Manasseh will be mine, just as Reuben and Simeon are mine.
- 6 But any children born after them are yours; they will come after their brothers in matters of inheritance.

- 6 Any children born to you after them will be yours; in the territory they inherit they will be reckoned under the names of their brothers.
- 7 I want it this way because, as I was returning from Paddan, your mother Rachel, to my deep sorrow, died as we were on our way through Canaan when we were only a short distance from Ephrath, now called Bethlehem."
- 7 As I was returning from Paddan, to my sorrow Rachel died in the land of Canaan while we were still on the way, a little distance from Ephrath. So I buried her there beside the road to Ephrath" (that is, Bethlehem).
- 8 Just then Jacob noticed Joseph's sons and said, "Who are these?"
- 8 When Israel saw the sons of Joseph, he asked, "Who are these?"
- 9 Joseph told his father, "They are my sons whom God gave to me in this place." "Bring them to me," he said, "so I can bless them."
- 9 They are the sons God has given me here, Joseph said to his father. Then Israel said, "Bring them to me so I may bless them."
- 10 Israel's eyesight was poor from old age; he was nearly blind. So Joseph brought them up close. Old Israel kissed and embraced them
- 10 Now Israel's eyes were failing because of old age, and he could hardly see. So Joseph brought his sons close to him, and his father kissed them and embraced them.
- 11 and then said to Joseph, "I never expected to see your face again, and now God has let me see your children as well!"
- 11 Israel said to Joseph, "I never expected to see your face again, and now God has allowed me to see your children too."
- 12 Joseph took them from Israel's knees and bowed respectfully, his face to the ground.
- 12 Then Joseph removed them from Israel's knees and bowed down with his face to the ground.
- 13 Then Joseph took the two boys, Ephraim with his right hand setting him to Israel's left, and Manasseh with his left hand setting him to Israel's right, and stood them before him.
- 13 And Joseph took both of them, Ephraim on his right toward Israel's left hand and Manasseh on his left toward Israel's right hand, and brought them close to him.
- 14 But Israel crossed his arms and put his right hand on the head of Ephraim who was the younger and his left hand on the head of

Manasseh, the firstborn.

- 14 But Israel reached out his right hand and put it on Ephraim's head, though he was the younger, and crossing his arms, he put his left hand on Manasseh's head, even though Manasseh was the firstborn.
- 15 Then he blessed them: The God before whom walked my fathers Abraham and Isaac, The God who has been my shepherd all my lifelong to this very day,
- 15 Then he blessed Joseph and said, "May the God before whom my fathers Abraham and Isaac walked, the God who has been my shepherd all my life to this day,
- 16 The Angel who delivered me from every evil, Bless the boys. May my name be echoed in their lives, and the names of Abraham and Isaac, my fathers, And may they grow covering the Earth with their children.
- 16 the Angel who has delivered me from all harm --may he bless these boys. May they be called by my name and the names of my fathers Abraham and Isaac, and may they increase greatly upon the earth."
- 17 When Joseph saw that his father had placed his right hand on Ephraim's head, he thought he had made a mistake, so he took hold of his father's hand to move it from Ephraim's head to Manasseh's,
- 17 When Joseph saw his father placing his right hand on Ephraim's head he was displeased; so he took hold of his father's hand to move it from Ephraim's head to Manasseh's head.
- 18 saying, "That's the wrong head, Father; the other one is the firstborn; place your right hand on his head."
- 18 Joseph said to him, "No, my father, this one is the firstborn; put your right hand on his head."
- 19 But his father wouldn't do it. He said, "I know, my son; but I know what I'm doing. He also will develop into a people, and he also will be great. But his younger brother will be even greater and his descendants will enrich nations."
- 19 But his father refused and said, "I know, my son, I know. He too will become a people, and he too will become great. Nevertheless, his younger brother will be greater than he, and his descendants will become a group of nations."
- 20 Then he blessed them both: Israel will use your names to give blessings: May God make you like Ephraim and Manasseh. In that he made it

explicit: he put Ephraim ahead of Manasseh.

20 He blessed them that day and said, "In your name will Israel pronounce this blessing: 'May God make you like Ephraim and Manasseh.' " So he put Ephraim ahead of Manasseh.

21 Israel then said to Joseph, "I'm about to die. God be with you and give you safe passage back to the land of your fathers.

21 Then Israel said to Joseph, "I am about to die, but God will be with you and take you back to the land of your fathers.

22 As for me, I'm presenting you, as the first among your brothers, the ridge of land I took from Amorites with my sword and bow."

22 And to you, as one who is over your brothers, I give the ridge of land I took from the Amorites with my sword and my bow."

Genesis 49

MSG

NIV

1 Jacob called his sons and said, "Gather around. I want to tell you what you can expect in the days to come."

1 Then Jacob called for his sons and said: "Gather around so I can tell you what will happen to you in days to come.

2 Come together, listen sons of Jacob, listen to Israel your father.

2 Assemble and listen, sons of Jacob; listen to your father Israel.

3 Reuben, you're my firstborn, my strength, first proof of my manhood, at the top in honor and at the top in power,

3 Reuben, you are my firstborn, my might, the first sign of my strength, excelling in honor, excelling in power.

4 But like a bucket of water spilled, you'll be at the top no more, Because you climbed into your father's marriage bed, mounting that couch, and you defiled it.

4 Turbulent as the waters, you will no longer excel, for you went up onto your father's bed, onto my couch and defiled it.

5 Simeon and Levi are two of a kind, ready to fight at the drop of a hat.

5 Simeon and Levi are brothers-- their swords are weapons of violence.

6 I don't want anything to do with their vendettas, want no part in their bitter feuds; They kill men in fits of temper, slash oxen on a whim.

- 6 Let me not enter their council, let me not join their assembly, for they have killed men in their anger and hamstrung oxen as they pleased.
- 7 A curse on their uncontrolled anger, on their indiscriminate wrath. I'll throw them out with the trash; I'll shred and scatter them like confetti throughout Israel.
- 7 Cursed be their anger, so fierce, and their fury, so cruel! I will scatter them in Jacob and disperse them in Israel.
- 8 You, Judah, your brothers will praise you: Your fingers on your enemies' throat, while your brothers honor you.
- 8 Judah, your brothers will praise you; your hand will be on the neck of your enemies; your father's sons will bow down to you.
- 9 You're a lion's cub, Judah, home fresh from the kill, my son. Look at him, crouched like a lion, king of beasts; who dares mess with him?
- 9 You are a lion's cub, O Judah; you return from the prey, my son. Like a lion he crouches and lies down, like a lioness--who dares to rouse him?
- 10 The scepter shall not leave Judah; he'll keep a firm grip on the command staff Until the ultimate ruler comes and the nations obey him.
- 10 The scepter will not depart from Judah, nor the ruler's staff from between his feet, until he comes to whom it belongs and the obedience of the nations is his.
- 11 He'll tie up his donkey to the grapevine, his purebred prize to a sturdy branch. He will wash his shirt in wine and his cloak in the blood of grapes,
- 11 He will tether his donkey to a vine, his colt to the choicest branch; he will wash his garments in wine, his robes in the blood of grapes.
- 12 His eyes will be darker than wine, his teeth whiter than milk.
- 12 His eyes will be darker than wine, his teeth whiter than milk.
- 13 Zebulun settles down on the seashore; he's a safe harbor for ships, right alongside Sidon.
- 13 Zebulun will live by the seashore and become a haven for ships; his border will extend toward Sidon.
- 14 Issachar is one tough donkey crouching between the corrals;
- 14 Issachar is a rawboned donkey lying down between two saddlebags.
- 15 When he saw how good the place was, how pleasant the country, He gave up his freedom and went to work as a slave.

- 15 When he sees how good is his resting place and how pleasant is his land, he will bend his shoulder to the burden and submit to forced labor.
- 16 Dan will handle matters of justice for his people; he will hold his own just fine among the tribes of Israel.
- 16 Dan will provide justice for his people as one of the tribes of Israel.
- 17 Dan is only a small snake in the grass, a lethal serpent in ambush by the road When he strikes a horse in the heel, and brings its huge rider crashing down.
- 17 Dan will be a serpent by the roadside, a viper along the path, that bites the horse's heels so that its rider tumbles backward.
- 18 I wait in hope for your salvation, GOD.
- 18 I look for your deliverance, O LORD.
- 19 Gad will be attacked by bandits, but he will trip them up.
- 19 Gad will be attacked by a band of raiders, but he will attack them at their heels.
- 20 Asher will become famous for rich foods, candies and sweets fit for kings.
- 20 Asher's food will be rich; he will provide delicacies fit for a king.
- 21 Naphtali is a deer running free that gives birth to lovely fawns.
- 21 Naphtali is a doe set free that bears beautiful fawns.
- 22 Joseph is a wild donkey, a wild donkey by a spring, spirited donkeys on a hill.
- 22 Joseph is a fruitful vine, a fruitful vine near a spring, whose branches climb over a wall.
- 23 The archers with malice attacked, shooting their hate-tipped arrows;
- 23 With bitterness archers attacked him; they shot at him with hostility.
- 24 But he held steady under fire, his bow firm, his arms limber, With the backing of the Champion of Jacob, the Shepherd, the Rock of Israel.
- 24 But his bow remained steady, his strong arms stayed limber, because of the hand of the Mighty One of Jacob, because of the Shepherd, the Rock of Israel,
- 25 The God of your father--may he help you! And may The Strong God--may he give you his blessings, Blessings tumbling out of the skies, blessings bursting up from the Earth-- blessings of breasts and womb.
- 25 because of your father's God, who helps you, because of the Almighty, who blesses you with blessings of the heavens above, blessings of the

deep that lies below, blessings of the breast and womb.

26 May the blessings of your father exceed the blessings of the ancient mountains, surpass the delights of the eternal hills; May they rest on the head of Joseph, on the brow of the one consecrated among his brothers.

26 Your father's blessings are greater than the blessings of the ancient mountains, than the bounty of the age-old hills. Let all these rest on the head of Joseph, on the brow of the prince among his brothers.

27 Benjamin is a ravenous wolf; all morning he gorges on his kill, at evening divides up what's left over.

27 Benjamin is a ravenous wolf; in the morning he devours the prey, in the evening he divides the plunder.

28 All these are the tribes of Israel, the twelve tribes. And this is what their father said to them as he blessed them, blessing each one with his own special farewell blessing.

28 All these are the twelve tribes of Israel, and this is what their father said to them when he blessed them, giving each the blessing appropriate to him.

29 Then he instructed them: "I am about to be gathered to my people. Bury me with my fathers in the cave which is in the field of Ephron the Hittite,

29 Then he gave them these instructions: "I am about to be gathered to my people. Bury me with my fathers in the cave in the field of Ephron the Hittite,

30 the cave in the field of Machpelah facing Mamre in the land of Canaan, the field Abraham bought from Ephron the Hittite for a burial plot.

30 the cave in the field of Machpelah, near Mamre in Canaan, which Abraham bought as a burial place from Ephron the Hittite, along with the field.

31 Abraham and his wife Sarah were buried there; Isaac and his wife Rebekah were buried there; I also buried Leah there.

31 There Abraham and his wife Sarah were buried, there Isaac and his wife Rebekah were buried, and there I buried Leah.

32 The field and the cave were bought from the Hittites."

32 The field and the cave in it were bought from the Hittites. "

33 Jacob finished instructing his sons, pulled his feet into bed, breathed his last, and was gathered to his people.

33 When Jacob had finished giving instructions to his sons, he drew his feet up into the bed, breathed his last and was gathered to his people.

Genesis 50

MSG

NIV

- 1 Joseph threw himself on his father, wept over him, and kissed him.
- 1 Joseph threw himself upon his father and wept over him and kissed him.
- 2 Joseph then instructed the physicians in his employ to embalm his father. The physicians embalmed Israel.
- 2 Then Joseph directed the physicians in his service to embalm his father Israel. So the physicians embalmed him,
- 3 The embalming took forty days, the period required for embalming. There was public mourning by the Egyptians for seventy days.
- 3 taking a full forty days, for that was the time required for embalming. And the Egyptians mourned for him seventy days.
- 4 When the period of mourning was completed, Joseph petitioned Pharaoh's court:
- 4 When the days of mourning had passed, Joseph said to Pharaoh's court, "If I have found favor in your eyes, speak to Pharaoh for me. Tell him,
- 5 "If you have reason to think kindly of me, present Pharaoh with my request: My father made me swear, saying, 'I am ready to die. Bury me in the grave plot that I prepared for myself in the land of Canaan.' Please give me leave to go up and bury my father. Then I'll come back."
- 5 'My father made me swear an oath and said, "I am about to die; bury me in the tomb I dug for myself in the land of Canaan." Now let me go up and bury my father; then I will return.' "
- 6 Pharaoh said, "Certainly. Go and bury your father as he made you promise under oath."
- 6 Pharaoh said, "Go up and bury your father, as he made you swear to do."
- 7 So Joseph left to bury his father. And all the high-ranking officials from Pharaoh's court went with him, all the dignitaries of Egypt,
- 7 So Joseph went up to bury his father. All Pharaoh's officials accompanied him--the dignitaries of his court and all the dignitaries of Egypt--

- 8 joining Joseph's family--his brothers and his father's family. Their children and flocks and herds were left in Goshen.
- 8 besides all the members of Joseph's household and his brothers and those belonging to his father's household. Only their children and their flocks and herds were left in Goshen.
- 9 Chariots and horsemen accompanied them. It was a huge funeral procession.
- 9 Chariots and horsemen also went up with him. It was a very large company.
- 10 Arriving at the Atad Threshing Floor just across the Jordan River, they stopped for a period of mourning, letting their grief out in loud and lengthy lament. For seven days, Joseph engaged in these funeral rites for his father.
- 10 When they reached the threshing floor of Atad, near the Jordan, they lamented loudly and bitterly; and there Joseph observed a seven-day period of mourning for his father.
- 11 When the Canaanites who lived in that area saw the grief being poured out at the Atad Threshing Floor, they said, "Look how deeply the Egyptians are mourning." That is how the site at the Jordan got the name Abel Mizraim (Egyptian Lament).
- 11 When the Canaanites who lived there saw the mourning at the threshing floor of Atad, they said, "The Egyptians are holding a solemn ceremony of mourning." That is why that place near the Jordan is called Abel Mizraim.
- 12 Jacob's sons continued to carry out his instructions to the letter.
- 12 So Jacob's sons did as he had commanded them:
- 13 They took him on into Canaan and buried him in the cave in the field of Machpelah facing Mamre, the field that Abraham had bought as a burial plot from Ephron the Hittite.
- 13 They carried him to the land of Canaan and buried him in the cave in the field of Machpelah, near Mamre, which Abraham had bought as a burial place from Ephron the Hittite, along with the field.
- 14 After burying his father, Joseph went back to Egypt. All his brothers who had come with him to bury his father returned with him.
- 14 After burying his father, Joseph returned to Egypt, together with his brothers and all the others who had gone with him to bury his father.

- 15 After the funeral, Joseph's brothers talked among themselves: "What if Joseph is carrying a grudge and decides to pay us back for all the wrong we did him?"
- 15 When Joseph's brothers saw that their father was dead, they said, "What if Joseph holds a grudge against us and pays us back for all the wrongs we did to him?"
- 16 So they sent Joseph a message, "Before his death, your father gave this command:
- 16 So they sent word to Joseph, saying, "Your father left these instructions before he died:
- 17 Tell Joseph, 'Forgive your brothers' sin--all that wrongdoing. They did treat you very badly.' Will you do it? Will you forgive the sins of the servants of your father's God?" When Joseph received their message, he wept.
- 17 'This is what you are to say to Joseph: I ask you to forgive your brothers the sins and the wrongs they committed in treating you so badly.' Now please forgive the sins of the servants of the God of your father." When their message came to him, Joseph wept.
- 18 Then the brothers went in person to him, threw themselves on the ground before him and said, "We'll be your slaves."
- 18 His brothers then came and threw themselves down before him. "We are your slaves," they said.
- 19 Joseph replied, "Don't be afraid. Do I act for God?
- 19 But Joseph said to them, "Don't be afraid. Am I in the place of God?
- 20 Don't you see, you planned evil against me but God used those same plans for my good, as you see all around you right now--life for many people.
- 20 You intended to harm me, but God intended it for good to accomplish what is now being done, the saving of many lives.
- 21 Easy now, you have nothing to fear; I'll take care of you and your children." He reassured them, speaking with them heart-to-heart.
- 21 So then, don't be afraid. I will provide for you and your children." And he reassured them and spoke kindly to them.
- 22 Joseph continued to live in Egypt with his father's family. Joseph lived 110 years.

- 22 Joseph stayed in Egypt, along with all his father's family. He lived a hundred and ten years
- 23 He lived to see Ephraim's sons into the third generation. The sons of Makir, Manasseh's son, were also recognized as Joseph's.
- 23 and saw the third generation of Ephraim's children. Also the children of Makir son of Manasseh were placed at birth on Joseph's knees.
- 24 At the end, Joseph said to his brothers, "I am ready to die. God will most certainly pay you a visit and take you out of this land and back to the land he so solemnly promised to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob."
- 24 Then Joseph said to his brothers, "I am about to die. But God will surely come to your aid and take you up out of this land to the land he promised on oath to Abraham, Isaac and Jacob."
- 25 Then Joseph made the sons of Israel promise under oath, "When God makes his visitation, make sure you take my bones with you as you leave here."
- 25 And Joseph made the sons of Israel swear an oath and said, "God will surely come to your aid, and then you must carry my bones up from this place."
- 26 Joseph died at the age of 110 years. They embalmed him and placed him in a coffin in Egypt.
- 26 So Joseph died at the age of a hundred and ten. And after they embalmed him, he was placed in a coffin in Egypt.